

THE HOLY R3UP FOR ALL



The 90-Day Rebuild

BIBLE · RESEARCH · STEP BY STEP

You survived. Now we rebuild.

Six pages a day for ninety days:
Scripture in context, what research suggests, and what to do next

THE HOLY R3UP FOR ALL
BANDO TO VINEYARD

THE HOLY R3UP FOR ALL

The 90-Day Rebuild



SCRIPTURE IN ITS SETTING · WHAT RESEARCH
SUGGESTS · FIVE STEPS A DAY
UNDERSTAND IT. STAND ON IT. GO TO HER. WRITE IT
DOWN. CARRY IT.

*For Brandi Renee, January 27, 1986 – December
17, 2021, and for the little girl who was not
protected.*

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The 90-Day Rebuild: Bible, Research, and Step-by-Step Healing for Ninety Days

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PLEASE READ

This book is a faith-based companion for reflection and practice. It is not medical, mental-health, legal, or addiction-treatment advice, and it does not replace a doctor, therapist, counselor, pastor, or emergency services. The author is not a licensed clinician. Prayer belongs beside — not in place of — treatment, medication, safe housing, and safety planning.

YOUR SAFETY COMES FIRST

If you are in danger, call 911 (or your local emergency number). If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988 (U.S.). If you are physically dependent on alcohol, benzodiazepines, or barbiturates, do not stop suddenly without medical supervision — withdrawal can be dangerous. The resource page at the back of the book lists additional help. Phone numbers and services change; please confirm them before you rely on them.

ABOUT THE STORIES AND IDEAS

Personal testimony is shared as lived experience, not as a formula or a promise of any outcome. Interpretations of Scripture are labeled as interpretation and offered for you to test against the Bible and with wise, trusted people. Nothing in this book guarantees healing, deliverance, income, or any particular result.

SCRIPTURE

Scripture quotations are from the ESV® Bible (The Holy Bible, English Standard Version®), copyright © 2001 by Crossway, a publishing ministry of Good News Publishers. Used by permission. All rights reserved. Some verses are shortened with ellipses (...) or summarized; summaries are marked as references rather than quotations.

IN MEMORY

In Memory of Brandi Renee · January 27, 1986 – December 17, 2021

You survived. Now we rebuild.

BEFORE DAY ONE

Meet Nikki and Big Boy

Hey. I'm Nikki, and this is Big Boy, my battle buddy: a big gray-and-white American Bully with a muscular build and no ears, who stood beside me through some of my loneliest days.

I lost my sister to addiction. I have lived through homelessness, trafficking, abuse, addiction, and a long, destructive relationship. When I reached for help, too often there were strings attached, or a watered-down verse and a pat on the head. I needed somewhere that could hold the truth about trauma without pushing God out of the room.

I am not a counselor, a doctor, or a finished story. I am building as I go. What I can offer is what I have learned, what Scripture actually says, and something practical you can do today. God met me while I was still trying to get up. That is where this book comes from.

Take what helps. Leave what does not. Get real help when you need it, because prayer sits beside treatment and safety, not instead of them.

You survived. Now we rebuild. — Nikki & Big Boy

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READ THIS FIRST

How This Book Works

Every day has **six pages**, always in this order, so you never have to decide what to do next:

1

GUIDE · UNDERSTAND AND PLAN

Today's goal, what the Bible passage actually says in its setting, what research suggests, and five numbered steps with check boxes.

2

STANDING, LEFT PAGE

An optional grounding exercise, Scripture, and teaching on spiritual warfare, family wounds, and addiction.

3

STANDING, RIGHT PAGE

Reflection prompts, one soft action, a prayer, and a declaration.

4

COMING HOME · GO TO HER

One gentle step toward the child you were, with a prayer, an affirmation, and a challenge.

5

WRITE IT DOWN

Rate your distress before and after, circle the steps you finished, and write what came up. Over time the numbers show you what actually helps.

6

POCKET PAGE

A verse to carry, a note of love with an ESV verse, a nugget, "Today I choose," and a note from Future Me.

BE HONEST ABOUT THE SCIENCE

- The research notes are plain-language summaries of published studies. They describe what has been found across groups of people. They are not promises about you.
- Citations were written from memory and have not been checked against the originals. Look up any you plan to rely on, and ask a counselor or doctor about anything that affects your care.
- The Bible "in context" notes explain a passage's setting. Where I apply a verse beyond its own subject, I say so.

PACE YOURSELF

- Do all six pages in one sitting, or spread them across the day. Doing only the Guide on a hard day still counts.
- Skip any step or any grounding exercise that does not feel safe. Nothing here asks you to tell a story or remember anything.
- This book does not replace counseling, treatment, medical care, or a safety plan. Prayer sits beside those things, not instead of them.

THE WHOLE MAP

Your 90-Day Path

Nine arcs, ten to fifteen days each. Each arc has one theme and one place on the road from surviving toward living.

Days	Arc	Standing focus	Coming Home stage
1-10	Telling the Truth	The war underneath: childhood, body, secrecy, a date	Build Her a Safe Place
11-20	The Lies and the Names	Lies, names, and the moral injury of surviving	Meet Her at the Doorway
21-30	The Realm and Your Authority	Warfare, plainly: sorting, standing, forgiving	Stand Guard for Her
31-45	The Contracts	Vows, words, ties, the cistern, wanting out	Release What She Promised
46-55	The Bloodline	Family patterns and ending the cycle	Show Her Her Family Line
56-68	The Playbook and the Structure	Patterns, cravings, daily structure, boundaries, falling	Build Her a House
69-76	God	Where He was, honest anger, silence	Where Was Jesus?
77-84	Brandi and Letting Go	Grief, guilt, children out of reach, release	Say Goodbye and Hello
85-90	Becoming Her	Stewarding what you have learned	Meet the New You

READ THIS FIRST

Going Back Safely

This book walks you through a prayerful, imaginative practice: visiting the child you were, comforting her, releasing what she promised to survive, and bringing her home to the woman you are becoming. It is a tool, not a cure, and these are the rules that keep it safe.

What it is

Prayerful imagination and compassion practice anchored in Scripture: God sees and comforts (Psalm 139:12; Isaiah 66:13), and Jesus welcomes children (Mark 10:14). The “room” and the “doorway” are pictures. They are not visions, and they are not literal memories.

What it is not

It is not memory recovery. You never hunt for memories, and you never try to reconstruct what you do not already know. It is not a ritual that frees anyone by itself, and it does not replace therapy, medicine, or safety planning. Imagining something does not make it true history.

Your rules

- You choose the pace. A stop word, a ten-minute timer, and a landing (warm drink, walk, a text to someone) are part of every visit.
- Visit from the doorway. You never have to go into a scene.
- Use only what you already know. If nothing comes, nothing is required.
- Jesus is central. If you cannot picture Him, pray His words aloud instead.
- If you feel far away, numb, flooded, or have flashbacks, stop, open your eyes, find the date and the exit, and do your landing.

DO THIS WITH A TRAINED TRAUMA THERAPIST IF

- your history includes severe or ongoing abuse, trafficking, or ritual abuse
- you lose time, dissociate, or feel like parts of you are separate
- visits leave you worse for more than a day

If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text **988**. If you are in danger, call 911.

Spiritual Warfare, Plainly

I want to be careful with this language, because it has been used on people who needed help, not hype. So here is what I stand on.

What Scripture says

There is a real adversary: a liar, an accuser, a thief (John 10:10; Revelation 12:10; 1 Peter 5:8). He is a created being, limited by God (Job 1–2), and already defeated at the cross (Colossians 2:15; 1 John 3:8). Our part is to submit to God, resist the devil, stand firm in the armor God gives, answer lies with what is written (as Jesus did in Matthew 4), and pray (James 4:7; Ephesians 6:10–18).

What Scripture does not say

It does not hand us a formula. In Acts 19:13–16, men tried to use Jesus’ name like a tool and were beaten. It does not say every problem is demonic. It does not say we should shout or boast about authority; Jesus told His disciples to rejoice not that spirits submit to them but that their names are written in heaven (Luke 10:20), and even the archangel Michael did not presume to rebuke the devil on his own (Jude 9). It does not say a child’s struggle is a spirit, or that words on a page break a curse.

How this book uses the word “warfare”

Here, warfare means refusing to agree with lies, standing in Christ, and doing the ordinary faithful things together with practical care: sleep, food, doctors, counselors, safety, honest friends, and prayer. Test every spirit (1 John 4:1). If something makes you more ashamed, more isolated, or more afraid, it is not from Him.

Where I offer a picture (doors, agreements, stages) it is interpretation. Scripture is the authority; the pictures are tools.

A Word About Your Mother

This book was rewritten for you: a daughter whose mother carried her own trauma and addiction, and who allowed your father to abuse you when you were a baby; a woman in recovery from her own addiction; a woman who is not a mother and does not want to carry any of this on. If that is not your story, read it as the nearest true thing.

What I will not do

I will not ask you to remember. You were six months old; you cannot, and you do not need to. I will not tell you your mother was only a monster or only a victim; people are often both, and you can hold that without excusing her. I will not tell you your addiction is her fault, or that it is only yours. I will not tell you that you are destined to repeat it, or that you are cursed. I will not use guilt, and I will not tell you that forgiving means going back.

What I will do

Explain, plainly and without claiming certainty, how a baby who was not protected can grow into a woman whose body reaches for relief and whose heart struggles to trust (Days 5, 6, 39, 40). Name the grief for the mother you needed. Walk you through forgiving at your own pace, setting boundaries, and releasing what is not yours. Show you concrete ways to stop the pattern with you: recovery, therapy, safe people, new habits, and a line of faith and honesty you start now, with or without children.

Right now

If you are in danger, call 911. If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988. If a child is at risk near the person who harmed you, Childhelp: 1-800-422-4453. SAMHSA Helpline (substance use): 1-800-662-4357. (Please confirm numbers before relying on them.)

SAY IT BEFORE DAY ONE

An Opening Prayer

Say it again any day you need it.

PRAYER

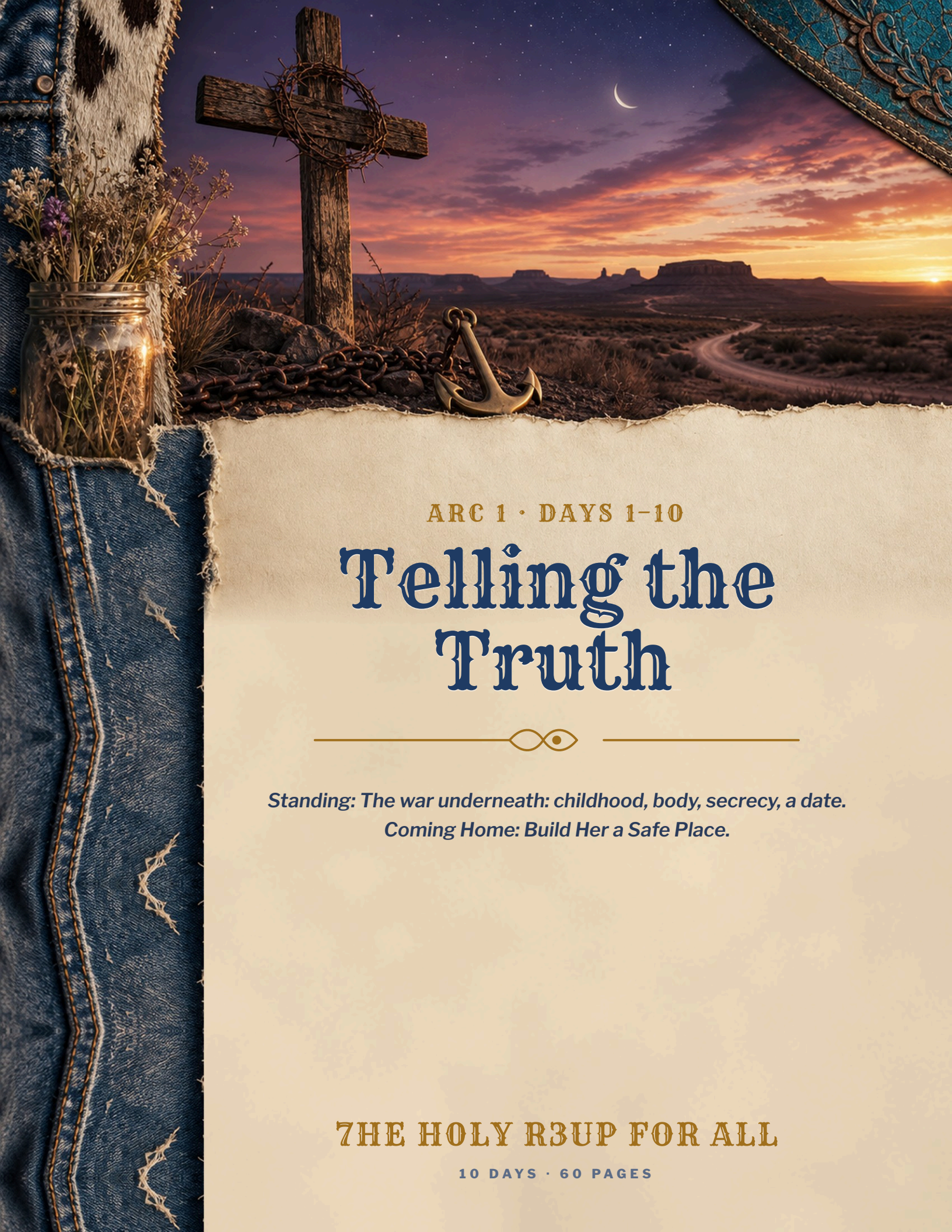
Father, I come to You through Jesus. I am not coming cleaned up. I am coming honest.

You know what was done to me, what I did to get through it, and what I am still afraid is true about me. Nothing in these ninety days will surprise You.

Walk through each page with me. Where I find shame, bring light. Where I find grief, sit with me and do not rush me. Where I find anger, let me bring it to You instead of holding it against You.

Give me the courage to take the next small step, and the sense to ask for help when I need it. Let what I learn become something somebody else can use.

I put my sister Brandi Renee in Your hands, not mine. In Jesus' name. Amen.



ARC 1 • DAYS 1-10

Telling the Truth



Standing: The war underneath: childhood, body, secrecy, a date.

Coming Home: Build Her a Safe Place.

THE HOLY R3UP FOR ALL

10 DAYS • 60 PAGES

The War Started Before You Had Words

TODAY'S GOAL

Name that the fight is real, and that you are not fighting it alone.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • EPHESIANS 6:12 (ESV)

Paul wrote Ephesians while under arrest in Rome, around AD 60–62, to believers in Ephesus. “Struggle” translates a wrestling word. He is not saying people are never responsible for what they do. He is saying there is more going on in the world than what we can see, and that we are told to stand, not to panic.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

The large ACE study of more than 17,000 adults found that the more kinds of childhood adversity a person reported, the higher their risk of later problems, including substance use. It describes risk across a group. It does not say what will happen to you.

Source: Felitti et al., 1998. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Sit or stand where your feet can touch the floor. Set a timer for 2 minutes.
- 2 ☐ Say out loud, “I am here. It is today. I am an adult.” Look around and name three things you can see.
- 3 ☐ Read today’s verse once, slowly. Then read the “In context” box.
- 4 ☐ Write on the Journal page the one sentence you most need to be true about this book.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration out loud. Check the box. Stop.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

MOTHER WOUND · WARFARE · ADDICTION

Feel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

EPHESIANS 6:12 · ESV

You have told me that your father abused you when you were six months old, and that your mother, who carried her own trauma and addiction, allowed it. You had no words, no memory, and no defense. Scripture says the struggle is real and bigger than flesh and blood, and Jesus names the thief's work: to steal, kill, and destroy. What was done to you was never God's will. You are not crazy for living with effects you cannot explain, and you do not need a single memory to be believed here.

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SACRED REFLECTION

1. What do I already know about my beginning, and how do I know it?

2. How does it feel to hear that I do not need to remember it?

3. What would it mean to stand against it instead of just surviving it?

SOFT ACTION

Write one sentence that starts, "What happened to me was wrong because..." Say it aloud once.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, I did not choose the war I was born into. Stand with me in it. Name the harm as harm, and be near me while I look. Amen.

What was done to me was wrong, and God was never on its side.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 91:1

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- Too much today? Open your eyes, name five things you see, and stop. Stopping is part of the practice.*

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The War Started Before You Had Words

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“For we do not wrestle against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the cosmic powers over this present darkness, against the spiritual forces of evil in the heavenly places.”

Ephesians 6:12 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

I know the first step is the hardest one. You took it. I am proud of you and I am not even in the room.

“Fear not, for I am with you; be not dismayed, for I am your God; I will strengthen you, I will help you, I will uphold you with my righteous right hand.”

Isa 41:10 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Seeing the whole battlefield is not the same as living on it. You can learn the map and still sleep at night.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to begin before I feel ready.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I am writing this on Day 1 so you can see where it started. I was scared and I did it anyway. If you are reading this, I kept going. Thank me.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Telling the Truth About Both of Them

TODAY'S GOAL

Tell the truth about both parents without lying in either direction.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • 1 JOHN 1:7 (ESV)

First John was written by the apostle John to believers who were being taught confusing things about sin and about Jesus. Verse 7 says walking in the light brings fellowship and that Jesus's blood cleanses us from all sin. Light in this letter means honesty before God, not performance.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

In the classic 1986 study, people who wrote about a distressing event for a few days reported fewer health-center visits afterward than people who wrote about neutral topics. Later work found the average effect is modest and varies from person to person.

Source: Pennebaker & Beall, 1986. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Get two sheets of paper. Head one "Mother" and one "Father."
- 2 ☐ For 5 minutes each, list what was true: what they did, what they failed to do, and what they did well. Use short phrases, not paragraphs.
- 3 ☐ Put a star by anything you have never said to anyone. Do not explain it yet.
- 4 ☐ Fold the pages and put them where no one will find them. You do not have to show anyone.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration. If you feel flooded, stop and do the 5-things-you-can-see reset.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

MOTHER WOUND · WARFARE

Hold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

1 JOHN 1:7 · ESV

Families protect the ones who did the harm. Silence says the father's actions and the mother's failure to protect are not to be named. Light is not exposure for its own sake. It is one safe person who will not panic, gossip, or use it against you. Warfare begins small: saying out loud to one human being that your father hurt you and your mother did not protect you, and watching what the fear does when it is spoken.

20

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What have I never said out loud about my father or my mother?

2. Who has earned the right to hear the unedited version?

3. What do I need from them when I say it?

SOFT ACTION

Name your one person and choose a day this week. Start with one true sentence. You do not have to tell it all.

SUPPLICATION

Father, I have kept this in the dark to survive. Give me one safe person and the courage to say one true thing. Amen.

I do not have to carry this alone, and I do not have to carry it in secret.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: ECCLESIASTES 4:9-10

She does not have to be alone this time.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Telling the Truth About Both of Them

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“But if we walk in the light, as he is in the light, we have fellowship with one another, and the blood of Jesus his Son cleanses us from all sin.”

1 John 1:7 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

It is okay to love people who were not safe. It is okay to stop going near them, too. Both can be true tonight.

“The LORD is near to the brokenhearted and saves the crushed in spirit.”

Ps 34:18 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You are allowed to write a sentence you will later cross out. Honesty gets drafted before it gets polished.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose accuracy over loyalty to a story.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, you are going to be able to say both things: that you were hurt and that you were loved by somebody, sometimes in the same breath. That is not betrayal. That is accuracy.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Both Hands: What Was Done and What You Did

TODAY'S GOAL

Hold what was done to you and what you did, without letting one erase the other.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • ROMANS 7:15 (ESV)

In Romans 7:15 Paul describes the struggle of doing what he does not want to do. He is writing to the church in Rome about the law, sin, and grace, and he is not hiding his own struggle. Chapter 8 follows with "There is therefore now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Researchers who study shame and guilt have found that shame ("I am bad") tends to go with hiding and relapse risk, while guilt ("I did something wrong") tends to go with repair. This is a pattern in groups of people, not a rule for you.

Source: Tangney & Dearing, 2002. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Draw a line down the middle of a page. Left: "What was done to me." Right: "What I did."
- 2 ☐ Write three to five words in each column. No stories.
- 3 ☐ Read the right-hand column aloud, then say, "I am accountable for this, and I am not disposable."
- 4 ☐ Read the left-hand column aloud, then say, "This was not my fault."
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration, then put a hand on your chest for five breaths.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

MOTHER WOUND · ADDICTION

Name three things you can see and one thing you can hear. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

ROMANS 7:15 · ESV

A baby has zero responsibility for what happens to her. None. And later, in your own addiction, some of what you did was your own doing, and some of it hurt people. Both are true at once. Holding only the first makes you a permanent victim. Holding only the second makes you your own warden. Your mother had both hands too: she was hurt, and she failed you. You can see that without excusing it. You need both hands to carry this, and God carries the rest.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What was done to me that was never mine to carry?

2. What did I do that was mine to own?

3. What would it be like to see my mother with both hands without excusing her?

SOFT ACTION

Make two columns: "Done to me" and "My part." Fill one line each. Stop there.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, give me honest hands, one to set down what was never mine, one to own what was. Hold the rest. Amen.

I can tell the truth about what was done to me and what I did, and still be held.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: ROMANS 7:15

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Both Hands: What Was Done and What You Did

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“For I do not understand my own actions. For I do not do what I want, but I do the very thing I hate.”

Romans 7:15 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You are not the sum of what you did to survive. You are the girl who lived through it.

“Fear not, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by name, you are mine.”

Isa 43:1 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Accountable and ashamed are not the same room. You can live in the first without ever moving into the second.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose responsibility without self-hatred.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you can look at that two-column page without flinching now. It was never meant to be a verdict. It was a map.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

The Accuser Says It Was Your Fault

TODAY'S GOAL

Spot the accuser's voice and answer it with what Jesus has already said.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • REVELATION 12:10 (ESV)

Revelation 12:10 is part of John's vision, written to churches under pressure around the end of the first century. The "accuser of our brothers" is cast down, and verse 11 says believers conquered him "by the blood of the Lamb and by the word of their testimony." The accuser's main work in Scripture is accusation, not creativity.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

In a brain-imaging study, simply putting a name on an emotion ("angry," "afraid") was linked to less amygdala activity than other responses. Naming the feeling is a small, free tool, and it is not a cure.

Source: Lieberman et al., 2007. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write down the accusing sentence you hear most (for example, "It was your fault"). Use the exact words.
- 2 ☐ Next to it write who is saying it: "My shame," "My family," "The accuser," or "I don't know." Any answer is fine.
- 3 ☐ Under it write one true sentence, such as "I was six months old," or "I am forgiven."
- 4 ☐ Say the true sentence three times out loud, slowly.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration. Drink a glass of water.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · MOTHER WOUND

Put a hand on your chest and let one long breath out. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.*

REVELATION 12:10 · ESV

Children, even tiny ones, take blame. When the people who should protect you do not, a child concludes that she must not be worth protecting. The accuser loves that conclusion and says it in your own voice: you were the problem, you are too much, no one would help. Conviction names one specific thing with a way out. Condemnation names your whole self with no door. A baby cannot be guilty of what was done to her, and God does not condemn the one who was harmed.

32

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What does the accuser say about why this happened to me?

2. Is it specific with a way out, or sweeping with no door?

3. What would Jesus say to that sentence?

SOFT ACTION

When the sentence shows up today, answer it once with Romans 8:1 and move on. Do not debate it.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You stand with the harmed. Silence the voice that blames the baby. Amen.

Conviction gives me a door. Condemnation is not from God.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 34:5

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Accuser Says It Was Your Fault

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“...for the accuser of our brothers has been thrown down, who accuses them day and night before our God.”

Revelation 12:10 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

The voice that says it was your fault was never God's voice. Listen for the One who speaks gentler.

“What then shall we say to these things? If God is for us, who can be against us?”

Rom 8:31 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

*A lie said often does not become true.
It becomes familiar. Familiar is not the same as accurate.*

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to check the sentence before I obey it.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

*Future Me, there will be days the old sentence still shows up. You will not have to believe it to hear it.
You will know what to write underneath.*

Write Future Me one line of your own:

A Body That Learned Early

TODAY'S GOAL

Learn what your body learned, without needing the story.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • PSALM 56:8 (ESV)

Psalm 56 is attributed to David “when the Philistines seized him in Gath.” Verse 8 says, “You have kept count of my tossings; put my tears in your bottle. Are they not in your book?” God is described as someone who notices and keeps track of pain.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

A review of slow-breathing studies found that breathing slowly (around six breaths a minute) is linked to measurable changes in heart-rate variability and to feeling calmer in many people. Trauma writers like Bessel van der Kolk describe how stress can be held in the body, though the science is still being refined.

Sources: Zaccaro et al., 2018; van der Kolk, 2014. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Sit with your feet flat. Put one hand on your belly. Set a timer for 3 minutes.
- 2 ☐ Breathe in through your nose for 4 counts. Let it out slowly for 6 counts. Repeat.
- 3 ☐ Notice where your body is tight. Do not fix it. Just say, “There.”
- 4 ☐ Say to your body, quietly: “Thank you for watching out for me. We can rest now.”
- 5 ☐ If breathing makes you dizzy or anxious, stop and press your feet into the floor instead.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

CHILDHOOD · ADDICTION

Look around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.*

"You have kept count of my tossings; put my tears in your bottle. Are they not in your book?"

PSALM 56:8 · ESV

Your body learned things before you had words: that the world is not safe, that the people meant to protect you may not, that relief has to be found. Those lessons live in the nervous system, not in stories, which is why you can feel them without remembering anything. Fight, flight, freeze, and fawn were survival strategies, and a body that learned them that early may reach for relief quickly. That is not weak faith. It is a body doing a job it learned young. God keeps count of every tear.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which survival response is my default?

2. How does it show up in my cravings, my relationships, my sleep?

3. What did it save me from?

SOFT ACTION

Put a hand where your body holds it most. Say, "You kept me alive. You can rest now."

SUPPLICATION

God, You saw every tear. Thank You for the body that kept me alive. Teach it that it does not stand watch alone. Amen.

My body is not broken. It is remembering, and it can learn a new rhythm.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 56:8

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

A Body That Learned Early

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“You have kept count of my tossings; put my tears in your bottle. Are they not in your book?”

Psalms 56:8 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Your body has been on guard for a long time. Today, let it be off duty for one breath.

“The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want. He makes me lie down in green pastures. He leads me beside still waters. He restores my soul.”

Psalms 23:1–3 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Your nervous system is not your enemy. It is a very loyal employee working off an old job description.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to be gentle with the part of me that stays alert.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope your body feels like a house you live in and not a trap you escaped. If it still startles easily, that is okay. It has a long memory.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Where the Baby Lives

TODAY'S GOAL

Give the very young part of you a place to be held, without going back into the fire.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • ISAIAH 66:13 (ESV)

Isaiah 66:13 says, "As one whom his mother comforts, so I will comfort you." Isaiah is speaking to Jerusalem after exile. God is described with a mother's tenderness, which does not mean your own mother did that for you. It means God offers it.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

A review of human-animal interaction research reported that contact with a friendly animal is linked to lower stress and, in some studies, changes in oxytocin and cortisol. The findings are mixed and often small, but many people feel steadier with a companion nearby.

Source: Beetz et al., 2012. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Pick one soft thing: a blanket, a stuffed animal, or your dog's warm back. Hold it for 2 minutes.
- 2 ☐ Say softly, "I am here. I am the grown-up now."
- 3 ☐ Ask, "How old does the fear feel today?" Write only the number.
- 4 ☐ Do not ask what happened. Just say hello to that age.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration and keep the soft thing close for the rest of the day.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

CHILDHOOD · MOTHER WOUND

Press your palms together, then let go. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.*

ISAIAH 66:13 · ESV

Trauma has an age, and for you the youngest part may be pre-verbal. You cannot interview a baby; you can only hold her. That is what comfort is: warmth, rocking, a steady voice, a blanket, a hand on the chest. You do not have to dig for anything. You only have to give the youngest part of you what she needed and did not get. God promised to comfort like a mother comforts, and He means the kind of mother who stays.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Where in my body does the oldest fear live?

2. What does she need that is simple: warmth, quiet, being held?

3. What would it feel like to give it?

SOFT ACTION

Wrap yourself in a blanket for three minutes. Say, "I am here. I will not leave you."

SUPPLICATION

Father, You comfort like a mother who stays. Come to the youngest part of me and hold her. Amen.

I can comfort her without going back into what hurt her.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: ISAIAH 66:13

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Where the Baby Lives

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“As one whom his mother comforts, so I will comfort you; you shall be comforted in Jerusalem.”

Isaiah 66:13 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

If the youngest part of you only needed a hand to hold, go be that hand.

“The LORD your God is in your midst, a mighty one who will save; he will rejoice over you with gladness; he will quiet you by his love; he will exult over you with loud singing.”

Zeph 3:17 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You do not have to dig to be kind. You can just knock and say hello.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose comfort over interrogation.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, remember that she did not need an explanation. She needed someone to show up. You can.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Six Resets for an Old Alarm

TODAY'S GOAL

Learn one reset you can do anywhere in under two minutes.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • PSALM 46:10 (ESV)

Psalm 46:10 says, "Be still, and know that I am God." The Hebrew word for "be still" can mean to relax your grip or let go. The psalm opens with God as "a very present help in trouble" and describes earthquakes, roaring waters, and nations in uproar, so "be still" is spoken in the middle of noise, not after it clears.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Slow breathing is linked in studies to calmer physiology. Separately, research on emotion regulation suggests that changing how we think about a situation early on (reappraisal) tends to work better than trying to push the feeling down once it is big.

Sources: Zaccaro et al., 2018; Gross, 2002. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Choose one reset to practice: (a) feet-on-floor, (b) 4-in/6-out breathing, (c) cold water on wrists, or (d) naming five things you see.
- 2 ☐ Practice it now for 90 seconds while you are calm. Calm practice is how it works when you are not.
- 3 ☐ Write on a card: "When it spikes, I will _____." Put the card where you will see it.
- 4 ☐ Tell one person which reset you chose.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · ADDICTION

Sit with your back against something solid. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

"Be still, and know that I am God. I will be exalted among the nations, I will be exalted in the earth."

WHAT THIS MEANS

A body that was never taught to calm itself will reach for something that does it. Before you ask whether something is spiritual, calm the alarm. Breathe in four, hold seven, out eight. Name five things you see. Cold water on your wrists. Push the wall for ten seconds. Say, "This is memory, not danger." These do not replace prayer. They are what you learn instead of the thing you used, and they are what make prayer possible when your chest is on fire.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which reset helps me most?

2. When is my alarm loudest, and what do I usually reach for?

3. What small change could make the reset easier to reach?

SOFT ACTION

Pick one reset and practice it three times today before you need it.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, I do not have to fight with a racing heart. Slow me down and be near. Amen.

I have tools. I am not at the mercy of my own alarm.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 46:10

I am teaching her how to feel safe.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Six Resets for an Old Alarm

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Be still, and know that I am God. I will be exalted among the nations, I will be exalted in the earth!”

Psalms 46:10 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You do not need to be calm to practice calm. Show up shaky. It still counts.

“God is our refuge and strength, a very present help in trouble.”

Ps 46:1 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You do not rise to the occasion. You fall to the level of your practice. So practice small and early.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose a tool I can reach.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope that card is worn soft from use. A reset you practiced when you were calm is the one you can find at 2 a.m.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Inventory: Mother, Father, Me

TODAY'S GOAL

Make a list of who and what, without telling the whole story to anyone.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • PSALM 139:23-24 (ESV)

Psalm 139:23–24 reads, “Search me, O God, and know my heart! Try me and know my thoughts! And see if there be any grievous way in me, and lead me in the way everlasting!” It is David’s prayer to be examined by someone who already knows him. He asks God to search, not to condemn.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Writing about hard experiences helps some people more when they also make plans for what to do next. Research on “if–then” plans found that people who wrote a specific plan (“If X happens, I will do Y”) were more likely to follow through than people who only intended to.

Sources: Pennebaker & Beall, 1986; Gollwitzer, 1999. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Make three columns: “Mother,” “Father,” “Me.” Under each write short phrases for what was never dealt with.
- 2 ☐ Circle one item in each column you are ready to look at first. Leave the rest.
- 3 ☐ Write one if–then plan: “If I start to feel numb or flooded, then I will _____.”
- 4 ☐ Read the plan aloud.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration, then close the page.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

Inventory: Mother, Father, Me

MOTHER WOUND · ADDICTION

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Take a slow sip of water. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

"Search me, O God, and know my heart! Try me and know my thoughts! And see if there is any grievous way in me, and lead me in the way everlasting!"

PSALM 139:23-24 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Titles only, no stories. Three lists: what happened to me (what my father did, what my mother did or did not do), what I used and what it did, and the patterns I am afraid of repeating. Ten lines at most. Then circle the one you skipped. That is where the work is, and we are coming back to it slowly. You are allowed to leave a list blank today.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What are the main titles under what happened?

2. What are the titles under what I used?

3. What pattern am I most afraid of repeating?

SOFT ACTION

Write your three lists. Circle the skipped one. Do not write about it yet.

SUPPLICATION

God, search me, not to punish me but to lead me. Show me where to start, and not more than I can hold. Amen.

Naming it is the beginning of the end of its power over me.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 139:23-24

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Inventory: Mother, Father, Me

BEFORE I STARTED

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1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Search me, O God, and know my heart! Try me and know my thoughts! And see if there is any grievous way in me, and lead me in the way everlasting!”

Psalms 139:23-24 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You are allowed to take your time with your own list.
Nobody is grading it.

“The LORD is near to all who call on him, to all who call on him in truth.”

Ps 145:18 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

A list is not a confession. It is a way to stop carrying it all in your head.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to organize the weight instead of just carrying it.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I am sure the list is shorter than it feels today. Most things are, once they are on paper.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Medical Before Mystical

TODAY'S GOAL

Ask the practical questions: sleep, body, medication, safety, and professional help.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • JEREMIAH 8:22 (ESV)

Jeremiah 8:22 asks, “Is there no balm in Gilead? Is there no physician there? Why then has the health of the daughter of my people not been restored?” Gilead was known for healing balm. Jeremiah is grieving that help existed and the people were not being healed. The verse is not telling anyone to skip medicine. It is lamenting an unhealed wound.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

A Cochrane review concluded that exercise is moderately more effective than no treatment for depression symptoms, although the quality of evidence varies. Exercise is not a replacement for therapy or medication when those are needed.

Source: Cooney et al., 2013. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write down when you last had a medical check-up, a dental visit, a blood test, or talked to a counselor.
- 2 ☐ Circle one overdue thing. Write how you will start: “Call _____ on _____.”
- 3 ☐ Write your top three sleep problems (falling asleep, staying asleep, nightmares). Underline one to bring up with a doctor.
- 4 ☐ If you take medication, write one question you have about it. Do not stop or change it on your own.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration. Put the appointment in your phone before you close this book.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · ADDICTION

Feel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

JEREMIAH 8:22 · ESV

Before you decide something is demonic, ask a doctor. Early trauma changes how the body handles stress, and addiction changes the brain, so sleep, mood, anxiety, and craving can feel like attack. Look for a therapist trained in trauma (approaches like EMDR or trauma-focused therapy are options), a doctor who understands addiction, and a recovery community. If you are physically dependent on alcohol, benzodiazepines, or barbiturates, withdrawal can be deadly; do not stop alone. Prayer and medicine are not enemies.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What have I been calling spiritual that might also be physical?

2. What appointment have I been avoiding?

3. Who could go with me?

SOFT ACTION

Make the call or book the appointment today. If you are in crisis, call or text 988.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, You made healers. Give me the courage to ask for help and the humility to take it. Amen.

Treating my body is stewardship, not a lack of faith.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: JEREMIAH 8:22

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Medical Before Mystical

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Is there no balm in Gilead? Is there no physician there? Why then has the health of the daughter of my people not been restored?”

Jeremiah 8:22 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Going to the doctor is not a lack of faith. It is how some of the help arrives.

“He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds.”

Ps 147:3 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

God made physicians and God made your body. Using them is not a lack of faith.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to treat my body like it matters.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you went. Taking yourself to the doctor is a spiritual act, too. Bodies are not the enemy of faith.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

A Date, and a Reason Bigger Than Fear

TODAY'S GOAL

Set a start date, a reason bigger than fear, and one person who knows.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • PROVERBS 4:26 (ESV)

Proverbs 4:26 says, "Ponder the path of your feet; then all your ways will be sure." Proverbs is a collection of wisdom sayings, many of them written as a father instructing his child. Here the instruction is to pay attention to where you are walking, which is a call to be deliberate.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

A study that tracked people forming a new daily habit found that it took anywhere from about 18 to 254 days to feel automatic, with a typical figure of about 66 days. Missing a single day did not ruin the process.

Source: Lally et al., 2010. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write today's date at the top of a card. Write a start date for your daily practice time (same time, same place).
- 2 ☐ Write your reason in one sentence. It has to be bigger than "because I should."
- 3 ☐ Choose one person to tell. Write their name.
- 4 ☐ Send them a text: "I'm doing 90 days of something hard. Will you check on me on day 10, 30, and 60?"
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration. Put the card on your mirror or fridge.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

ADDICTION · CYCLE-BREAKING

Hold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.*

PROVERBS 4:26 · ESV

Someday is a comfortable word. A date is a decision. If you are ready to stop using, pick the date, clear the first seventy-two hours, remove what needs removing, and tell three people. Add the reason: you do not want to carry on what was handed to you. That reason is bigger than fear, and it can hold you when a craving is loud. If medical detox is needed, do it first; call SAMHSA at 1-800-662-4357.

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Date: ___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What date am I willing to write down?

2. Who are my three people?

3. What is the reason that is bigger than my fear?

SOFT ACTION

Write the date, three names, and the reason on one card.

SUPPLICATION

Father, I am tired of someday. Give me a date, a plan, people, and a reason that holds. Amen.

I am not waiting for someday. I am choosing a day.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PROVERBS 4:26

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

A Date, and a Reason Bigger Than Fear

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Ponder the path of your feet; then all your ways will be sure.”

Proverbs 4:26 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Ten days in. You have already outlasted a lot of promises you made yourself. Keep going.

“The steadfast love of the LORD never ceases; his mercies never come to an end; they are new every morning; great is your faithfulness.”

Lam 3:22–23 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Habits aren't built by mood. They are built by showing up, imperfectly, in the same spot.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose a time, a place, and a witness.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, you did the first ten. That is already a streak most people never see. Look at the card on your wall.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

ARC 1 REVIEW

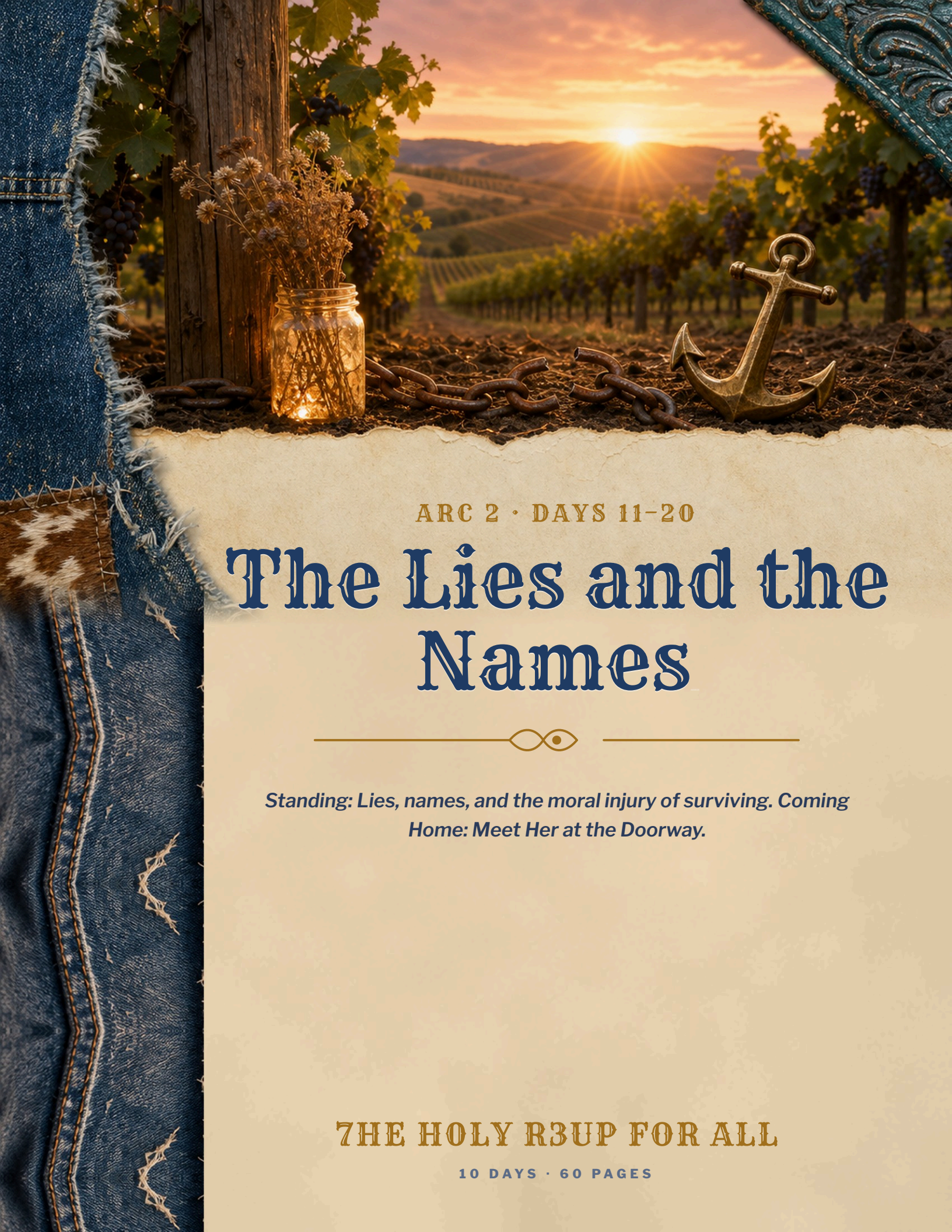
Looking Back: Telling the Truth

A few honest lines before you turn the page. This sheet also keeps each arc starting on a fresh sheet of paper for your binder.

WHAT DID I TELL THE TRUTH ABOUT IN THIS ARC?

WHAT WAS HARDEST, AND WHAT HELPED?

WHAT DO I WANT TO CARRY INTO THE NEXT ARC?



ARC 2 • DAYS 11-20

The Lies and the Names



Standing: Lies, names, and the moral injury of surviving. Coming Home: Meet Her at the Doorway.

THE HOLY R3UP FOR ALL

10 DAYS • 60 PAGES

What Your Mother Taught Without Words

TODAY'S GOAL

See one thing your home taught without words, and name what you would teach instead.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · JOHN 8:32 (ESV)

In John 8:31–36 Jesus speaks to people who had believed in him: “If you abide in my word, you are truly my disciples, and you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free.” In the very next lines he says that everyone who sins is a slave to sin and that “if the Son sets you free, you will be free indeed.” Truth here is tied to Jesus himself and to staying with his word.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Attachment researchers have found that some adults who had difficult childhoods can describe them honestly and coherently and still have secure relationships in adulthood. The term is “earned security.” It suggests that the past shapes us without sealing our future.

Source: Roisman et al., 2002. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the sentence: “In my house, nobody ever said it out loud, but the rule was _____.” Fill it in three different ways.
- 2 ☐ Pick one. Write the opposite rule that you want for your life now.
- 3 ☐ Say the new rule out loud once.
- 4 ☐ Write one small action you did today that fits the new rule, even if it is tiny.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

MOTHER WOUND · CHILDHOOD

Name three things you can see and one thing you can hear. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.*

JOHN 8:32 · ESV

Trauma does not only hurt. It teaches. Without a word, you may have learned that love comes with harm, that people who should protect you will not, that you are not worth protecting, and that relief is something you find on your own. Those lessons were installed when you were too small to argue. You may be living by house rules from a house that burned down. The work is not to hate the lessons but to notice them.

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SACRED REFLECTION

1. What did I learn about love and safety before I could speak?

2. Which lesson shows up in my relationships or my addiction?

3. What would I tell a child who had learned it?

SOFT ACTION

Underline the lesson that frightens you most. Write beside it, "I was taught this. I can unlearn it."

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You are the truth. Show me the lessons I took on, and replace them with what is real. Amen.

I learned it under pressure. I am allowed to unlearn it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Visit Her at the Doorway

RETURN TO HER

Set a ten-minute timer. In your imagination, stand at the doorway of a room at an age you already know about. Do not go in. Just see her from the door: what is she doing? Do not fix anything. When the timer rings, say, "I will come back," take your landing, and write three words for what you saw. This is prayerful imagination, not a memory test.

ANCHOR: PSALM 139:12

PRAYER

Jesus, stand at the door with me. Let me see
only what I can bear.

AFFIRMATION

*I can look at her from the doorway and
come back safe.*

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- After your visit, take a short walk outside and name five colors.

Swap the step for something small and kind: water, a snack, a stretch. That is practice too.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

What Your Mother Taught Without Words

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"...and you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free."

John 8:32 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

What you learned in that house was real. What you choose now is real too, and it is yours.

"Your word is a lamp to my feet and a light to my path."

Ps 119:105 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

What was never said still got learned.

What is said now can be learned too.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to speak the rule I want to live by.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope the new rule is a habit by now. If it still feels strange, that is how a new language feels at first.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Lie, Evidence, Truth: "I Wasn't Worth Protecting"

TODAY'S GOAL

Write one lie, the evidence against it, and the truth, in a three-line row.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · 2 CORINTHIANS 10:4-5 (ESV)

In 2 Corinthians 10:3–5 Paul is defending his ministry to a church that had doubts about him. He says, “the weapons of our warfare are not of the flesh but have divine power to destroy strongholds,” and speaks of taking every thought captive to obey Christ. The battle in this passage is over arguments and thoughts, not over bodies or people.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Cognitive therapy, which teaches people to check their thoughts against evidence, has been shown in clinical trials to help with depression and anxiety. Checking a thought is different from arguing with it, which usually feeds it.

Source: Gross, 2002. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the lie in the first line: “I wasn’t worth protecting.”
- 2 ☐ Second line, “Evidence against this:” list two facts. For example, “I was an infant,” “Infants are not responsible for protecting themselves.”
- 3 ☐ Third line, “What Scripture says:” write the verse reference from today’s page and put it in your own words.
- 4 ☐ Read all three lines aloud in order.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · MOTHER WOUND

Put a hand on your chest and let one long breath out. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.*

2 CORINTHIANS 10:4-5 · ESV

Paul's weapons are truth, arguments answered, thoughts brought to Christ. Take the lie: I was not worth protecting. Ask who taught it. The evidence you have used is that no one stopped it. But a person's failure to protect you says everything about them and nothing about your worth. Now find one piece of evidence against it, and write the truth you choose instead. God is called the defender of the helpless. Do not give the Sunday School answer. Give the real one.

Date:

___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Lie one, in my own words:

2. One piece of evidence against it:

3. The truth I choose, and where Scripture says it:

SOFT ACTION

Say the truth aloud to the mirror once today. It will feel awkward. Do it anyway.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, I bring this thought to You instead of agreeing with it. Teach me what is true. Amen.

I am not arguing with a lie. I am replacing it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: JOHN 8:32

I can listen to what she believed without believing it myself.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Lie, Evidence, Truth: "I Wasn't Worth Protecting"

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“For the weapons of our warfare are not of the flesh but have divine power to destroy strongholds. We destroy arguments and every lofty opinion raised against the knowledge of God, and take every thought captive to obey Christ,”

2 Corinthians 10:4-5 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You can check a thought before you obey it. That one skill changes more than you think.

“Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and do not lean on your own understanding. In all your ways acknowledge him, and he will make straight your paths.”

Prov 3:5-6 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You do not have to win an argument with a lie. You just have to stop signing its paperwork.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose evidence over echo.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I wonder how many of those lies have lost their grip by now. If one is still stubborn, we have a plan: lie, evidence, truth, repeat.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

The Names You Were Given

TODAY'S GOAL

Write down the names you were called, and hand them back.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · ISAIAH 43:1 (ESV)

Isaiah 43:1 comes in the middle of God's word to Israel after the Babylonian exile was announced: "But now thus says the LORD, he who created you... 'Fear not, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by name, you are mine.'" In Scripture, to be called by name means to be known and claimed. The promise was spoken to a people, and Christians read it as the character of the God who calls his own.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Self-compassion researchers have linked treating yourself kindly, remembering you are not alone in suffering, and noticing pain without exaggerating it to lower depression and anxiety. In one trial, an eight-week self-compassion program improved well-being compared with a waiting list.

Source: Neff, 2003. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write three names or labels you were called growing up. Write who said each one.
- 2 ☐ Under each write: "That was their word, not mine."
- 3 ☐ Write one name God uses in Scripture for those who are his (child, beloved, redeemed, called).
- 4 ☐ Say that name out loud, then say, "That is what I answer to."
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

CHILDHOOD · MOTHER WOUND

Look around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

ISAIAH 43:1 · ESV

Somebody named you and you answered. Damaged. The addict's daughter. Too much. Not enough. The one who is just like her. A name given in someone's worst moment can follow you for decades, and a family that cannot name its own harm often names the child instead. God gives names in love. Whatever you answer to will run your life, so it is worth asking who gave it to you and whether they had the right.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which name have I answered to longest?

2. Who gave it to me?

3. Does God agree with it?

SOFT ACTION

Write the old name on a slip of paper. Do not tear it up yet. Just see it from the outside.

SUPPLICATION

Father, You called me by name before anyone else did. Help me hear Yours louder than theirs. Amen.

I belong to God. My name is not the worst thing that was said about me.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: ISAIAH 43:1

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Names You Were Given

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"But now thus says the LORD, he who created you, O Jacob, he who formed you, O Israel: "Fear not, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by name, you are mine.""

Isaiah 43:1 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Somebody gave you names that did not fit. I would like you to try on some that do.

"Fear not, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by name, you are mine."

Isa 43:1 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

The names we carry often belong to somebody else's pain.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to answer to the name God gives.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you have a name now that fits. If you still flinch at the old ones, remember they were handed to you. You can put them down.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Trading Names

TODAY'S GOAL

Choose a new name or phrase and practice answering to it.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · REVELATION 2:17 (ESV)

Revelation 2:17 is part of Jesus's message to the church in Pergamum: "To the one who conquers I will give some of the hidden manna, and I will give him a white stone, with a new name written on the stone that no one knows except the one who receives it." The meaning of the white stone is debated by scholars. What is clear is the picture of being personally known and renamed by Jesus.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

In a study on writing about life goals, people who wrote for a few days about their best possible future selves reported better well-being afterward than people who wrote about neutral topics. It is a small effect, and it works best when the writing is realistic.

Source: King, 2001. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write down three words you would want someone to use for you in five years (for example, steady, tender, brave).
- 2 ☐ Pick one as your word for this week. Write it on a card.
- 3 ☐ Say, "My word is _____. I am practicing it." Out loud once.
- 4 ☐ Write one small thing you did today that matches the word.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · CHILDHOOD

Press your palms together, then let go. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

REVELATION 2:17 · ESV

God renames people: Abram to Abraham, Jacob to Israel, Simon to Peter. His names point at who you are becoming. Trading names is not positive thinking. It is putting a new truth where the old one lived. Daughter of an addicted mother becomes daughter of God. Damaged goods becomes new creation. Addict becomes a woman in recovery. Cycle-breaker is a name you get to earn, a day at a time. Say the new one out loud each morning for thirty days.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. The name I am putting down:

2. The name I am choosing, and where Scripture says it:

3. Who will help me remember it?

SOFT ACTION

Write the new name where you will see it every morning.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, I give You the old name. Teach me to answer to the one You give. Amen.

I answer to what God calls me, not what they called me.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: REVELATION 2:17

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Trading Names

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“...To the one who conquers I will give some of the hidden manna, and I will give him a white stone, with a new name written on the stone that no one knows except the one who receives it.”

Revelation 2:17 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

A new name is not a costume. It is a direction you are allowed to face.

“Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away; behold, the new has come.”

2 Cor 5:17 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

A new name is not a costume. It is a direction you start walking.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose a word to grow toward.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, what word did you pick? I hope it is one that other people use about you now.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

It Was Not Your Fault. You Were Six Months Old.

TODAY'S GOAL

Say it to yourself in the words you would say to a baby: "It was not your fault."

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · PSALM 103:13 (ESV)

Psalm 103:13 says, "As a father shows compassion to his children, so the LORD shows compassion to those who fear him." The psalm is attributed to David and praises God for forgiving, healing, and redeeming. It also says, "He knows our frame; he remembers that we are dust" (v. 14). God knows how small and fragile we are.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Self-compassion studies suggest that speaking to yourself with the kindness you would give a friend is linked to lower self-criticism and less shame. It can feel odd and unearned at first, which is normal.

Source: Neff, 2003. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Find a photo of yourself as a baby or small child, or picture one. If you have none, write "baby me" on a card.
- 2 ☐ Hold it for 30 seconds. Say, "It was not your fault."
- 3 ☐ Say it again slower. Notice your breath.
- 4 ☐ If you feel overwhelmed, stop and press your feet on the floor.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration and finish with a glass of water.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

It Was Not Your Fault. You Were Six Months Old.

CHILDHOOD · MOTHER WOUND

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Sit with your back against something solid. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

"As a father shows compassion to his children, so the LORD shows compassion to those who fear him."

PSALM 103:13 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

A baby cannot consent, cannot run, cannot tell, cannot choose. A body that responds physically under harm is not agreeing. Shame built a city on that lie. And your mother's failure to stop it was her failure, not yours. Notice how God meets you: not with a lecture but with compassion, the way a father does for his child. Take your name off a crime you did not commit.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

DAY 15 · IT WAS NOT YOUR FAULT. YOU WERE SIX MONTHS OLD.

Date:

___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What am I still blaming myself for that was never a choice?

2. What do I want to say to a baby who was hurt?

3. What would God say to her?

SOFT ACTION

Say it aloud, as if to a baby you love: "It was not your fault." Then say it to yourself.

SUPPLICATION

Father, You are not angry at the baby I was. Take the blame she picked up and give her compassion. Amen.

I am taking my name off a crime I did not commit.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 103:13

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

It Was Not Your Fault. You Were Six Months Old.

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“As a father shows compassion to his children, so the LORD shows compassion to those who fear him.”

Psalms 103:13 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You were six months old. Say it again slower. You were six months old.

“How precious is your steadfast love, O God! The children of mankind take refuge in the shadow of your wings.”

Psalms 36:7 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

A six-month-old cannot be at fault.

This is not opinion. It is a fact.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to believe what is true about her.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I am hoping you can say that sentence without flinching and mean it. If you cannot yet, tomorrow is not too late.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Why You Went Back

TODAY'S GOAL

Understand why you went back, without calling yourself stupid.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · LUKE 22:31-32 (ESV)

In Luke 22:31–32 Jesus tells Peter at the Last Supper, “Simon, Simon, behold, Satan demanded to have you, that he might sift you like wheat, but I have prayed for you that your faith may not fail. And when you have turned again, strengthen your brothers.” Jesus says “when,” not “if,” and he knows Peter is about to fail. He prays for him ahead of time and gives him a future.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Researchers who study how people change describe it as a loop with relapses, not a straight line. Many people who eventually change a deep habit go through the cycle several times. It does not make the attempts worthless.

Source: Prochaska & DiClemente, 1983. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the last time you went back (to a person, a place, a substance, a belief). Just the facts, in one sentence.
- 2 ☐ Write what you were hoping to get. Common answers: comfort, belonging, numbness, being chosen.
- 3 ☐ Write what it actually cost you.
- 4 ☐ Write one need you could meet a different way this week.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration. Say, “I am turning again.”

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

Why You Went Back

ADDICTION · MOTHER WOUND

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Take a slow sip of water. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.*

"Simon, Simon, behold, Satan demanded to have you, that he might sift you like wheat, but I have prayed for you that your faith may not fail. And when you have turned again, strengthen your brothers."

LUKE 22:31-32 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

When the first people in your life were unsafe, unsafe can feel like home. Peter failed and went back, and Jesus had already prayed for him and named what came after: when you have turned again. Why you went back to the substance, to people who hurt you, to your mother or your father: it was familiar, it worked, you had no other options, or you hoped it would be different this time. Most people try more than once. The turning again is the story.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What did I go back to, and what did it give me?

2. What was I hoping would be different?

3. What do I believe Jesus prayed for me?

SOFT ACTION

Write, "I went back because..." with no excuses and no punishment. Then write, "And I am turning again."

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You prayed for Peter before he fell. Pray for me. Strengthen me for the turning. Amen.

I was in a trap built to hold. Leaving late is still leaving.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: LUKE 22:31-32

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Why You Went Back

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Simon, Simon, behold, Satan demanded to have you, that he might sift you like wheat, but I have prayed for you that your faith may not fail. And when you have turned again, strengthen your brothers.”

Luke 22:31-32 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You went back because you were hungry for something good. Now we help you find it where it is safe.

“And he arose and came to his father. But while he was still a long way off, his father saw him and felt compassion, and ran and embraced him and kissed him.”

Luke 15:20 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Going back is information. It tells you what you were reaching for.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to learn from the return trip.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you can say “turned again” without shame now. Peter did. So did every person God has ever used.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Missing the Ones Who Hurt You

TODAY'S GOAL

Let yourself miss the people who hurt you, without going back to them.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · PSALM 107:9 (ESV)

Psalm 107 is a song of thanks for God's rescue of people in different kinds of trouble: wanderers, prisoners, the sick, sailors in storms. Verse 9 says, "For he satisfies the longing soul, and the hungry soul he fills with good things." The refrain, "Let them thank the LORD for his steadfast love," returns after each rescue. Longing is treated as real and God as the one who meets it.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Putting a mixed feeling into words ("I miss him and I am angry at him") is linked to lower emotional intensity in lab studies of affect labeling. Mixed feelings are normal after harm, and they do not mean you should return.

Source: Lieberman et al., 2007. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write two sentences: "I miss _____ because _____." and "I do not miss _____ because _____."
- 2 ☐ Say both aloud. Notice that you can feel both without choosing one.
- 3 ☐ Write one thing that satisfied you today that did not involve them (food, music, sunshine, a laugh).
- 4 ☐ If the longing gets very loud, text a safe person: "I'm missing something I shouldn't go back to."
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

MOTHER WOUND · ADDICTION

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"For he satisfies the longing soul, and the hungry soul he fills with good things."

PSALM 107:9 · ESV

You can miss a mother who did not protect you. You can miss a father who harmed you. You can miss the high. Longing for a parent does not mean the parent was good; it means you were a child who needed one. Cruelty and tenderness on an unpredictable schedule bond people harder than steady kindness. Missing is not evidence you should go back. It is evidence that something in you is still hungry, and God fills the hungry.

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SACRED REFLECTION

1. What do I actually miss: them, or what I needed from them?

2. What hunger is under it?

3. What safe thing could feed that hunger today?

SOFT ACTION

When the missing hits, say, "This is hunger, not a sign." Then eat, drink water, and call a safe person.

SUPPLICATION

God, I am hungry and tired of feeding it with what hurts. Fill the place only You can fill. Amen.

What I feel is real. It is not a reason to go back.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 107:9

God, You satisfy the longing soul. Give her what is good and safe.

What I long for is not shameful. I can feed it safely.

□ Give someone a real hug today, or hug a pillow while you breathe.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Missing the Ones Who Hurt You

BEFORE I STARTED

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WHEN I FINISHED

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Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"For he satisfies the longing soul, and the hungry soul he fills with good things."

Psalms 107:9 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Missing them does not make you weak. It makes you someone who loved. Love is not the problem.

"When the cares of my heart are many, your consolations cheer my soul."

Psalms 94:19 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Missing someone is not the same as needing them.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to honor the longing without obeying it.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope the missing has softened. If it has not, you still got through it again this time.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

No Memory, No Problem

TODAY'S GOAL

Make peace with the gaps in your memory.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · PSALM 139:12 (ESV)

Psalm 139:12 says, “even the darkness is not dark to you; the night is bright as the day, for darkness is as light with you.” The whole psalm is David’s meditation on being known by God from before birth. The verse does not say you must remember. It says nothing is hidden from him.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Dan Siegel’s “window of tolerance” describes the zone where a person can feel and think at the same time. Many trauma-informed therapists work on widening that window in the present rather than pressing for memories. It is one model among several.

Source: Siegel, 1999. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write: “What I know for sure about my early life is _____.” Two or three lines.
- 2 ☐ Write: “What I don’t know, and may never know, is _____.”
- 3 ☐ Say, “I do not have to remember to heal.”
- 4 ☐ Put a hand on your chest. Take five slow breaths.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration. Do not go looking for anything today.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

CHILDHOOD · WARFARE

Hold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.*

PSALM 139:12 · ESV

You cannot remember being six months old, and you do not need to. You know what you know from what family told you, from your body, from patterns you live with. You are not lying and you are not making it up. Do not push for memory; do not let anyone lead you to "recover" scenes. A trauma-informed counselor can help you work with what the body holds without scripts. God sees the parts you cannot, and the grief of not knowing is real.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What do I know, and how do I know it?

2. What do I wish I could remember, or wish I could un-know?

3. What would it mean to let "enough" be enough?

SOFT ACTION

Write one line: "I know that ___. I do not need to know more to heal."

SUPPLICATION

Lord, the dark is not dark to You. Hold what I cannot hold. Give me grace for the gaps. Amen.

I do not need perfect memory to tell the truth or to be loved.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 139:12

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

No Memory, No Problem

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“even the darkness is not dark to you; the night is bright as the day, for darkness is as light with you.”

Psalms 139:12 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You do not have to remember everything to be healing.
Your body is not asking for a file. It is asking for safety.

“Trust in him at all times, O people; pour out your heart before him; God is a refuge for us.”

Psalms 62:8 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You do not need a complete file to be a whole person.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose present safety over past evidence.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you stopped treating the missing pieces like a debt you owe. You are allowed to build a life on what you have.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

What You Did While Surviving

TODAY'S GOAL

Name what you did to survive, without lying and without self-hatred.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · 1 TIMOTHY 1:15 (ESV)

In 1 Timothy 1:15 Paul writes to Timothy in Ephesus, "The saying is trustworthy and deserving of full acceptance, that Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners, of whom I am the foremost." Paul says this about a man who had persecuted the church. He names what he did and builds his life on grace anyway.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Studies of shame and guilt in people with substance problems have found that shame-prone people tend to do worse over time, while guilt ("I did something wrong, and I want to repair it") is linked to better outcomes. How we name what we did matters.

Source: Tangney & Dearing, 2002. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ List three things you did to survive that you do not like. One line each.
- 2 ☐ Next to each write what you were protecting yourself from.
- 3 ☐ Mark each with "Own it" (needs repair) or "Understand it" (it was survival).
- 4 ☐ For any "Own it," write one small repair, such as an apology you can send or an amends you can plan.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What did I do that I cannot reconcile with who I wanted to be?

2. Who did it touch?

3. What part is guilt I can bring to Jesus, and what part is shame that lies?

SOFT ACTION

Write it in one line. Beneath it write, "Jesus came for people like me."

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You came for sinners, and I am one. Take what I cannot carry, and lead me to repair what I can. Amen.

I did that. It was mine. Jesus paid for it. I stop punishing someone He pardoned.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: 1 TIMOTHY 1:15

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

What You Did While Surviving

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“The saying is trustworthy and deserving of full acceptance, that Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners, of whom I am the foremost.”

1 Timothy 1:15 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

What you did to live through it was not your whole self. Take responsibility where it is yours and be kind where it is not.

“See what kind of love the Father has given to us, that we should be called children of God; and so we are.”

1 John 3:1 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Understanding is not excusing, and excusing is not required for understanding.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose honesty without cruelty.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you can read that list with kindness and accuracy. Some of those things were survival. Some need repair. Both can be true.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Living Amends, and Forgiving Yourself

TODAY'S GOAL

Plan one living amends and one act of self-forgiveness.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · PROVERBS 28:13 (ESV)

Proverbs 28:13 says, "Whoever conceals his transgressions will not prosper, but he who confesses and forsakes them will obtain mercy." It sits in a section the book itself says was copied by the men of Hezekiah (Proverbs 25:1). Notice the two verbs: confess and forsake. Mercy follows both.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

A meta-analysis of forgiveness programs found that people who took part reported more forgiveness and less distress than people who did not. Forgiving someone is not the same as reconciling with them.

Source: Wade et al., 2014. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the name of someone you owe an amends. If it is not safe to contact them, write what you would do instead (a letter you do not send, a changed behavior).
- 2 ☐ Write one sentence of the amends: "I am sorry for _____. I will _____ from now on."
- 3 ☐ Write one thing you need to forgive yourself for. Say, "I release myself from carrying this alone."
- 4 ☐ Pick a day this week to act. Put it on the calendar.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

ADDICTION · CYCLE-BREAKING

Put a hand on your chest and let one long breath out. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

PROVERBS 28:13 · ESV

When you cannot undo the harm, you live differently where the harm lives. Amends are mostly shown: showing up when you said you would, telling the truth, not asking people to take care of your feelings, and not demanding their forgiveness. Where a person is gone or contact is unsafe, serve where that damage lives. And forgive yourself, not because you deserve it but because God decided it. You cannot walk out of the prison while you are still the warden.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Who needs repair from me, and what would honest repair look like?

2. Where is repair unsafe, and what could I do instead?

3. What am I still collecting from myself that God already settled?

SOFT ACTION

Choose one promise you can keep this week, however small, and keep it.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, make me someone who shows up. Where I cannot repair, use me where the damage lives. Amen.

I make amends by becoming someone who does not do that anymore.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Forgive Her

You can forgive her, and God already has. At the doorway, say: "I forgive you for what you had to do." If you cannot yet, say: "I am willing to be willing." Then write one sentence of what you will do differently, as her protector.

PRAYER

Father, I take myself out of my own prison. Be the judge, and let it be settled.

AFFIRMATION

I forgive her, and God has already forgiven me.

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ☐ Wear or carry something that makes you feel like yourself today.

If this stirs up more than you can hold, do your landing (warm drink, a walk, a text) and come back tomorrow.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Living Amends, and Forgiving Yourself

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Whoever conceals his transgressions will not prosper, but he who confesses and forsakes them will obtain mercy.”

Proverbs 28:13 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

An amends is a long walk with small steps. Take one this week.

“And let us not grow weary of doing good, for in due season we will reap, if we do not give up.”

Gal 6:9 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Forgiveness is a decision. Trust is rebuilt. They are not the same thing.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose repair over replay.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you followed through. Amends are lived, not just said.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

ARC 2 REVIEW

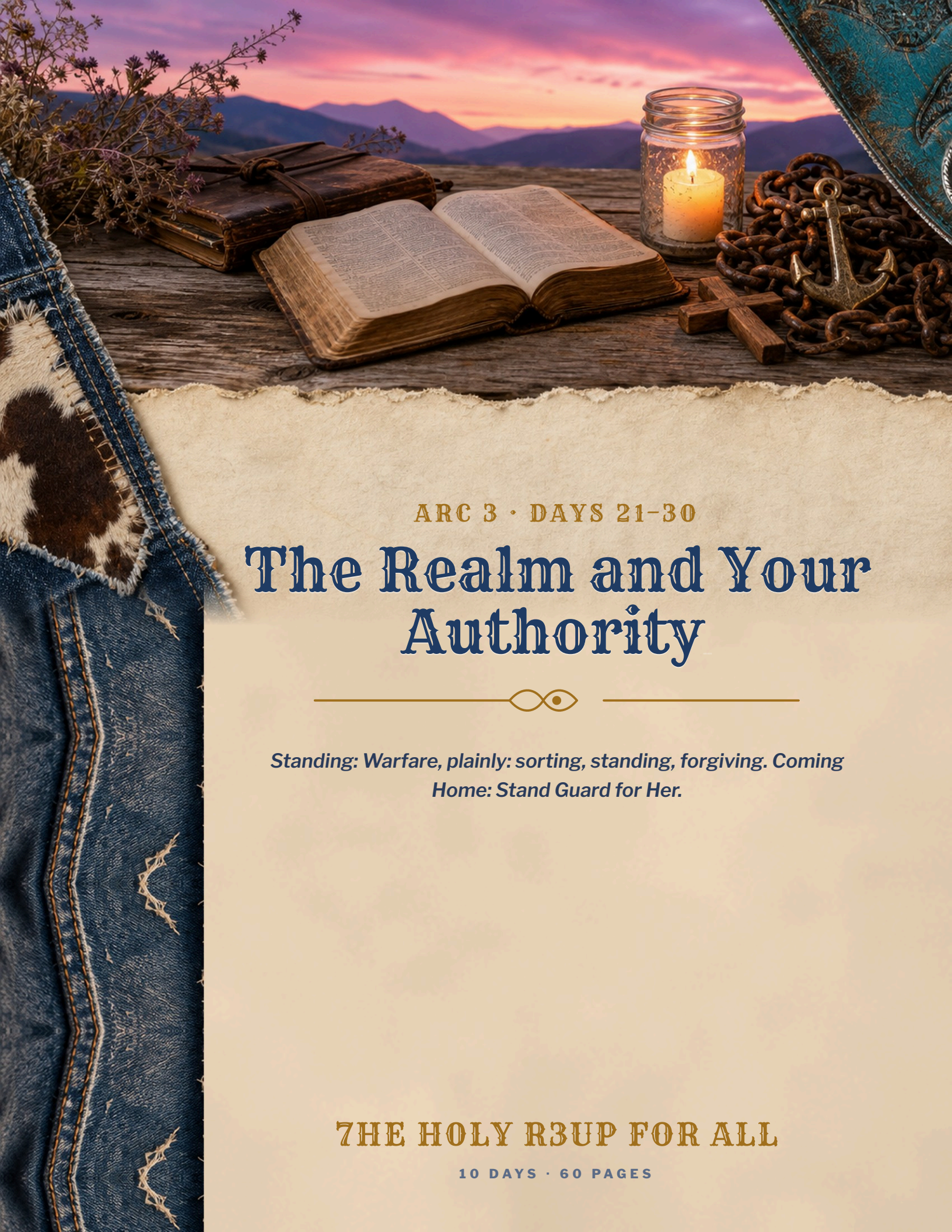
Looking Back: The Lies and the Names

A few honest lines before you turn the page. This sheet also keeps each arc starting on a fresh sheet of paper for your binder.

WHAT DID I TELL THE TRUTH ABOUT IN THIS ARC?

WHAT WAS HARDEST, AND WHAT HELPED?

WHAT DO I WANT TO CARRY INTO THE NEXT ARC?



ARC 3 • DAYS 21-30

The Realm and Your Authority



Standing: Warfare, plainly: sorting, standing, forgiving. Coming Home: Stand Guard for Her.

THE HOLY R3UP FOR ALL

10 DAYS • 60 PAGES

Two Realms, One Family

TODAY'S GOAL

Practice holding two realities: what you see, and what you cannot.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · 2 CORINTHIANS 4:18 (ESV)

In 2 Corinthians 4:16–18 Paul writes that “we do not lose heart,” and that “as we look not to the things that are seen but to the things that are unseen. For the things that are seen are transient, but the things that are unseen are eternal.” He is writing from deep affliction. The unseen realm is described as real and lasting, not as a place to hunt for threats.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Research on rumination suggests that repetitive worry about causes and meanings tends to deepen distress and does not solve the problem. A deliberate shift to a concrete action or to something you can see and touch is often more useful.

Source: Nolen-Hoeksema et al., 2008. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write: “Things I can see and touch right now: _____.” Name five.
- 2 ☐ Write: “Things I believe are true but cannot see: _____.” Name two or three, such as God’s presence, that I am forgiven, that this will end.
- 3 ☐ Say, “Both are real. I will not chase the unseen to prove it.”
- 4 ☐ Do one tangible, ordinary thing (wash a dish, fold a towel) as an act of faith in the visible world.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · MOTHER WOUND

Look around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

2 CORINTHIANS 4:18 · ESV

Spiritual warfare is not only for conferences. It meets us in a family where addiction, abuse, and silence ran for years: in what you believe about yourself, in cravings, in who you are drawn to. Scripture treats the unseen opposition as real and limited, and treats ordinary faithfulness as how we stand. You are not imagining what you lived through, and you do not have to make the fight dramatic. You have to show up, tell the truth, and keep Jesus near. People are not demons; the harm done through them was still wrong.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Where do I see the fight in ordinary moments?

2. What have I called "just my personality" that might be something else?

3. How could I meet it with something simple?

SOFT ACTION

Pick one ordinary moment today and pray one sentence in it.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, You are in my ordinary day. Teach me to see what is going on beneath the noise, and to stand there with You. Amen.

I am not imagining what I have been through, and I am not fighting it alone.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 139:12

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- You can do the prayer and skip the step. That still counts.*

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Two Realms, One Family

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"...as we look not to the things that are seen but to the things that are unseen. For the things that are seen are transient, but the things that are unseen are eternal."

2 Corinthians 4:18 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You can believe in a world you cannot see without being scared of every shadow in this one.

"Do not be anxious about anything, but in everything by prayer and supplication with thanksgiving let your requests be made known to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus."

Phil 4:6-7 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You can believe in an unseen realm without searching every shadow for it.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose attention over alarm.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope your faith has room for both the seen and the unseen without making you jumpy. Peace is a sign of presence, not proof of absence.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Four Categories at 2 a.m.

TODAY'S GOAL

Sort what scares you into four plain categories.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · 1 THESSALONIANS 5:21 (ESV)

First Thessalonians 5:21 says, “but test everything; hold fast what is good.” Paul is closing a letter to a young church in Thessalonica and has just said, “Do not despise prophecies” (v. 20). The instruction is to evaluate carefully, not to believe everything and not to dismiss everything.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Cognitive reappraisal, which means looking at a situation again and asking what else could explain it, has been associated with healthier emotion outcomes than suppressing the feeling. Sorting is a form of reappraisal.

Source: Gross, 2002. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the thing that scares you at night in one line.
- 2 ☐ Check one: Is it (1) a body/medical thing, (2) a memory or trauma response, (3) a real-world danger, or (4) a spiritual concern I should pray and test?
- 3 ☐ Match it to a next step: doctor, grounding and a counselor, a safety plan, or prayer and a trusted pastor.
- 4 ☐ Write the next step and when you will do it.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · ADDICTION

Press your palms together, then let go. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.*

1 THESSALONIANS 5:21 · ESV

When something is tormenting you, sort it. What part is body and chemistry (sleep, withdrawal, anxiety)? What part is wound (the old fear)? What part is flesh, your untrained appetite, which needs discipline, not deliverance? What part might be spiritual? Now you have four assignments instead of one impossible one. A craving is usually several at once. Do not label a craving demonic first. Treat the body, tend the wound, build discipline, and bring all of it to God.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What is tormenting me most right now?

2. How would I sort it?

3. Who could help me with each part?

SOFT ACTION

Fill in the four categories for one craving or one fear. Do one small thing under each.

SUPPLICATION

God, give me discernment instead of panic. Teach me to fight the right thing the right way. Amen.

Discernment is not doubt. It is how I stop fighting the wrong thing.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: 1 THESSALONIANS 5:21

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Four Categories at 2 a.m.

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“but test everything; hold fast what is good.”

1 Thessalonians 5:21 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

A scare at 2 a.m. is a scare. Sort it, then sleep. You do not have to solve the whole night.

“I lift up my eyes to the hills. From where does my help come? My help comes from the LORD, who made heaven and earth.”

Ps 121:1–2 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Not everything that feels like an attack is an attack. Not everything that feels like nothing is nothing.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to test before I label.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you learned that not every scare is spiritual and not every scare is only physical. Sorting is wisdom.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

What He Cannot Do

TODAY'S GOAL

Say what the enemy cannot do, using only what Scripture says.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · 1 JOHN 4:4 (ESV)

First John 4:4 says, "Little children, you are from God and have overcome them, for he who is in you is greater than he who is in the world." John is writing to believers about false teachers and about testing spirits (4:1). The "greater" is the Spirit of God in the believer. The verse is not about us being powerful. It is about him.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Albert Bandura's work on self-efficacy suggests that people who believe they can handle a challenge, often because they have handled smaller ones, are more likely to try again after setbacks. Believing you can does not guarantee you will.

Source: Bandura, 1977. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write: "Three things I have already survived that I once thought I could not: _____."
- 2 ☐ Write the verse in your own words: "The One in me is greater than _____."
- 3 ☐ Say it standing up, out loud, once.
- 4 ☐ Write one small hard thing you will do today to prove you can.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · CYCLE-BREAKING

Sit with your back against something solid. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.*

1 JOHN 4:4 · ESV

The enemy is a created being, not God's opposite. He is not everywhere, he cannot read your mind, he cannot make you do anything, and he cannot snatch you from God's hand. Your biggest fear may be that you are destined to become your mother. Scripture does not say that. Patterns are strong, and they are not destiny. God keeps those who are His, and He does not promise a trouble-free life; He promises you will not face it alone or unprotected.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Where has the fear of becoming her been louder than truth?

2. What do I believe about what the enemy can do?

3. What is God asking me to trust Him with?

SOFT ACTION

Write: "I am afraid I will become ___." Then write, "God, this is Yours."

SUPPLICATION

Father, You are greater. I give You the fear I have been carrying like a weapon. Keep what I cannot keep. Amen.

He can build a hallway. He cannot move my feet.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: 1 JOHN 4:4

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

What He Cannot Do

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"Little children, you are from God and have overcome them, for he who is in you is greater than he who is in the world."

1 John 4:4 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You do not have to feel strong to stand on something strong.

"Have I not commanded you? Be strong and courageous. Do not be frightened, and do not be dismayed, for the LORD your God is with you wherever you go."

Josh 1:9 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Your authority is borrowed, and the loan is good.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to stand on what is promised, not on how I feel.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, remember today. You were not strong because you never wavered. You were strong because he was with you when you did.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Standing, Not Cowering

TODAY'S GOAL

Practice standing: feet down, breath slow, words true.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · EPHESIANS 6:13 (ESV)

Ephesians 6:13 says, "Therefore take up the whole armor of God, that you may be able to withstand in the evil day, and having done all, to stand firm." The armor imagery likely echoes what Paul saw on the Roman soldiers guarding him. Notice the goal: stand firm. The armor is mostly defense, and every piece is something God provides.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Slow, controlled breathing is associated with a calmer heart rate and with a sense of steadiness in many studies, though results vary. It is a tool, not a cure.

Source: Zaccaro et al., 2018. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Stand with your feet hip-width. Press them into the floor.
- 2 ☐ Breathe in for 4, out for 6, five times.
- 3 ☐ Say out loud: "I stand on what is true. I do not have to run."
- 4 ☐ Name one thing in your day today that you are tempted to run from. Write what standing would look like.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE

Take a slow sip of water. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.*

EPHESIANS 6:13 · ESV

Notice the verb in Ephesians 6: stand. Colossians 2:15 says Christ disarmed the rulers and authorities and put them to open shame. Authority is not volume or a formula. It is standing where Jesus has already won, and it lets you rest. It is also never a reason to skip a doctor, a counselor, a meeting, or a safety plan. Cowering and charging are both ways of forgetting He already won. You were not protected as a child. You can be, now, by Him and by the people He sends.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Where have I been cowering?

2. Where have I been charging in my own strength?

3. What would standing look like in one situation this week?

SOFT ACTION

Stand up, plant your feet, and say aloud, "I stand in Christ." Hold it ten seconds.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You disarmed what scared me. Help me stand where You already won. Amen.

I am not negotiating with fear. I am standing on what Christ has already won.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: EPHESIANS 6:13

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- If nothing comes, nothing is required. Rest is allowed.*

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Standing, Not Cowering

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Therefore take up the whole armor of God, that you may be able to withstand in the evil day, and having done all, to stand firm.”

Ephesians 6:13 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Standing looks like feet on the floor and one honest sentence. That is enough today.

“but they who wait for the LORD shall renew their strength; they shall mount up with wings like eagles; they shall run and not be weary; they shall walk and not faint.”

Isa 40:31 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

*Standing is not the same as fighting.
It is refusing to be moved.*

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to stay on my feet.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you can find your feet any time you need to. They have been under you the whole time.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Submit, Then Resist

TODAY'S GOAL

Do the verse in order: submit first, then resist.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · JAMES 4:7 (ESV)

James 4:7 says, "Submit yourselves therefore to God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you." James wrote to scattered Jewish Christians, and this verse sits in a passage about pride, worldliness, and humility (4:1–10). Notice the order: submission to God comes first, and resistance rests on that, not on your own strength.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Making specific if-then plans ("If I feel the pull at 9 p.m., I will call my sponsor") helps people carry out intentions more reliably than good intentions alone, according to a large body of work on implementation intentions.

Source: Gollwitzer, 1999. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the temptation or the thought you most often fight on your own.
- 2 ☐ Write a submit sentence: "God, I give this to you: _____. " Say it as a prayer.
- 3 ☐ Write an if-then resist plan: "If _____ happens, then I will _____ (call, leave, pray, drink water, go outside)."
- 4 ☐ Put the plan on your phone as a note.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · ADDICTION

Feel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

JAMES 4:7 · ESV

The order matters. Submit to God first, then resist. For anyone in addiction, submission begins with an honest admission that you cannot do this on willpower, and that is not defeat; it is where help begins. Resisting without submitting is exhausting. Authority is not volume. Jesus answered temptation with a sentence of Scripture. Loud is for our own fear.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What am I trying to handle in my own strength?

2. What would submitting to God look like there?

3. What is one thing I can resist this week once I am under His care?

SOFT ACTION

Say aloud, "I cannot do this alone. Jesus, I am Yours." Then do one resisting thing.

SUPPLICATION

God, I give You my will, my plan, and my pride. Under Your care, I will stand against what harms me. Amen.

I get under God before I stand against anything.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Pray With Her

Teach her a short prayer, in words a child can say: "Jesus, help me. I am Yours." Say it together. Notice that surrender comes first. Then, if there is something to say no to, say it with Him beside you.

PRAYER

God, I give You my will and my plan. Under Your care, I stand.

AFFIRMATION

I can say help, and I can say no.

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- Say your short prayer three times today, once each in the morning, noon, and night.

Too much today? Open your eyes, name five things you see, and stop. Stopping is part of the practice.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Submit, Then Resist

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Submit yourselves therefore to God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you.”

James 4:7 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Handing something over before you push back is not weakness. It is the order that works.

“casting all your anxieties on him, because he cares for you.”

1 Pet 5:7 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Resistance without submission is just white-knuckling.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to hand it over before I push back.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope that plan has been used so many times it does not feel like a plan anymore. Just a reflex.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

What Keeps Getting Fed: Anger at Both Parents

TODAY'S GOAL

Find what is feeding your anger and starve that part, not the person.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · EPHESIANS 4:26-27 (ESV)

Ephesians 4:26–27 says, “Be angry and do not sin; do not let the sun go down on your anger, and give no opportunity to the devil.” Paul is quoting Psalm 4:4 and is not forbidding anger. He is warning about letting it sit and grow. Anger itself is treated as a signal, not as a sin.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Studies on rumination suggest that replaying anger in your head tends to keep it going rather than release it. Doing something physical, writing it out, or talking with someone safe may work better than rehearsing it.

Source: Nolen-Hoeksema et al., 2008. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write what you are angry about. Use hard words if you need. No one will read this.
- 2 ☐ Write what you would want to say to each person, in a letter you will not send.
- 3 ☐ Walk fast for 5 minutes, or squeeze a towel, or do 20 pushes against a wall.
- 4 ☐ Write one boundary you can set that protects you without punishing them.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · MOTHER WOUND

Hold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

EPHESIANS 4:26-27 · ESV

Some struggles keep getting fed by the same things: unforgiveness, lies about yourself, anger left to rot, old vows, substances. Paul says anger is not the problem. Holding it past sundown gives the enemy room. Your anger at your father and your mother is not wrong; it is information that you were wronged. The work is to bring it to God and to safe people, so it does not spill on yourself, on your recovery, or on people who did not cause it.

Date: ___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Where does my anger really belong?

2. How have I been feeding it, knowingly or not?

3. Where can I safely put it?

SOFT ACTION

Name your anger in one line. Then do one physical thing with it: walk hard, scrub something, push a wall.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, You are not afraid of my anger. Take it, and keep it from feeding on me. Amen.

Everything I can name, I can bring to God and begin to change.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Stop Feeding What Scares Her

Name one thing that keeps feeding her fear: a show, a person's social media, a substance, a habit, a late-night scroll. Remove or limit one thing today. Tell her: "I will not feed what hurts you."

ANCHOR: EPHESIANS 4:26-27

Lord, show me what keeps getting fed. Give me strength to stop feeding it.

I can decide what I let in.

- Take a phone-free hour this evening.

If this stirs up more than you can hold, do your landing (warm drink, a walk, a text) and come back tomorrow.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

What Keeps Getting Fed: Anger at Both Parents

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Be angry and do not sin; do not let the sun go down on your anger, and give no opportunity to the devil.”

Ephesians 4:26-27 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Your anger makes sense. Let it move through your body in a way that does not hurt you.

“He brought me out into a broad place; he rescued me, because he delighted in me.”

Ps 18:19 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Anger is a smoke alarm. Do not burn down the house, but do not ignore it either.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to move anger out of my body safely.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope the anger became something you can use for good: a boundary, a decision, a rebuilt life.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Taken In

TODAY'S GOAL

Practice the thought that God takes you in when no one else did.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · PSALM 27:10 (ESV)

Psalm 27:10 says, “For my father and my mother have forsaken me, but the LORD will take me in.” Psalm 27 is a psalm of David about trusting God in danger. The line acknowledges real abandonment and says God receives the one who was abandoned. It does not say that the abandonment was fine.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

A large meta-analysis found that people with stronger social relationships had a lower risk of early death than people with weaker ones. Belonging seems to matter for health, and God’s taking you in is not the only kind of belonging he provides.

Source: Holt-Lunstad et al., 2010. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Read the verse aloud three times, slower each time.
- 2 ☐ Write the two names of people who have been safe for you, even briefly. Add one place, one animal, or one community.
- 3 ☐ Write: “God, take me in. Here is where I feel unsheltered: _____.”
- 4 ☐ Plan one contact with a safe person this week and put it on the calendar.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

MOTHER WOUND · WARFARE

Name three things you can see and one thing you can hear. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

PSALM 27:10 · ESV

Before anything else, get under cover. David knew what it was to be left: his father and mother had forsaken him, and the Lord took him in. You do not have to pretend your parents were safe in order to receive a safe God. Say who you belong to. Say what you cannot do alone. This is not a spell, and it does not guarantee a trouble-free life. It is a child running to the one who is bigger, and being taken in.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Who failed to take me in?

2. What would it mean to be taken in by God?

3. What do I want covered today?

SOFT ACTION

Pray aloud in your own words: "I belong to You. Take me in and cover me today."

SUPPLICATION

Father, You take me in. I run to You. I do not go in uncovered. Amen.

I do not go in alone and I do not go in uncovered.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 91:1-2

Father, You are her refuge. Cover her, and cover me.

I do not go in uncovered.

□ Make your bed carefully tonight like you are preparing a room for a child.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Taken In

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“For my father and my mother have forsaken me, but the LORD will take me in.”

Psalms 27:10 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Somebody should have taken you in sooner. I am glad you are letting Someone do it now.

“He who dwells in the shelter of the Most High will abide in the shadow of the Almighty.”

Psalms 91:1 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Being taken in is not a reward for being easy. It is a gift for being loved.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to let myself be held.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you have a table by now. If not, keep going. There are people you have not met who would pull a chair up for you.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Forgiving a Mother Who Did Not Protect You

TODAY'S GOAL

Start the long, honest work of forgiving without pretending it is done.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · COLOSSIANS 3:13 (ESV)

Colossians 3:13 says, “bearing with one another and, if one has a complaint against another, forgiving each other; as the Lord has forgiven you, so you also must forgive.” Paul is writing to a church about clothing themselves in compassion. Forgiveness here is rooted in what Jesus has done, and it does not erase the “complaint.” The wrong is real.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

In a meta-analysis of forgiveness interventions, people who were helped to forgive reported better outcomes, but the best results came in programs that took time and addressed the emotional experience, not just the decision.

Source: Wade et al., 2014. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the name of the person you are working toward forgiving.
- 2 ☐ Write what you are still angry about. Do not skip it.
- 3 ☐ Write: “I am willing to be willing to forgive. I am not there yet, and that is okay.”
- 4 ☐ Pray: “Jesus, you forgave from the cross. Help me with this one, one inch at a time.”
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration. Do not contact the person unless it is safe and wise.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

MOTHER WOUND · WARFARE

Put a hand on your chest and let one long breath out. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.*

"bearing with one another and, if one has a complaint against another, forgiving each other; as the Lord has forgiven you, so you also must forgive."

COLOSSIANS 3:13 · ESV

Forgiveness is not saying it was okay and not reconciliation. It is releasing the right to collect. A mother who did not protect you, perhaps because of her own trauma and addiction, still did not protect you. Both are true: she may have been hurt and she hurt you. Forgive in pieces if you have to, out loud, one thing at a time, and let God keep the ledger. If she is gone, forgiveness can happen without her. You can forgive fully and keep every boundary.

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SACRED REFLECTION

1. What specifically do I need to forgive her for?

2. What do I fear forgiveness would mean?

3. What would I keep, even after forgiving?

SOFT ACTION

Choose one specific thing and say, "I release this to You, God. I am not available for more harm."

SUPPLICATION

Lord, I am tired of being her jailer and her prisoner. I release it to You. Keep me safe. Amen.

I refuse to be her jailer and her prisoner at the same time.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: COLOSSIANS 3:13

Lord, free her from carrying this, and do not rush her.

*Forgiveness is mine to give in my time,
and it never means going back.*

□ Write one boundary you will keep even after you forgive.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Forgiving a Mother Who Did Not Protect You

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“bearing with one another and, if one has a complaint against another, forgiving each other; as the Lord has forgiven you, so you also must forgive.”

Colossians 3:13 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Forgiveness can take a lifetime. You are allowed to start with one inch.

“Let us then with confidence draw near to the throne of grace, that we may receive mercy and find grace to help in time of need.”

Heb 4:16 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Forgiveness is not forgetting, and it is not reconciliation.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose one inch.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope forgiveness has become a place you can rest in. If it is still unfinished, that is not failure.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Forgiven Is Not Back In

TODAY'S GOAL

Write what forgiven-but-not-back-in looks like for you.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · PROVERBS 22:3 (ESV)

Proverbs 22:3 says, "The prudent sees danger and hides himself, but the simple go on and suffer for it."

Proverbs treats wisdom as seeing a real danger and acting. It is not unloving to stay out of a place that has hurt you.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

People with several adverse childhood experiences are at higher average risk for later problems, which is why safe relationships and stable environments matter so much in recovery. This supports staying away from places and people that repeat the harm.

Source: Felitti et al., 1998. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write: "I forgive _____ and I will not _____." Fill in the blank with a real boundary.
- 2 ☐ Write three warning signs that you are being pulled back in.
- 3 ☐ Write what you will do when you see them (leave, call someone, close the app, drive away).
- 4 ☐ Share your boundary with one safe person.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

MOTHER WOUND · WARFARE

Look around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.*

PROVERBS 22:3 · ESV

Forgiveness is between you and God. Reconciliation requires two people and real repentance. Where someone has harmed you or could harm you, safety decides access, not guilt or family pressure. Jesus withdrew often, and Paul named people and told others to avoid them. If your mother or father reaches out, you have options: no contact, limited contact, contact with conditions. This is not unforgiveness. It is wisdom, and in recovery it may be survival.

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SACRED REFLECTION

1. Who have I let back in because I thought forgiving required it?

2. What does safety actually require right now?

3. Who can help me hold the line?

SOFT ACTION

Write one boundary about contact with a parent. Tell one safe person.

SUPPLICATION

God, give me wisdom, not just kindness. Help me guard what You have given me to guard. Amen.

I forgive completely. I am not available for more harm.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PROVERBS 22:3

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Forgiven Is Not Back In

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"The prudent sees danger and hides himself, but the simple go on and suffer for it."

Proverbs 22:3 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You can forgive and still keep the door locked. That is wisdom, not bitterness.

"The LORD is my strength and my shield; in him my heart trusts, and I am helped; my heart exults, and with my song I give thanks to him."

Ps 28:7 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You can forgive someone and still keep the door locked.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose wisdom over wishful thinking.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you keep this boundary. It is not a punishment. It is how you protect what God has restored.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Armor for the Daughter Who Wasn't Protected

TODAY'S GOAL

Put on the armor, one piece at a time, with your hands.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · EPHESIANS 6:14-15 (ESV)

Ephesians 6:14–15 says, “Stand therefore, having fastened on the belt of truth, and having put on the breastplate of righteousness, and, as shoes for your feet, having put on the readiness given by the gospel of peace.” Verses 16–17 add the shield of faith, the helmet of salvation, and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God. Paul is describing what God provides, and in verse 18 he adds prayer.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Habit research suggests that actions repeated in the same place and time become automatic partly because the setting itself becomes a cue. Pairing the armor practice with a regular cue, like brushing your teeth, can make it easier to keep.

Source: Wood & Neal, 2007. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Stand up. Touch your waist and say, “Truth.” Touch your chest and say, “Righteousness, the right standing Jesus gave me.” Touch your feet and say, “Peace.”
- 2 ☐ Raise one arm as if holding a shield. Say, “Faith.” Touch your head and say, “Salvation.” Open your hand and say, “The word.”
- 3 ☐ Say a one-sentence prayer: “Lord, I put on what you provide.”
- 4 ☐ Pick a cue (brushing your teeth, starting the car) to repeat this each morning.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · CYCLE-BREAKING

Press your palms together, then let go. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.*

EPHESIANS 6:14-15 · ESV

Thirty seconds, out loud, before the day puts anything on you. Truth: I will not lie to myself today. Righteousness: I am covered by His, not mine. Peace: I bring it into rooms; I do not take chaos from them. Faith, salvation, the Word, prayer. This is the covering you did not get as a baby, given now by Someone who does not fail. Notice there is no armor for the back; you are built to stand, not run.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

Date: ____/____/____

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which piece of armor do I forget most?

2. What is coming at me today that I need to prepare for?

3. Who do I want to be covered by?

SOFT ACTION

Say it aloud for thirty seconds today, standing.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, I put on what You gave me. Keep me upright today, and keep my eyes on You. Amen.

I put it on before the day puts anything on me.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: EPHESIANS 6:14-17

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- If nothing comes, nothing is required. Rest is allowed.*

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Armor for the Daughter Who Wasn't Protected

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Stand therefore, having fastened on the belt of truth, and having put on the breastplate of righteousness, and, as shoes for your feet, having put on the readiness given by the gospel of peace.”

Ephesians 6:14-15 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Putting on armor in the morning is just remembering whose you are before the day starts talking.

“for God gave us a spirit not of fear but of power and love and self-control.”

2 Tim 1:7 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You are not dressing for a fight you started. You are dressing so you can stay on your feet.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to get dressed on purpose.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope the armor practice has become a morning habit that takes less than two minutes and settles you every time.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

ARC 3 REVIEW

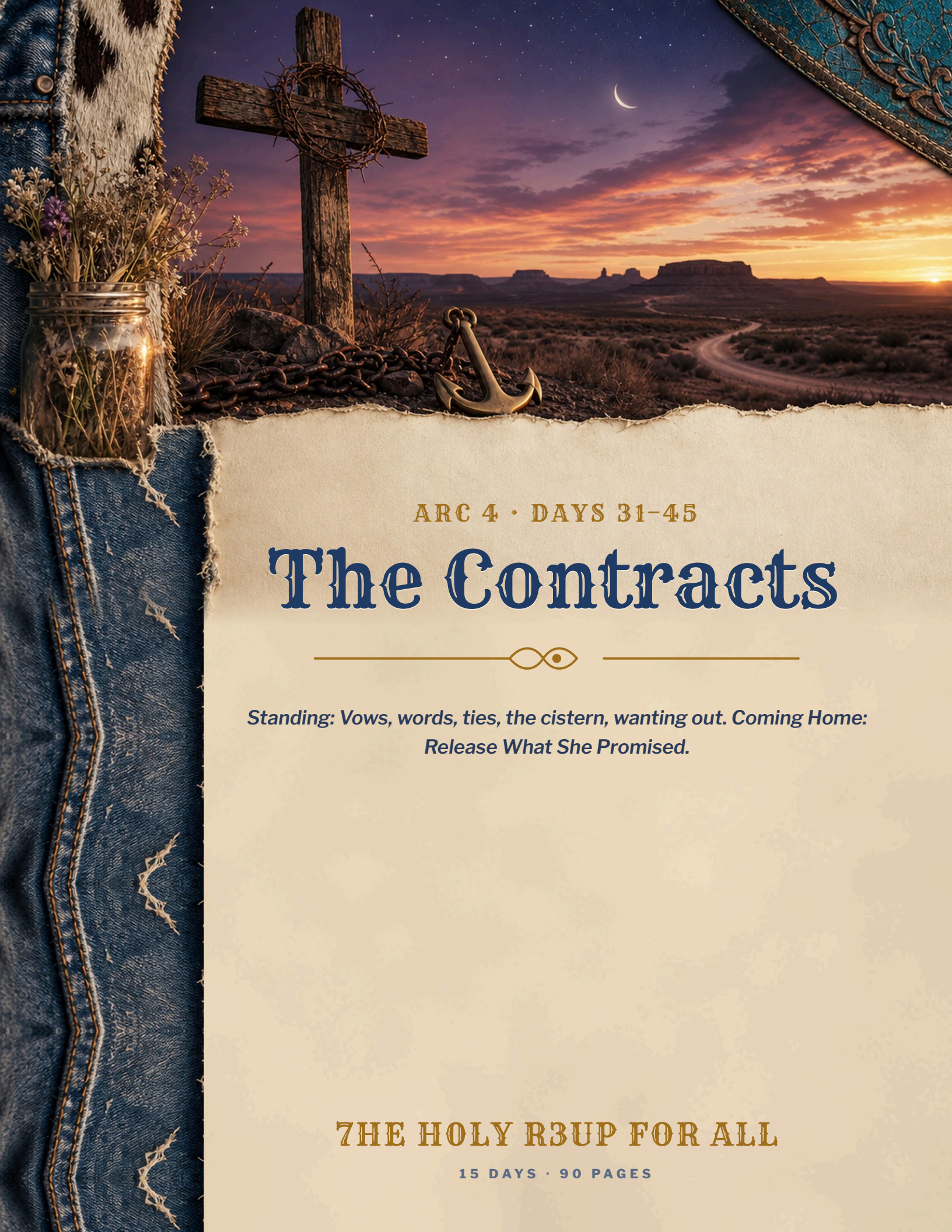
Looking Back: The Realm and Your Authority

A few honest lines before you turn the page. This sheet also keeps each arc starting on a fresh sheet of paper for your binder.

WHAT DID I TELL THE TRUTH ABOUT IN THIS ARC?

WHAT WAS HARDEST, AND WHAT HELPED?

WHAT DO I WANT TO CARRY INTO THE NEXT ARC?



ARC 4 • DAYS 31-45

The Contracts



*Standing: Vows, words, ties, the cistern, wanting out. Coming Home:
Release What She Promised.*

THE HOLY R3UP FOR ALL

15 DAYS • 90 PAGES

Conclusions Drawn Before You Could Speak

TODAY'S GOAL

Find one agreement you made as a child and read it as a child's conclusion.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · COLOSSIANS 2:14 (ESV)

Colossians 2:14 speaks of God “by cancelling the record of debt that stood against us with its legal demands. This he set aside, nailing it to the cross.” Paul is writing to a church being pressured by rules and spiritual experiences, and he says Christ has dealt with the list of charges. For Christians this is the basis for believing that the “paperwork” against you is not the last word.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Writing about an experience several days in a row is associated, on average, with modest improvements in well-being, partly because people begin to organize what happened into a story. It does not work equally well for everyone, and it is not a substitute for treatment.

Source: Pennebaker & Beall, 1986. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Finish this sentence three ways: “When I was little, I decided that _____.”
- 2 ☐ Circle the one that has run your life the most.
- 3 ☐ Write how old you were when you decided it. A guess is fine.
- 4 ☐ Say, “That was a child’s conclusion. It was reasonable then. I can revisit it now.”
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · CHILDHOOD

Sit with your back against something solid. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

COLOSSIANS 2:14 · ESV

Scripture uses the language of debts and records, and Colossians 2:14 says Christ canceled the record that stood against us. This book uses a courtroom picture for the beliefs, vows, and conclusions people live by without choosing them. A baby does not make vows, but a body draws conclusions: I am not safe, no one comes, I have to take care of myself. Those can run an adult life. Christians hold different views on how literally to take the picture. What is clear is that Jesus came to set captives free, and you may look honestly at what you have been living by.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What conclusions do I think my body drew very early?

2. How do they run my choices now, especially around addiction and love?

3. What is it like to think they do not get the final word?

SOFT ACTION

Write one conclusion you suspect you live by, in plain words.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You carried the record that stood against me. Show me what I have been living by, and show me what You say instead. Amen.

What I concluded in pain does not get the final word. Christ does.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: COLOSSIANS 2:14

What I agreed to in pain does not get the final word.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Conclusions Drawn Before You Could Speak

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“by canceling the record of debt that stood against us with its legal demands. This he set aside, nailing it to the cross.”

Colossians 2:14 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You made the best decision a small child could. We can look at it together now without blaming her.

“Come to me, all who labor and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest.”

Matt 11:28 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

A child's conclusion is not a life sentence.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to revisit a decision I made before I could vote.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope that conclusion no longer sits at the head of the table. You were just trying to make sense of something nobody should have had to make sense of.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

The Survival Vow: "I'll Never Need Anyone"

TODAY'S GOAL

Hear the vow plainly: "I will never need anyone."

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · MATTHEW 5:37 (ESV)

In Matthew 5:37 Jesus says, "Let what you say be simply 'Yes' or 'No'; anything more than this comes from evil." He is teaching in the Sermon on the Mount about oaths, and says people should not need to swear to be believed. The point is honest, simple speech. Vows made out of fear and pain are not treated here as binding on you in Jesus's name.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Attachment research suggests that people who learned early not to rely on others can learn to depend on safe people later, often through repeated experiences with someone steady. It takes time and it is not about willpower.

Source: Roisman et al., 2002. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the vow you made in your own words: "I will never _____."
- 2 ☐ Write what it protected you from.
- 3 ☐ Write what it has cost you: friendships, love, help, rest.
- 4 ☐ Say it out loud once: "I made this vow to survive. I understand why."
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration. Do not try to release it today. Just look at it.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

CHILDHOOD · CYCLE-BREAKING

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"Let what you say be simply 'Yes' or 'No'; anything more than this comes from evil."

MATTHEW 5:37 · ESV

Somewhere in childhood most survivors make a rule to stay alive. I will never need anyone. I will never cry. I will never be like her. It worked then, and it may be running your adult life, including the reason you cannot let anyone hold you. Even a vow made to be the opposite of someone binds you to her, because you are still living in reaction. Jesus told us to stop swearing oaths. Not because He is harsh, but because He knows vows made in fear are heavy.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What rule did I make to stay alive?

2. How old was I when I made it?

3. What is it costing me now, especially in recovery and in love?

SOFT ACTION

Write the vow in the exact words you remember. Under it write what it protected you from.

SUPPLICATION

God, a child made that promise because she had to. Thank You that she survived. Show me what it costs now. Amen.

It kept me alive. It does not get to run me.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: MATTHEW 5:37

*Her promise protected her, and I honor
why she made it.*

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Survival Vow: "I'll Never Need Anyone"

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Let what you say be simply 'Yes' or 'No'; anything more than this comes from evil.”

Matthew 5:37 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

A promise you made to survive can be set down gently.
You do not have to rip it off.

“You keep him in perfect peace whose mind is stayed on you, because he trusts in you.”

Isa 26:3 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Self-reliance was the right answer once. It might not be the right answer forever.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to see my vow without being ruled by it.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope that vow has loosened. You do not have to need everyone. You just don't have to need no one.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Releasing a Child's Promise

TODAY'S GOAL

Release a child's promise in prayer, in your own words.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · MARK 10:14 (ESV)

In Mark 10:13–14 people were bringing children to Jesus and the disciples scolded them. Jesus was indignant and said, “Let the children come to me; do not hinder them, for to such belongs the kingdom of God.” The scene shows Jesus welcoming the young and the powerless, and removing the obstacles people put in front of them.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Compassion-focused approaches suggest that people who speak to their younger or hurting selves with kindness often feel less shame over time. The effects are modest on average and vary a lot from person to person.

Source: Neff, 2003. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Read yesterday's vow aloud.
- 2 ☐ Write a prayer: “Jesus, she made this promise to survive. I am letting her put it down. Hold it for her.”
- 3 ☐ Pray it aloud or whisper it.
- 4 ☐ Write what you will do differently in one small way this week (ask for help, accept an offer, say no to something).
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration. Do something kind for the child in you, such as a favorite snack or a nap.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

CHILDHOOD · WARFARE

Feel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

MARK 10:14 · ESV

Jesus welcomed children and did not make them earn it. When you find the vow, speak to the child who made it, not to scold her but to release her. Say: I see you. You made that promise because you had to, and it worked. I am the adult now, and you do not have to hold the door anymore. Then, in Jesus' name, release the vow and replace it with something true: I can let safe people in. I can feel and still be okay. I can want things. A woman who learns this breaks a chain that ran before her.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What would I say to the child who made the vow?

2. What new, true sentence do I want to live by?

3. Who could witness me saying it aloud?

SOFT ACTION

Say the release aloud, in your own words, then say your new sentence three times.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You welcomed children. Welcome her. Come and bring her home. I take over from here, with You. Amen.

I break the old rule and write a new one with God.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: MARK 10:14

Jesus, welcome her. Come and bring her home.

*I break the old rule and write a new one
with God.*

Write your new sentence on a card and put it in your pocket.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Releasing a Child's Promise

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"...Let the children come to me; do not hinder them, for to such belongs the kingdom of God."

Mark 10:14 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

A child's promise comes out like a splinter from a small hand: gently, with the light on, and with someone holding still beside you.

"He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."

Ps 147:3 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Releasing a vow is not the same as being weak. It is the same as being free.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to put down what I picked up in fear.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you feel lighter. If you do not, that is okay. This is a seed, not a harvest.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Words Over You, and Words You Say to Yourself

TODAY'S GOAL

Replace one thing you say to yourself with something true and kind.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • EPHESIANS 4:29 (ESV)

Ephesians 4:29 says, "Let no corrupting talk come out of your mouths, but only such as is good for building up, as fits the occasion, that it may give grace to those who hear." It is addressed to a church about how they speak to each other. It also fits how we speak to ourselves, though that is an application, not the verse's direct subject.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

In studies of self-talk, people who addressed themselves by name or as "you" (instead of "I") while stressed often reported less anxiety and performed better under pressure. It is a simple tool, and results differ among people.

Source: Kross et al., 2014. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the mean thing you say to yourself most. Exact words.
- 2 ☐ Cross it out with one line.
- 3 ☐ Write what you would say to a friend in the same situation.
- 4 ☐ Say it to yourself using your name: "_____, you are doing the best you can with what you have."
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

Date:

___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What was said over me that I still hear?

2. What do I say to myself that sounds like them?

3. What truer sentence can I say, and to whom?

SOFT ACTION

Speak one blessing today to someone, or to yourself, in the mirror. Make it specific.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, heal what was said over me. Teach me to speak life where there was death. Amen.

I take back every word spoken in pain. It does not get to run my life.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: EPHESIANS 4:29

Lord, undo what was said, and speak truth over her.

I take back every word spoken in pain.

- Speak one specific blessing to someone today.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Words Over You, and Words You Say to Yourself

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Let no corrupting talk come out of your mouths, but only such as is good for building up, as fits the occasion, that it may give grace to those who hear.”

Ephesians 4:29 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You get to say a new thing out loud in a house with no one to correct you. Try it.

“He drew me up from the pit of destruction, out of the miry bog, and set my feet upon a rock, making my steps secure.”

Ps 40:2 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You would never talk to a child like that. She is still in there.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose a kinder sentence.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope the kind voice is the one that answers first now. If it is not yet, you are building it.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

The Shame Covenant: Being Her Daughter

TODAY'S GOAL

Notice the shame that belongs to somebody else and hand it back.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • PSALM 34:5 (ESV)

Psalm 34:5 says, "Those who look to him are radiant, and their faces shall never be ashamed." The psalm is attributed to David after he escaped from Abimelech (Achish) by pretending to be insane. The shame in view is the disgrace of being abandoned, and the answer is looking to God.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Research on shame and addiction suggests that shame often drives hiding, and hiding often drives relapse. People who tend toward guilt ("I did something wrong") over shame ("I am wrong") tend to take more steps to repair.

Source: Tangney & Dearing, 2002. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write one thing you are ashamed of that someone else did to you or put on you.
- 2 ☐ Write: "This is not mine. I am handing it back."
- 3 ☐ Take a piece of paper, write the shame on it, and tear it in four pieces. Throw it away.
- 4 ☐ Say a short prayer: "Jesus, take it. I do not need it."
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

MOTHER WOUND · WARFARE

Name three things you can see and one thing you can hear. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.*

PSALM 34:5 · ESV

Shame is not the same as guilt. Guilt says I did something wrong. Shame says I am something wrong. A child of an addicted, absent, or complicit parent often carries shame that is not hers: the family's reputation, the secrets, the smell of the house. Shame hides, and the hiding feeds it. Safe light is what shame cannot stand. That means looking toward Him, not at your reflection in other people's faces.

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SACRED REFLECTION

1. What do I feel most ashamed of about my family or myself?

2. Who taught me this shame?

3. What does looking toward Jesus instead look like?

SOFT ACTION

Tell one shame-heavy true thing to your safe person. Notice that you are still here.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, I look to You. Lift the shame I have worn like a coat. Let my face be uncovered. Amen.

I am not the worst thing that happened to me, and I am not the worst thing I did.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 34:5

Jesus, You bore shame. Take hers.

I am not the worst thing that happened to me.

- Wear something bright today.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Shame Covenant: Being Her Daughter

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"Those who look to him are radiant, and their faces shall never be ashamed."

Psalms 34:5 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

I would like to see you be as patient with yourself as you are with people you love.

"I have loved you with an everlasting love; therefore I have continued my faithfulness to you."

Jer 31:3 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Shame is a heavy coat someone else put on you. You can take it off.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to look up.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope your face lifts easily now. If shame still shows up, you know where to send it.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

The Silence Contract: Family Secrets

TODAY'S GOAL

Break one silence in a safe way.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • PSALM 32:3 (ESV)

Psalm 32:3 says, “For when I kept silent, my bones wasted away through my groaning all day long.” David is describing what concealing sin did to him, and verse 5 continues, “I acknowledged my sin to you, and I did not cover my iniquity; I said, ‘I will confess my transgressions to the LORD,’ and you forgave the iniquity of my sin.” The relief came when he spoke. This is about confession to God, which can include a safe person.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Studies of expressive writing suggest that putting secrets into words can reduce the load they carry, even when no one reads them. When possible, telling a safe, trained person can help more than writing alone.

Source: Pennebaker & Beall, 1986. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write one secret in a sentence. No details needed.
- 2 ☐ Decide who is safe: a counselor, a pastor you trust, a recovery sponsor, a close friend, or God alone for now.
- 3 ☐ Write what you would say in one sentence, such as “There is something I have never told anyone, and I need to say it.”
- 4 ☐ Practice saying it aloud once.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration. Choose a day this week to tell one safe person.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

MOTHER WOUND · CHILDHOOD

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"For when I kept silent, my bones wasted away through my groaning all day long."

PSALM 32:3 · ESV

Somebody told you not to tell, or no one needed to. Families protect secrets over children, and a mother who allows abuse is often keeping the secret too. Telling should be done with support and never in a way that puts you in danger. If a child is at risk now, whether a sibling, a niece, a nephew, or any child near the person who harmed you, protecting that child comes before the family secret: call the Childhelp hotline at 1-800-422-4453, or 911 in an emergency. Your story matters. You are not the keeper of what was done to you.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What does my family never say out loud?

2. What has the silence cost me?

3. What would telling safely look like?

SOFT ACTION

Write the secret for yourself only, then decide who, if anyone, should hear it, and when.

SUPPLICATION

Father, You see what was hidden. Give me courage and wisdom to speak when it is time and safe. Protect every child involved. Amen.

I am not the keeper of what was done to me.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 32:3

Father, You see what was hidden. Give wisdom about when and to whom.

I am not the keeper of what was done to me.

☐ Say one true thing to a safe person that you normally hide.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Silence Contract: Family Secrets

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“For when I kept silent, my bones wasted away through my groaning all day long.”

Psalms 32:3 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

A heavy coat of shame was put on you by someone else. It will not take much to slip it off.

“For his anger is but for a moment, and his favor is for a lifetime. Weeping may tarry for the night, but joy comes with the morning.”

Psalms 30:5 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

A secret is a heavy thing to carry alone.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose one safe disclosure.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope that secret has lost its power. Secrets get smaller when someone else knows.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Soul Ties, Plainly: To Her, To Him, To the Substance

TODAY'S GOAL

Name what still holds you, in plain words, with no spooky language.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · 1 CORINTHIANS 6:17 (ESV)

First Corinthians 6:17 says, "But he who is joined to the Lord becomes one spirit with him." Paul is writing to the church at Corinth about sexual immorality and about bodies belonging to the Lord. The ties we form to people and substances are real emotionally and in the body. The Bible's answer is a stronger union with Christ, not a ritual.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Attachment research shows that early bonds shape how we connect later, including to people who are not good for us. Trauma-informed therapists often describe this as a pattern that can be understood and gradually changed.

Source: Roisman et al., 2002. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ List three people, substances, or places you still feel pulled toward.
- 2 ☐ Next to each write what the pull feels like in your body (tight chest, craving, heat).
- 3 ☐ Write what you got from each that you needed (comfort, escape, belonging).
- 4 ☐ Write one safer source for that need.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · MOTHER WOUND · ADDICTION

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Look around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

"But he who is joined to the Lord becomes one spirit with him."

1 CORINTHIANS 6:17 · ESV

"Soul tie" is not a phrase found in Scripture. It names a real experience: someone you barely knew, or someone who harmed you, still has a hold on your thoughts. The deepest holds are often to the first people. You may feel bound to your mother and to the substance, and in the same way. What was taken from you was a wrong done to you, not a sin you committed. Being joined to the Lord is the tie that holds.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

THE HOLY R3UP · STANDING · UNDERSTAND AND STAND

Date:

___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Who still has a hold on my mind or body?

2. Is it a person, a place, or a substance?

3. What would a healthier connection look like, if any?

SOFT ACTION

List names, or write "the one whose name I do not know." Do not write the stories.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, You are the one I want to be joined to. Loosen what is not of You, and show me what safe connection looks like. Amen.

What God did not join, I do not keep.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: 1 CORINTHIANS 6:16-17

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Soul Ties, Plainly: To Her, To Him, To the Substance

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"But he who is joined to the Lord becomes one spirit with him."

1 Corinthians 6:17 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

A secret told to a safe person gets smaller. Not all at once, but it does.

"When I am afraid, I put my trust in you."

Ps 56:3 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

A tie is a real thing. So is freedom.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to name what holds me.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope the pulls feel quieter. If any are still loud, you know what you are really hungry for.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Releasing the Hold

TODAY'S GOAL

Practice releasing: give back what was never yours to carry.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · PHILIPPIANS 3:13-14 (ESV)

Philippians 3:13–14 says, “Brothers, I do not consider that I have made it my own. But one thing I do: forgetting what lies behind and straining forward to what lies ahead, I press on toward the goal for the prize of the upward call of God in Christ Jesus.” Paul wrote from prison and in the same letter says he has not yet arrived. Forgetting here means not letting the past define the race, not erasing it.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Research on habits suggests that changing cues in your environment can make it easier to break old patterns. Removing reminders, changing routes, and changing routines help more than relying on willpower alone.

Source: Wood & Neal, 2007. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write one object, number, place, or app connected to what pulls you back.
- 2 ☐ Decide: delete, hide, move, or give away. Do it now, or put a time on it.
- 3 ☐ Write one new cue to replace it (a photo, a verse card, a different route).
- 4 ☐ Say, “I am pressing on.”
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · CYCLE-BREAKING

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"Brothers, I do not consider that I have made it my own. But one thing I do: forgetting what lies behind and straining forward to what lies ahead, I press on toward the goal for the prize of the upward call of God in Christ Jesus."

PHILIPPIANS 3:13-14 · ESV

You can release your hold on a person and ask God to loosen their hold on you. Hand back what is theirs: the shame, the blame, the voice in your head, their version of you. Take back what is yours: your body, your mind, your peace, your future. Where contact is ongoing, the release is internal and the practical is separate: boundaries, limited contact, someone who can help you hold them. Pressing forward is not pretending. It is a direction.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What am I handing back today?

2. What am I taking back?

3. What practical boundary supports the release?

SOFT ACTION

Pray the release in your own words, by name. Then take one practical step.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, I release my hold, and I ask You to loosen theirs. I hand back what was never mine. Amen.

I take back what was mine and hand back what was never mine.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PHILIPPIANS 3:13-14

*I hand back what was never mine and
take back what was.*

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Releasing the Hold

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Brothers, I do not consider that I have made it my own. But one thing I do: forgetting what lies behind and straining forward to what lies ahead, I press on toward the goal for the prize of the upward call of God in Christ Jesus.”

Philippians 3:13-14 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

The pull is real. The pull is also not in charge of you.

“For I am sure that neither death nor life, nor angels nor rulers, nor things present nor things to come, nor powers, nor height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God in Christ Jesus our Lord.”

Rom 8:38-39 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

*You are not forgetting what happened.
You are refusing to live there.*

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to remove one reminder.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope those cues are gone and you do not miss them. Look how far you have pressed on.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

The Cistern: What the Substance Gave You That She Didn't

TODAY'S GOAL

Find what you were really thirsty for.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · JEREMIAH 2:13 (ESV)

Jeremiah 2:13 says, “for my people have committed two evils: they have forsaken me, the fountain of living waters, and hewed out cisterns for themselves, broken cisterns that can hold no water.” God, speaking through Jeremiah, describes his people trying to meet a real need in places that cannot hold it. It names the thirst as legitimate and the cistern as the problem.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Behavioral activation, a well-studied approach, helps people re-engage with activities that give a sense of meaning and pleasure instead of avoiding or numbing. In one trial it did as well as other treatments for depression. It works by doing, not by waiting to feel like it.

Source: Dimidjian et al., 2006. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write what the substance or pattern gave you: relief, belonging, energy, quiet, feeling chosen.
- 2 ☐ Next to each, write one healthier source of it.
- 3 ☐ Pick one activity from that list and schedule it for a specific time today or tomorrow.
- 4 ☐ Do it, even for ten minutes. Note afterward how you feel.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

ADDICTION · MOTHER WOUND

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Sit with your back against something solid. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

"for my people have committed two evils: they have forsaken me, the fountain of living waters, and hewed out cisterns for themselves, broken cisterns that can hold no water."

JEREMIAH 2:13 · ESV

Every addiction promised something real: peace, escape, belonging, courage, rest, a feeling of being held. A baby who was not protected may find that a substance is the first reliable comfort she ever had. That is not an excuse and not a moral failing; it is an explanation, and it points toward what was missing. The cistern is not the sin. Digging your own is. If you can answer what it gave you that you could not get anywhere else, you can find a legitimate source for the need.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

Date:

___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What did it give me that I could not get anywhere else?

2. What did it let me stop feeling?

3. What was I truly thirsty for?

SOFT ACTION

Write the job it did. We will replace each one by Day 64.

SUPPLICATION

God, I dug my own cistern because I was thirsty and no one handed me water. Teach me to drink from You. Amen.

I put it down as my savior, my comfort, and my god.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: JEREMIAH 2:13

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Cistern: What the Substance Gave You That She Didn't

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“for my people have committed two evils: they have forsaken me, the fountain of living waters, and hewed out cisterns for themselves, broken cisterns that can hold no water.”

Jeremiah 2:13 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Letting go of a number, an app, an object: that is not small. That is a door.

“The LORD is my strength and my shield; in him my heart trusts, and I am helped; my heart exults, and with my song I give thanks to him.”

Ps 28:7 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

*Your hunger was never the problem.
The cistern was.*

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose a well that holds water.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope that list became your routine. The thirst was real. You found water that holds.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

The Bond You Mistook for Love

TODAY'S GOAL

Learn the difference between a trauma bond and love.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · 1 JOHN 4:18 (ESV)

First John 4:18 says, "There is no fear in love, but perfect love casts out fear. For fear has to do with punishment, and whoever fears has not been perfected in love." John is writing about God's love and about how believers love each other. Love here is described as safe, not as a source of terror.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Studies of adverse childhood experiences show that early harm can make unsafe relationships feel familiar. Many people feel strongest pulled toward patterns that echo childhood, even when the patterns hurt them.

Source: Felitti et al., 1998. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Make two columns: "Feels like love but isn't" and "Is love."
- 2 ☐ Under the first list three things from your past (intense highs and lows, constant fear, being needed to fix someone).
- 3 ☐ Under the second list three things you want (steady, consistent, kind, safe to disagree).
- 4 ☐ Circle one thing in the second column to look for this month.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

MOTHER WOUND · ADDICTION

Take a slow sip of water. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.*

1 JOHN 4:18 · ESV

When harm and love arrive in the same package, your instrument for detecting safety gets miscalibrated. You may be drawn to people who feel like home because they feel like her, or him. Your alarm works; your identifier is off. It is rebuilt by new evidence, slowly, with safe people. If love has always had fear in it, real love may feel boring or suspicious at first. Trust the pattern over time, not the intensity.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Where has fear been tangled in love for me?

2. Who in my life has been consistently safe?

3. What evidence would I want before trusting someone?

SOFT ACTION

List three signs of a safe person. Check it against someone in your life.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, teach me what safe love looks like. Be the standard I measure by. Amen.

I am building new evidence. Familiar is not the same as safe.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: 1 JOHN 4:18

Lord, teach her what safe love looks like.

Familiar is not the same as safe.

□ Notice one calm, safe thing about someone today and tell them.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Bond You Mistook for Love

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“There is no fear in love, but perfect love casts out fear. For fear has to do with punishment, and whoever fears has not been perfected in love.”

1 John 4:18 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You were thirsty. Of course you were. Come drink from somewhere that does not run dry.

“How precious is your steadfast love, O God! The children of mankind take refuge in the shadow of your wings.”

Ps 36:7 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Love that makes you afraid is not the love John is talking about.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose safe over intense.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope calm no longer feels boring. I hope it feels like home.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Control and the Fear of Becoming Her

TODAY'S GOAL

Put down the control you used to survive.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • MATTHEW 6:27 (ESV)

In Matthew 6:27 Jesus asks, "And which of you by being anxious can add a single hour to his span of life?" It is part of the Sermon on the Mount, in a stretch about not being anxious about food, clothes, or tomorrow. He points to birds and flowers, and he is not telling people to be careless. He is telling them they are not in charge of everything.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Studies of rumination suggest that trying to think your way to total certainty usually increases worry. Acting on one small thing and then letting go tends to help more.

Source: Nolen-Hoeksema et al., 2008. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write three things you are trying to control that you cannot.
- 2 ☐ Write one thing in each area that is yours to do (call, schedule, decide).
- 3 ☐ Do one of them.
- 4 ☐ Pray: "God, I release _____ to you."
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

CYCLE-BREAKING · CHILDHOOD

Feel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.*

"And which of you by being anxious can add a single hour to his span of life?"

WHAT THIS MEANS

If you can manage every variable, nobody can ambush you again. That made sense. It also means you cannot rest, cannot receive, and may be gripping your life so tightly that you squeeze out the good. The fear of becoming your mother can make you control every move, and the fear itself can pull you toward the very patterns you dread. Hypervigilance feels like safety. Sometimes it is a wound wearing competence as a uniform.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Where am I controlling because I am afraid of being ambushed again?

2. What am I afraid will happen if I let go?

3. What is one thing I could let be a little messy?

SOFT ACTION

Choose one thing to loosen your grip on this week, and tell someone you are trying.

SUPPLICATION

Father, You see what I am afraid of. Hold what I cannot control. Let me rest in You. Amen.

I open my hands. Control was never protection.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: MATTHEW 6:27

Father, hold what we cannot control.

I can open my hands. Control was never protection.

- Do one thing imperfectly on purpose.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Control and the Fear of Becoming Her

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“And which of you by being anxious can add a single hour to his span of life?”

Matthew 6:27 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Calm should not feel boring. It should feel like a place you can finally unpack.

“Peace I leave with you; my peace I give to you. Not as the world gives do I give to you. Let not your hearts be troubled, neither let them be afraid.”

John 14:27 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Control is a comforting lie. Trust is a harder, truer thing.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to do my part and leave the rest.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you sleep better. Control was a way of staying safe. You can hold it more loosely now.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Worth That Isn't Work or Rescue

TODAY'S GOAL

Receive worth that is not earned by work or rescue.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • LUKE 10:41-42 (ESV)

In Luke 10:38–42 Jesus visits Martha and Mary. Martha is “distracted with much serving” and asks him to tell Mary to help. Jesus answers, “Martha, Martha, you are anxious and troubled about many things, but one thing is necessary. Mary has chosen the good portion, which will not be taken away from her.” He is not shaming work. He is pointing out that Martha is being pulled apart by it.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Self-compassion research has linked treating yourself kindly with greater motivation and resilience, not laziness. People who are kind to themselves after a failure are often more likely to try again.

Source: Neff, 2003. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the ways you try to earn love (fix, give, please, perform).
- 2 ☐ Write how you feel when you stop doing them.
- 3 ☐ Choose a 15-minute period today to simply sit and do nothing useful. Sit.
- 4 ☐ Say, “I am loved at rest.”
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

MOTHER WOUND · CHILDHOOD

Hold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.*

"But the Lord answered her, 'Martha, Martha, you are anxious and troubled about many things, but one thing is necessary. Mary has chosen the good portion, which will not be taken away from her.'"

LUKE 10:41-42 · ESV

I only matter when I am useful. Many children of addicted parents learn to earn love by fixing, caretaking, or staying quiet. Jesus did not shame Martha. He named what she was carrying and invited her to sit. If rest feels like disappearing, ask who you were responsible for rescuing as a child, and whether you are still doing it. Test it honestly: who are you when you produce nothing and rescue no one?

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Who was I responsible for as a child?

2. Where do I feel guilty when I rest?

3. What would it mean to be loved at rest?

SOFT ACTION

Do ten minutes of nothing useful today. Notice what comes up. Do not fix it.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, I am anxious about many things. Let me sit at Your feet without earning it. Amen.

I am loved at rest. My worth was never output.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: LUKE 10:41-42

Jesus, let her sit at Your feet without earning it.

I am loved at rest.

- Do something purely for joy: a hobby, a walk, a song.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Worth That Isn't Work or Rescue

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"But the Lord answered her, "Martha, Martha, you are anxious and troubled about many things, but one thing is necessary. Mary has chosen the good portion, which will not be taken away from her.""

Luke 10:41-42 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You are not guarding the whole house tonight.
Somebody else is on watch.

"I lift up my eyes to the hills. From where does my help come? My help comes from the LORD, who made heaven and earth."

Ps 121:1-2 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You were never meant to earn your place at the table.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose worth that does not need a job.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you can sit in a room with no tasks and not panic. If you can, that is a miracle.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Self-Punishment: Paying for Her Sins and Yours

TODAY'S GOAL

Stop punishing yourself for what the Lord has already carried.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • ROMANS 8:1 (ESV)

Romans 8:1 says, "There is therefore now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus." It comes after Romans 7, where Paul describes struggling with sin. "Therefore" ties it to the argument: the verdict has already been handled in Christ. Conviction that moves you toward repair can come from God. Condemnation that keeps you in the dock does not.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Research suggests that harsh self-punishment tends to increase hiding, not repair. Repair after a mistake is more likely when people feel responsible but not worthless.

Source: Tangney & Dearing, 2002. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write one way you punish yourself (starving, isolating, overworking, using, harming).
- 2 ☐ Write what you think it pays for.
- 3 ☐ Write: "Jesus already paid for this. I do not need to."
- 4 ☐ Replace the punishment with one kind, concrete act (a meal, a shower, a nap, a call).
- 5 ☐ If the urge to hurt yourself is strong, call or text 988 or tell a safe person now. Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

ADDICTION · MOTHER WOUND

Name three things you can see and one thing you can hear. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

ROMANS 8:1 · ESV

Part of you decided that as long as you keep paying, it is not unpunished. So you sabotage, deny yourself, stay in what hurts, or relapse after good news. Some of the debt you are paying belongs to people who never paid it. The bill was settled. Continuing to pay may feel like humility while it refuses a payment Jesus already made. Repair with people, where it is safe, is good. Punishing yourself is not repair.

Date:

___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. How do I still punish myself?

2. Whose debt am I paying?

3. What would accepting grace cost me, and what would it give?

SOFT ACTION

Do one kind thing for yourself today that you would do for a friend.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You already paid. Teach me to receive it and to stop collecting. Amen.

I am not going to keep paying for what He already bought.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: ROMANS 8:1

God, the bill is paid. Let her receive it.

I am not going to keep paying for what Christ already paid.

- Cook or buy one thing she would like.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Self-Punishment: Paying for Her Sins and Yours

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“There is therefore now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus.”

Romans 8:1 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You do not have to earn a seat. Come sit. The chair has your name on it.

“And he arose and came to his father. But while he was still a long way off, his father saw him and felt compassion, and ran and embraced him and kissed him.”

Luke 15:20 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Self-punishment feels like justice. It is just more hurt.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose repair over penance.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you no longer feel you owe anyone your suffering.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Wanting Out

TODAY'S GOAL

Get through a dark day safely.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · 1 KINGS 19:4-5 (ESV)

In 1 Kings 19:4–5 Elijah, exhausted and afraid after Jezebel's threat, goes a day's journey into the wilderness and asks that he might die: "It is enough; now, O LORD, take away my life." God does not scold him. An angel touches him and says, "Arise and eat." Rest and food come first. The fuller conversation with God comes later.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

If you are thinking about ending your life, the 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline offers free, confidential support by call or text, any hour, in the U.S. Wanting to disappear is a sign of overwhelming pain, not a character flaw, and it can be spoken about out loud.

Source: 988 Lifeline (988lifeline.org).

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ If you are in danger right now, call or text 988 (or call 911). Stay with someone if you can.
- 2 ☐ Tell one safe person in plain words: "I am having a dark day. Can you stay on the phone with me?"
- 3 ☐ Eat or drink something. Elijah's first step was food and sleep.
- 4 ☐ Remove anything you could use to hurt yourself from reach, or ask someone to hold it for you.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration. Do one tiny thing today and tell someone how it went.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · ADDICTION

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"But he himself went a day's journey into the wilderness and came and sat down under a broom tree. And he asked that he might die, saying, 'It is enough; now, O LORD, take away my life, for I am no better than my fathers.'" And he lay down and slept under a broom tree. And behold, an angel touched him and said to him, "Arise and eat."

1 KINGS 19:4-5 · ESV

A death wish is a symptom, not a sin, and not a truth. Elijah, Jonah, Job, and Moses all asked to die, and God's answer to Elijah was food, sleep, a whisper, and a new job, not a rebuke. Early trauma and addiction both raise the risk of wanting out. If that thought has teeth today, call or text 988 (or call 911) before you read another word. You can also tell your sponsor, a counselor, or a friend. This is not weakness; it is the correct use of help.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. When did I first start wanting out?

2. What is the pain underneath the wish?

3. Who can I tell today?

SOFT ACTION

If the thought is loud, stop here and call or text 988. If it is quieter, tell one person you trust today.

SUPPLICATION

God, I am tired. Feed me, let me sleep, and send me someone. Keep me here. Amen.

I choose life. I will tell someone.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: 1 KINGS 19:4-5

I choose to stay, and I will tell someone.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Wanting Out

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"But he himself went a day's journey into the wilderness and came and sat down under a broom tree. And he asked that he might die, saying, 'It is enough; now, O LORD, take away my life, for I am no better than my fathers.' And he lay down and slept under a broom tree. And behold, an angel touched him and said to him, 'Arise and eat.'"

1 Kings 19:4-5 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You have been paying for something that was already paid. You can stop.

"but God shows his love for us in that while we were still sinners, Christ died for us."

Rom 5:8 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You do not have to want to live every minute. You only have to get through this one with help.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to stay and reach out.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, if you are reading this, you made it through a day when you did not think you could. Thank you for staying.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

The Accuser's Pen: "You're Just Like Her"

TODAY'S GOAL

Take back the pen from the accuser's "You're just like her."

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · ZECHARIAH 3:1-4 (V. 2 QUOTED) (ESV)

In Zechariah 3:1–4 the prophet sees Joshua the high priest standing before the angel of the LORD, with Satan at his right hand to accuse him. The LORD says, "The LORD rebuke you, O Satan!" and asks, "Is not this a brand plucked from the fire?" Joshua's filthy garments are removed, and he is told, "Behold, I have taken your iniquity away from you, and I will clothe you with pure vestments." The accuser speaks, God answers, and the clothing is changed.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Self-talk research suggests that how we address ourselves, with distance and kindness, can reduce the sting of harsh self-evaluation. A small shift in wording can change how a thought lands.

Source: Kross et al., 2014. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the accusation: "You're just like her."
- 2 ☐ Write what is the same about you and her and what is different. Be honest and specific.
- 3 ☐ Write three choices you made this year that she did not make or could not make.
- 4 ☐ Rewrite the pen line: "I am not her. I am my own woman, and I am choosing differently."
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · CYCLE-BREAKING

Look around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

ZECHARIAH 3:1-4 (V. 2 QUOTED) · ESV

In Zechariah's vision, Joshua stands in filthy clothes with the accuser at his right hand. God does not argue Joshua's case. He rebukes the accuser and says, Remove the filthy garments. I have taken your iniquity away. The accuser says it once, and you say it to yourself for thirty years: you are just like her, you will always be an addict, you ruin everything. Today you take the pen back. A defeated prosecutor does not get to write your story.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What sentence have I been finishing for the accuser?

2. What are the filthy garments I am still wearing?

3. What clothing does God offer instead?

SOFT ACTION

Cross out the sentence in your writing, and write God's sentence over it: "Remove the filthy garments."

SUPPLICATION

Lord, You rebuke the accuser. Take the filthy clothes I have been wearing and clothe me. Amen.

I do not receive that. That is not mine. I take back the pen.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: ZECHARIAH 3:2-4

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Accuser's Pen: "You're Just Like Her"

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"And the LORD said to Satan, "The LORD rebuke you, O Satan! The LORD who has chosen Jerusalem rebuke you! Is not this a brand plucked from the fire?""

Zechariah 3:1-4 (v. 2 quoted) · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

If today is dark, call 988. Then call me again tomorrow, in a way: open this book and write one line.

"The LORD is near to the brokenhearted and saves the crushed in spirit."

Ps 34:18 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

The accuser wants you to write your future in your parents' handwriting.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to write in my own.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you hear that voice less and less. When you do, you know who is holding the pen.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

ARC 4 REVIEW

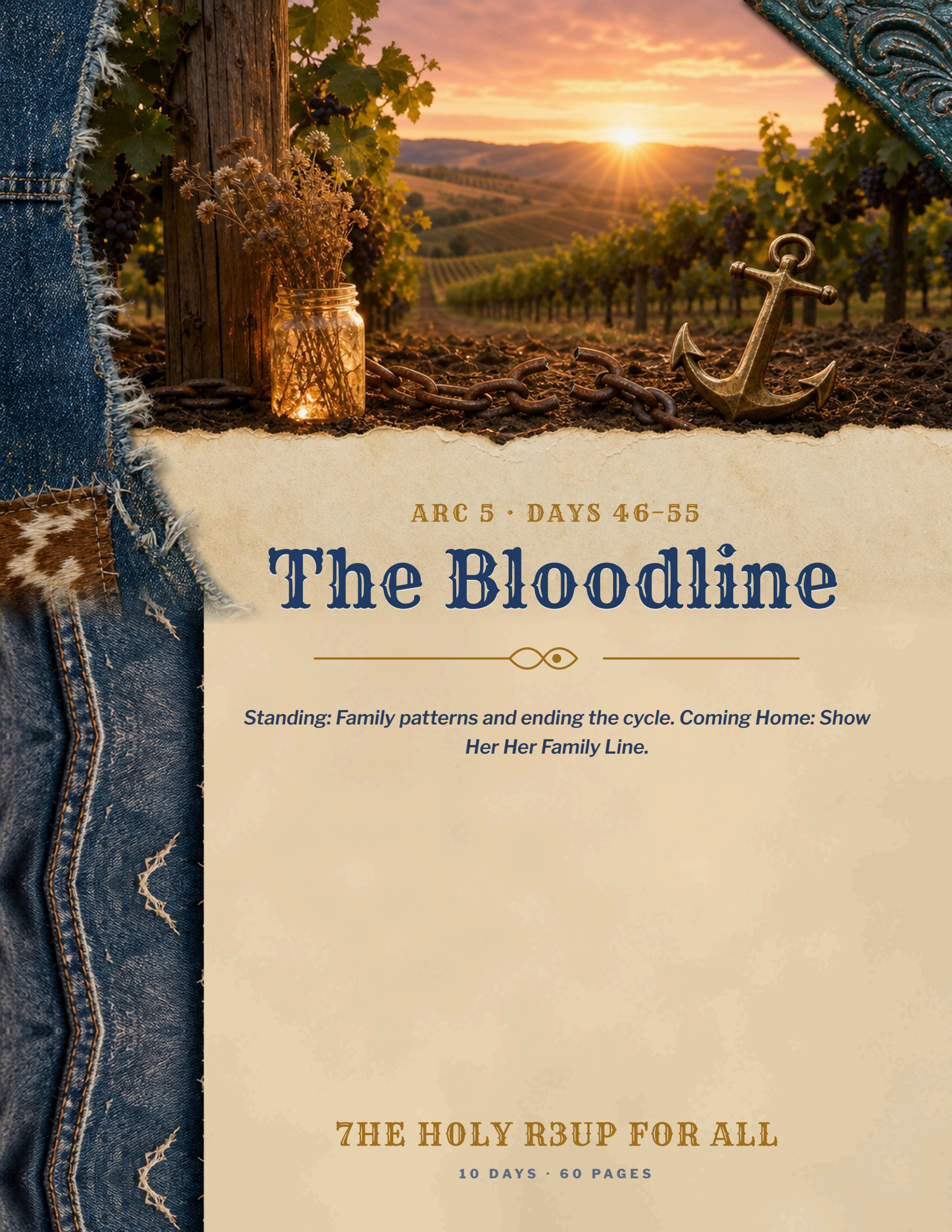
Looking Back: The Contracts

A few honest lines before you turn the page. This sheet also keeps each arc starting on a fresh sheet of paper for your binder.

WHAT DID I TELL THE TRUTH ABOUT IN THIS ARC?

WHAT WAS HARDEST, AND WHAT HELPED?

WHAT DO I WANT TO CARRY INTO THE NEXT ARC?



ARC 5 • DAYS 46-55

The Bloodline



*Standing: Family patterns and ending the cycle. Coming Home: Show
Her Her Family Line.*

THE HOLY R3UP FOR ALL

10 DAYS • 60 PAGES

Terrain, Not Guilt: What You Inherited

TODAY'S GOAL

Separate what you inherited from what you are guilty of.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • EZEKIEL 18:20 (ESV)

Ezekiel 18:20 says, “The soul who sins shall die. The son shall not suffer for the iniquity of the father, nor the father suffer for the iniquity of the son. The righteousness of the righteous shall be upon himself, and the wickedness of the wicked shall be upon himself.” Ezekiel was speaking to Judean exiles in Babylon who were saying, “The fathers have eaten sour grapes, and the children’s teeth are set on edge.” God answers that each person is accountable for their own sin. You may inherit terrain, but not guilt.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Twin and family studies suggest that genetics account for a meaningful share (often estimated around 40–60 percent) of vulnerability to addiction, and adverse childhood experiences add risk. Both describe risk, not destiny, and neither is moral guilt.

Sources: Goldman et al., 2005; Felitti et al., 1998. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Make two columns: “What I may have inherited (terrain)” and “What I am responsible for now (choices).”
- 2 ☐ Under terrain, list things like family history of addiction, early stress, learned coping.
- 3 ☐ Under choices, list things you can do: treatment, meetings, boundaries, sleep, supports.
- 4 ☐ Say: “I did not choose the terrain. I do choose the path.”
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

MOTHER WOUND · CYCLE-BREAKING

Press your palms together, then let go. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.*

"The soul who sins shall die. The son shall not suffer for the iniquity of the father, nor the father suffer for the iniquity of the son. The righteousness of the righteous shall be upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked shall be upon himself."

EZEKIEL 18:20 · ESV

Guilt does not transfer. You are not guilty of your mother's addiction or your father's abuse. But terrain does: patterns, wounds, habits, biology, silence. Research suggests addiction runs in families through both genes and environment, and scientists are still learning how. Exodus 20:5 says consequences reach down generations; Ezekiel 18 says each person answers for their own; the same Bible says God's steadfast love reaches thousands. You did not inherit their sin. You inherited the ground it grew on, and you get to change what grows.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What has run in my family for three generations or more?

2. Where do I see it in me?

3. What would it mean to see myself as not guilty of any of it?

SOFT ACTION

Write one pattern that has run in your family, and one way you are interrupting it.

SUPPLICATION

Father, I cannot change what I inherited, but I can walk differently. Meet me where they could not. Amen.

I did not inherit guilt. I inherited a terrain, and I can change what grows on it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: EZEKIEL 18:20

I did not inherit guilt. I inherited a terrain I can change.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Terrain, Not Guilt: What You Inherited

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“The soul who sins shall die. The son shall not suffer for the iniquity of the father, nor the father suffer for the iniquity of the son. The righteousness of the righteous shall be upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked shall be upon himself.”

Ezekiel 18:20 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

It is true that you and she are different women. Say it until your shoulders drop.

“Fear not, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by name, you are mine.”

Isa 43:1 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Risk is not guilt. Knowing your terrain is how you plan the route.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to work with my terrain, not against myself.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you carry the terrain without shame and walk the path with wisdom.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Drawing the Family Line

TODAY'S GOAL

Find one good thing in your family line and honor it.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • PSALM 78:4 (ESV)

Psalm 78:4 says, "We will not hide them from their children, but tell to the coming generation the glorious deeds of the LORD, and his might, and the wonders that he has done." Psalm 78 is a long historical psalm attributed to Asaph that tells Israel's story, including their failures, so that the next generation will not repeat them and will trust God. Passing on truth, good and hard, is the point.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

In a series of studies, people asked to list things they were grateful for each week reported greater well-being than those who listed hassles. Gratitude does not erase pain, but it can balance what we notice.

Source: Emmons & McCullough, 2003. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write three good things from your family, however small (a recipe, a song, a strong aunt, a funny phrase, a work ethic).
- 2 ☐ Circle the one you want to carry forward.
- 3 ☐ Write one way you will carry it (cook it, sing it, say it, do it).
- 4 ☐ If you cannot find any good, write a good thing you would want to start.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

Drawing the Family Line

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"we will not hide them from their children, but tell to the coming generation the glorious deeds of the LORD, and his might, and the wonders that he has done."

PSALM 78:4 · ESV

Draw it. Three or four generations, both sides. Mark the patterns: addiction, abuse, suicide, early death, mental illness, poverty, abandonment, incarceration, silence. Notice which columns have marks in three or more generations. This is not to blame your family. It is to see clearly, and to also see the good: faith, resilience, a grandmother who prayed. The same line that carried the pain carries gifts, and you get to choose what to carry.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What patterns do I see?

2. What good has also come down my line?

3. What do I choose to carry, and what to leave?

SOFT ACTION

Start the family map on the page, even partially. Add one good thing next to each side.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, show me my family as You see it. Thank You for the good, and help me carry it forward. Amen.

I am looking straight at it. And I am looking at what is good, too.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 78:4

There is good in my story, and I get to keep it.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Drawing the Family Line

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“we will not hide them from their children, but tell to the coming generation the glorious deeds of the LORD, and his might, and the wonders that he has done.”

Psalms 78:4 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You came from a hard terrain. That does not mean you have to plant the same crop.

“For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus for good works, which God prepared beforehand, that we should walk in them.”

Eph 2:10 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

A broken line can still have good threads. Pull the ones worth keeping.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to keep what is good.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you are passing on what is worth keeping.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Four Layers: How It Passed to You, and How It Stops

TODAY'S GOAL

Map the four layers: body, home, learning, and spirit, and how each can change.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • ROMANS 12:2 (ESV)

Romans 12:2 says, "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewal of your mind, that by testing you may discern what is the will of God, what is good and acceptable and perfect." Paul writes this after eleven chapters of explaining what God has done. Transformation is described as ongoing and as happening by renewal, which fits how habits are changed.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Addiction risk is shaped by biology, environment, and learning, and each of those layers can be addressed. Bandura's work suggests that behaviors we learn from watching others can be replaced by new ones we see modeled and practice.

Sources: Goldman et al., 2005; Bandura, 1977. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Draw four boxes: Body, Home, Learning, Spirit.
- 2 ☐ In each, write one way it affected you, and one change you can make (Body: sleep and treatment; Home: who you live with; Learning: new habits; Spirit: prayer and community).
- 3 ☐ Choose one change to start this week.
- 4 ☐ Write the first step and the date.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

CYCLE-BREAKING · WARFARE

Take a slow sip of water. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.*

ROMANS 12:2 · ESV

A pattern can travel four ways. Behavioral: you learn what you saw. Biological: severe stress can shape how bodies respond, and addiction risk runs in families. Systemic: poverty, instability, and lack of support are real walls. Spiritual: Scripture speaks of the enemy and of unhealed wounds, and Christians differ on how to understand this layer. Most people fight one layer and wonder why it did not hold. Work all four: practice new behavior, protect sleep and health, build support, and bring it to God.

Date:

___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which layer have I been ignoring?

2. What is one small action for each layer?

3. Who could help with the one I cannot reach alone?

SOFT ACTION

Write the four layers and one action for each, small enough to do this week.

SUPPLICATION

God, renew my mind and teach me to work all of it. Give me patience with the pace of change. Amen.

I am working all four layers, not just the one I can see.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: ROMANS 12:2

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Four Layers: How It Passed to You, and How It Stops

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewal of your mind, that by testing you may discern what is the will of God, what is good and acceptable and perfect.”

Romans 12:2 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

There are good things in your line too. Go find them and keep them.

“The steadfast love of the LORD never ceases; his mercies never come to an end; they are new every morning; great is your faithfulness.”

Lam 3:22–23 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

*You can change what you can reach.
Start with the layer closest to your hands.*

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose one layer to work on.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope all four boxes have a check mark in them by now.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Where It May Have Started

TODAY'S GOAL

Remember that you did not start it.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · LAMENTATIONS 5:7 (ESV)

Lamentations 5:7 says, "Our fathers sinned, and are no more; and we bear their iniquities." Lamentations is a collection of laments over the fall of Jerusalem in 586 BC. This verse is the cry of people feeling the weight of what came before. Notice that it is a lament, not a doctrine. It describes pain and does not command anyone to accept it forever.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Early research on abuse found that a minority (often cited around one-third) of abused children went on to abuse their own children, which means most did not. The finding is old and debated, but it supports the point that the pattern can be broken.

Source: Kaufman & Zigler, 1987. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write: "It started before me. The first person in my family I know of who _____ was _____." If you do not know, write "I do not know."
- 2 ☐ Write: "I am not the beginning of this."
- 3 ☐ Write: "I can be the end of it."
- 4 ☐ Pray: "Lord, I name what I have inherited. I am asking you to meet me here."
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What do I know about my mother's own childhood?

2. What do I not know, and can I let that be?

3. How does understanding differ from excusing for me?

SOFT ACTION

Write one possible starting place for one pattern. Label it "maybe."

SUPPLICATION

Lord, You know what I cannot find. Bring light where it helps and mercy where it does not. Amen.

Understanding is not excusing. It is seeing clearly.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: LAMENTATIONS 5:7

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Where It May Have Started

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"Our fathers sinned, and are no more; and we bear their iniquities."

Lamentations 5:7 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Four small changes can be more powerful than one big promise. Start with the one in reach.

"The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want. He makes me lie down in green pastures. He leads me beside still waters. He restores my soul."

Ps 23:1-3 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You are not the origin, but you may be the interruption.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to be the one who interrupts.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you see that you are a link, and you can be the last link of that kind.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Standing in the Gap for a Family That Didn't Stand for You

TODAY'S GOAL

Stand in the gap in prayer, without taking on the family's sin as your debt.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • NEHEMIAH 1:6 (ESV)

In Nehemiah 1:6 Nehemiah prays, “let your ear be attentive and your eyes open, to hear the prayer of your servant that I now pray before you day and night for the people of Israel your servants, confessing the sins of the people of Israel, which we have sinned against you. Even I and my father’s house have sinned.” He was cupbearer to the Persian king, hearing that Jerusalem’s walls were broken. He prays honestly, includes himself, and then acts.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

A review of studies on Alcoholics Anonymous and similar programs found that they were as effective as or more effective than other treatments at helping people stay abstinent, and they cost less. Community matters in recovery.

Source: Kelly et al., 2020. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write one prayer for your family, naming what you see: “Lord, we have struggled with _____.”
- 2 ☐ Write one honest line about yourself: “I too have _____.”
- 3 ☐ Write one action that follows the prayer, as Nehemiah’s did (go to a meeting, book an appointment, call someone).
- 4 ☐ Do the action today or schedule it.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

Standing in the Gap for a Family That Didn't Stand for You

CYCLE-BREAKING · WARFARE

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Hold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

"let your ear be attentive and your eyes open, to hear the prayer of your servant that I now pray before you day and night for the people of Israel your servants, confessing the sins of the people of Israel, which we have sinned against you. Even I and my father's house have sinned."

NEHEMIAH 1:6 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Nehemiah prayed for his people with the words we have sinned, including himself. Daniel did too. Many believers find this meaningful for family patterns: you do not take on their guilt, you agree with God about what is true, and you ask for mercy on your line. It is a practice to consider, not a requirement for freedom or a magic formula. If it does not sit right, skip it and talk to a pastor you trust. It may feel strange to pray for those who failed you; you can do it without defending them.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

7THE HOLY R3UP · STANDING · UNDERSTAND AND STAND

Date:

___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which pattern would I bring to God by name?

2. What would it be like to pray without defending anyone?

3. What do I want to ask God for the ones who come after me?

SOFT ACTION

Pray for one pattern in your family in your own words, with no one else listening.

SUPPLICATION

God, I stand in the gap with You for a family that did not stand for me. I tell the truth and ask for mercy.
Amen.

I stand in the gap as a daughter of this family. I do not defend it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: NEHEMIAH 1:6

God, I stand in the gap with You for the people I love.

*I can pray for my family without
defending them.*

□ Pray for one family member by name today.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Standing in the Gap for a Family That Didn't Stand for You

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“let your ear be attentive and your eyes open, to hear the prayer of your servant that I now pray before you day and night for the people of Israel your servants, confessing the sins of the people of Israel, which we have sinned against you. Even I and my father's house have sinned.”

Nehemiah 1:6 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You did not start this. You get to be the one who ends it, without taking on the blame for the start.

“What then shall we say to these things? If God is for us, who can be against us?”

Rom 8:31 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Standing in the gap is not paying the debt. It is leading the way out.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to pray and do something about it.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope that prayer led somewhere real. Prayer and a phone call can go together.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

A Prayer for the Line, Including Whoever Comes After You

TODAY'S GOAL

Write a prayer for those who came before and those who come after.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • EXODUS 34:6 (ESV)

Exodus 34:6 says, "The LORD, the LORD, a God merciful and gracious, slow to anger, and abounding in steadfast love and faithfulness." In the next verses God also says he visits the iniquity of fathers on the children to the third and fourth generation. Read together, verse 6 is the lead: his character is mercy. The generational line is a real consequence of sin spreading, while his steadfast love extends to thousands.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Writing about your best possible future, as in studies of life-goal writing, has been linked to better well-being. It tends to help most when you also say what you will do.

Source: King, 2001. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write a prayer for your parents (whatever their state), in your own words.
- 2 ☐ Write a prayer for yourself.
- 3 ☐ Write a prayer for anyone who comes after you (nieces, nephews, friends' children, people you will mentor).
- 4 ☐ Read all three aloud.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

Date:

---/---/---

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which pattern am I praying over?

2. Who comes after me, in any sense?

3. What am I willing to do differently in response?

SOFT ACTION

Pray the prayer once for one pattern. Write the date.

SUPPLICATION

Merciful Father, I bring this pattern and my family to You. Protect whoever comes after me. Begin with me. Amen.

I trust Jesus to carry what I cannot, and I will do the work of changing what I can.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: EXODUS 34:6

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- You can do the prayer and skip the step. That still counts.*

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

A Prayer for the Line, Including Whoever Comes After You

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"The LORD passed before him and proclaimed, "The LORD, the LORD, a God merciful and gracious, slow to anger, and abounding in steadfast love and faithfulness,""

Exodus 34:6 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You can pray for people you are not going near. Prayer does not require proximity.

"I have loved you with an everlasting love; therefore I have continued my faithfulness to you."

Jer 31:3 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You can pray for people without taking their place.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose mercy in both directions.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope that prayer is part of you now. The line can turn around.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Agreements We Repeat: "We're All Addicts"

TODAY'S GOAL

Replace one family saying with a true one.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • PROVERBS 26:2 (ESV)

Proverbs 26:2 says, "Like a sparrow in its flitting, like a swallow in its flying, a curse that is causeless does not alight." Proverbs uses vivid images from nature. The verse says an undeserved curse does not land. Words spoken over you that have no cause do not have the power they claimed.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Research on self-talk suggests that how you speak to yourself, even something as small as using your name, can change how a stress response feels. Replacing a familiar phrase with a new one takes repetition.

Source: Kross et al., 2014. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the saying you heard growing up (for example, "We're all addicts," "Nothing ever works out for us").
- 2 ☐ Write who said it and what they were afraid of.
- 3 ☐ Write a true replacement: "Some of us struggled. I am choosing recovery."
- 4 ☐ Say the replacement ten times today when you notice the old one.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which of these sentences do I say?

2. Who taught them to me?

3. What truer sentence could replace each?

SOFT ACTION

Cross out one family "we always" sentence and write a truer one beside it.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, I do not want to speak fate over myself. Put new words in my mouth. Amen.

That was never prophecy. It was a pattern, and it ends.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PROVERBS 26:2

Lord, put new words in my mouth.

That was never prophecy. It was a pattern, and it ends.

□ Say a true sentence aloud in place of a family sentence.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Agreements We Repeat: "We're All Addicts"

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Like a sparrow in its flitting, like a swallow in its flying, a curse that is causeless does not alight.”

Proverbs 26:2 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

A good prayer can be one sentence long. God is not waiting for a speech.

“The LORD is near to all who call on him, to all who call on him in truth.”

Ps 145:18 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

A saying repeated enough sounds like fate. It is not.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose words that match the future.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you catch the old words and swap them without thinking.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

New Behavior, Practiced Badly: Learning What Was Never Modeled

TODAY'S GOAL

Practice one thing nobody taught you, as a beginner.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • EPHESIANS 4:23-24 (ESV)

Ephesians 4:23–24 says, “and to be renewed in the spirit of your minds, and to put on the new self, created after the likeness of God in true righteousness and holiness.” Paul talks about taking off the old self and putting on the new, like changing clothes. It is something you practice, not something you feel your way into.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Bandura's research on learning suggests that people learn by watching others and by practicing in small steps, and that early successes increase confidence. Being a beginner is a normal part of learning.

Source: Bandura, 1977. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Choose one skill nobody taught you (asking for help, saying no, budgeting, apologizing, resting).
- 2 ☐ Watch or read about it for ten minutes (a safe person, a short video, a book).
- 3 ☐ Practice it once today in a small way.
- 4 ☐ Write what happened and how it felt.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

CYCLE-BREAKING · ADDICTION

Look around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.*

"and to be renewed in the spirit of your minds, and to put on the new self, created after the likeness of God in true righteousness and holiness."

EPHESIANS 4:23-24 · ESV

You can renounce a pattern perfectly and still repeat it, because nobody ever showed you something different. Prayer closes a door. Practice builds a house. You may have to learn calm, boundaries, money, rest, and asking for help like a second language. Find someone who does the thing you never saw: a sponsor, a mentor, a therapist, a friend with a steady life, and get close enough to watch. Practice badly on purpose, because practicing badly is how it is learned. This is also reparenting yourself.

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Date: ___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What behavior did I inherit?

2. What is the one I am building instead?

3. Who can I watch or learn from?

SOFT ACTION

Choose one replacement behavior and tell your sponsor, counselor, or a friend what it is.

SUPPLICATION

Father, teach me what I was never shown. Give me patience with myself and with the slow pace of learning. Amen.

I am not just closing a door. I am building a different house.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: EPHESIANS 4:23-24

Father, teach her what she was never shown.

I am allowed to learn slowly.

- Ask someone to teach you one small thing.

WHAT SHE SAID • WHAT I NOTICED

New Behavior, Practiced Badly: Learning What Was Never Modeled

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“and to be renewed in the spirit of your minds, and to put on the new self, created after the likeness of God in true righteousness and holiness.”

Ephesians 4:23-24 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Nobody taught you. That is not your failing. It is a gap, and gaps can be filled.

“And I am sure of this, that he who began a good work in you will bring it to completion at the day of Jesus Christ.”

Phil 1:6 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Not knowing is not the same as not being able.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to practice badly.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you are no longer ashamed to be a beginner. Everyone who is good at something was bad at it first.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Honor Without Repeating

TODAY'S GOAL

Honor without repeating.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • EXODUS 20:12 (ESV)

Exodus 20:12 says, "Honor your father and your mother, that your days may be long in the land that the LORD your God is giving you." It is the fifth of the Ten Commandments. In the Bible, honor is not blind obedience to harm, and elsewhere in Scripture God warns against abuse and calls parents to care for their children. Honor can mean treating someone with basic dignity, telling the truth about them, and keeping your distance when needed.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Attachment research suggests that people with painful childhoods can build secure relationships over time, even if they keep boundaries with their families. Distance and dignity are not opposites.

Source: Roisman et al., 2002. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write one way you can honor your parent(s) without getting hurt (pray for them, speak kindly of the good, keep the peace from a distance).
- 2 ☐ Write one thing that would not be honor (taking blame, enabling, lying).
- 3 ☐ Write one boundary you will keep.
- 4 ☐ Say, "I can honor the person without repeating the pattern."
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

MOTHER WOUND · CYCLE-BREAKING

Press your palms together, then let go. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.*

"Honor your father and your mother, that your days may be long in the land that the LORD your God is giving you."

EXODUS 20:12 · ESV

You can honor your parents and refuse their pattern. Honor is not obedience, agreement, access, or silence. It means you do not degrade them, you do not build your identity on hating them, and you do not hand them your life as payment. If your mother failed to protect you, honoring may look like praying for her from a distance, speaking truthfully of her, and keeping safe boundaries. It is not betrayal to be the one who stopped it.

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SACRED REFLECTION

1. What can I genuinely honor about where I came from?

2. What am I refusing to carry forward?

3. What boundary protects both of us?

SOFT ACTION

Write one honest good thing about each parent, if there is one. Then one thing you will not repeat.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, You asked me to honor, and You never asked me to be hurt. Show me what honor looks like safely. Amen.

I honor where I came from. I am not repeating it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: EXODUS 20:12

Lord, show me what honor looks like safely.

I honor where I came from. I am not repeating it.

□ Send a safe, kind, short note to someone from your past who was good to you.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Honor Without Repeating

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Honor your father and your mother, that your days may be long in the land that the LORD your God is giving you.”

Exodus 20:12 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You can honor someone from a safe distance, with the truth in one hand and a boundary in the other.

“Trust in him at all times, O people; pour out your heart before him; God is a refuge for us.”

Ps 62:8 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Honor is not a blank check.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose honor with boundaries.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope your honor is clean: truth, dignity, and distance as needed.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

The Line Stops Here: How You Do Not Carry It On

TODAY'S GOAL

Write the promise: the line stops here.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • JOSHUA 24:15 (ESV)

Joshua 24:15 says, "And if it is disagreeable in your sight to serve the LORD, choose this day whom you will serve, whether the gods your fathers served in the region beyond the River, or the gods of the Amorites in whose land you dwell. But as for me and my house, we will serve the LORD." Joshua says this at Shechem, near the end of his life. Notice "choose this day." He names what came before and picks anyway.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Specific, written commitments with if-then plans are linked to higher follow-through. The more concrete the promise, the more likely it is to be kept.

Source: Gollwitzer, 1999. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write: "The line stops with me. This means _____. " Be specific (I will stay in recovery, I will get help, I will tell the truth).
- 2 ☐ Write: "If I am tempted to _____, then I will _____."
- 3 ☐ Sign and date the promise.
- 4 ☐ Show it to one safe person or put it where you can see it.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

CYCLE-BREAKING · WARFARE

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Sit with your back against something solid. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

"And if it is evil in your eyes to serve the LORD, choose this day whom you will serve... But as for me and my house, we will serve the LORD."

JOSHUA 24:15 · ESV

Write it, sign it, put it where you will see it. Three things that end with me. Three things that begin with me. Not carrying it on is not one prayer; it is a way of living. It means staying in recovery. Staying in therapy. Choosing safe partners and safe friends. Not handing your pain to people who did not cause it. If you ever raise children, mentor, or love someone vulnerable, you will have done your healing first. And it means blessing the people around you with what nobody gave you.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

Date: ___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Three things that end with me:

2. Three things that begin with me:

3. Who will I bless this week?

SOFT ACTION

Write your declaration and sign it. Bless one person aloud, by name.

SUPPLICATION

God, let it stop here, with You and with me. I place whoever comes after me in Your hands. Amen.

I can be the pivot. I am choosing to turn what was meant to bury my family into something that frees it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: JOSHUA 24:15

God, let it stop here, with You and with me.

I am the pivot, and I do not have to be perfect.

□ Read your promise aloud once.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Line Stops Here: How You Do Not Carry It On

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“And if it is evil in your eyes to serve the LORD, choose this day whom you will serve... But as for me and my house, we will serve the LORD.”

Joshua 24:15 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Sign your name to your own promise. You have kept worse ones for other people.

“Have I not commanded you? Be strong and courageous. Do not be frightened, and do not be dismayed, for the LORD your God is with you wherever you go.”

Josh 1:9 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You are not carrying it on. You are carrying it out.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to sign my name to a new direction.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you still have that signed promise. Look at it on the days you feel like giving up.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

ARC 5 REVIEW

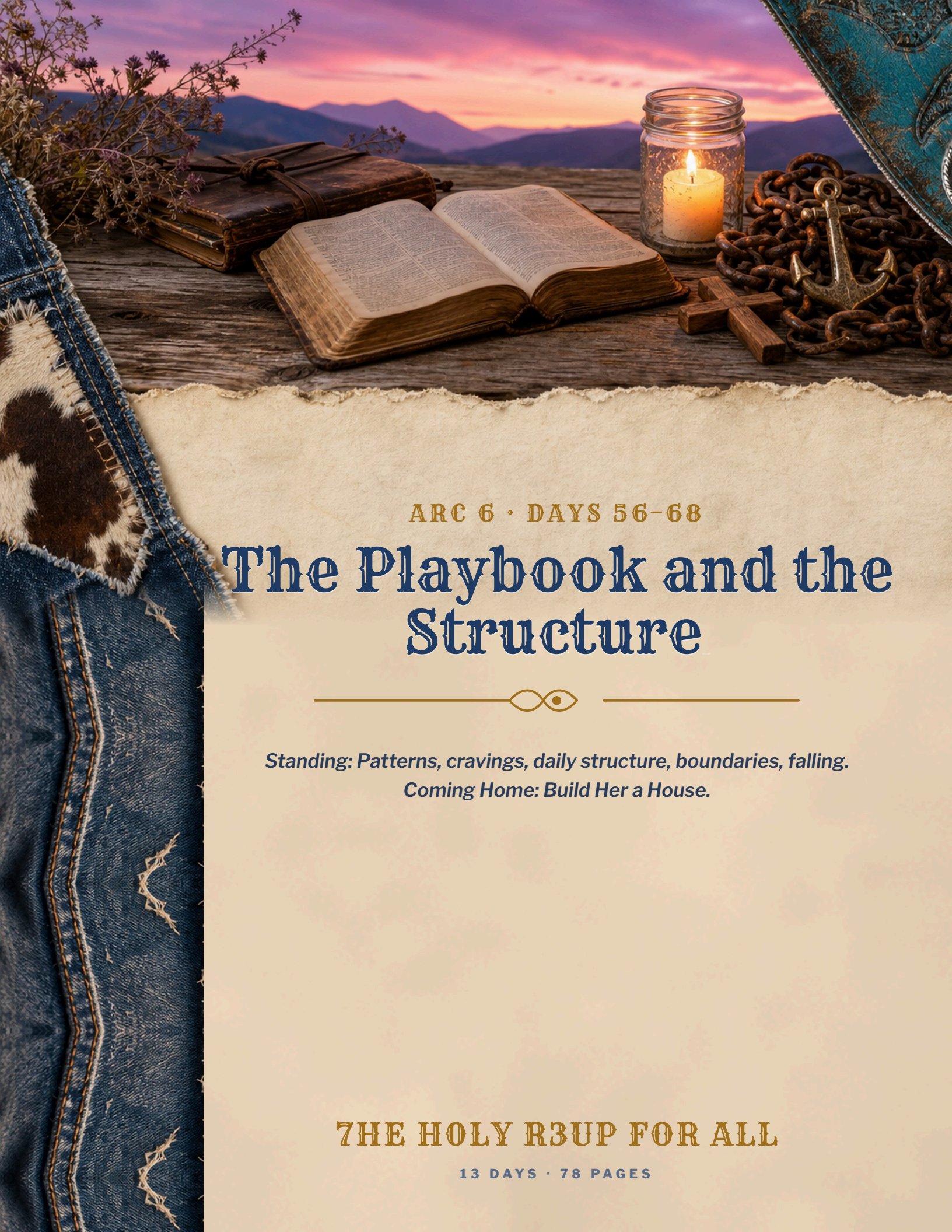
Looking Back: The Bloodline

A few honest lines before you turn the page. This sheet also keeps each arc starting on a fresh sheet of paper for your binder.

WHAT DID I TELL THE TRUTH ABOUT IN THIS ARC?

WHAT WAS HARDEST, AND WHAT HELPED?

WHAT DO I WANT TO CARRY INTO THE NEXT ARC?



ARC 6 • DAYS 56-68

The Playbook and the Structure



Standing: Patterns, cravings, daily structure, boundaries, falling.

Coming Home: Build Her a House.

THE HOLY R3UP FOR ALL

13 DAYS • 78 PAGES

Twelve Patterns

TODAY'S GOAL

Learn your own list of patterns, the way an investigator would.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · 2 CORINTHIANS 2:11 (ESV)

Second Corinthians 2:11 says, “so that we would not be outwitted by Satan; for we are not ignorant of his designs.” Paul has just urged the church to forgive and comfort a repentant man. He says being unforgiving would give Satan an advantage. Knowing the patterns of temptation and division is a defensive skill.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Relapse-prevention research found that identifying high-risk situations (people, places, feelings) and planning responses to them helps people avoid a lapse becoming a full relapse.

Source: Marlatt & Gordon, 1985. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ List your top three high-risk situations (for example, payday, being alone at night, arguments).
- 2 ☐ Next to each write the early warning sign (a thought, a feeling, a pull).
- 3 ☐ Next to each write your plan (call, leave, eat, pray).
- 4 ☐ Share one with a safe person.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · MOTHER WOUND

Take a slow sip of water. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

2 CORINTHIANS 2:11 · ESV

Volume II lays out twelve patterns that show up in the lives of people who have been hurt and stuck: being unwanted, early wounds, a false name, isolation, a coping tool, a shame loop, agreements, normalizing, passing it on, derailing the calling, waiting too long, silencing the story. This is a pattern-recognition tool, not a revealed schedule. Scripture also says much of our trouble comes from our own hearts, other people, and a broken world. Use it to notice, not to decide every hard thing was a scripted attack, and never to blame yourself for what was done to you.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which of the twelve patterns do I recognize?

2. Which is loudest right now?

3. What would I need to interrupt it?

SOFT ACTION

Mark the two patterns that fit you best. Do not analyze. Just notice.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, I do not want to be outwitted, and I do not want to see attacks everywhere. Give me clear eyes. Amen.

I can read the pattern now. Predictable is beatable.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: 2 CORINTHIANS 2:11

Lord, give clear eyes, not fear.

I can read the pattern now.

- Do one thing today that breaks one pattern.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Twelve Patterns

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“so that we would not be outwitted by Satan; for we are not ignorant of his designs.”

2 Corinthians 2:11 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

The pattern is easier to see when you stop being ashamed of it. Take a look.

“Your word is a lamp to my feet and a light to my path.”

Ps 119:105 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Naming the pattern is half of stopping it.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to see it coming.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you know your patterns so well that you see them coming and step aside.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Isolation: Your Family Taught You to Be Alone

TODAY'S GOAL

Reach out to one person today. Not tomorrow.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · ECCLESIASTES 4:9-10 (ESV)

Ecclesiastes 4:9–10 says, “Two are better than one, because they have a good reward for their toil. For if they fall, one will lift up his fellow. But woe to him who is alone when he falls and has not another to lift him up!” The author, called the Preacher, is looking at life under the sun and sees the cost of isolation. Companionship is described as a practical good.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

A large analysis found that stronger social connection was associated with a substantially lower risk of death, on a scale comparable to well-known health risks. Isolation is a real risk, not just a mood.

Source: Holt-Lunstad et al., 2010. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the name of one person you can contact (safe, even if you only know them a little).
- 2 ☐ Write what you will say: “I’m having a rough day. Do you have ten minutes?”
- 3 ☐ Send it now.
- 4 ☐ If they do not respond, write a second name and try again.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

Isolation: Your Family Taught You to Be Alone

ADDICTION · MOTHER WOUND

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Feel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

"Two are better than one, because they have a good reward for their toil. For if they fall, one will lift up his fellow. But woe to him who is alone when he falls and has no one to lift him up!"

ECCLESIASTES 4:9-10 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Isolation makes almost every harm worse. Abusers isolate. Addiction isolates. Families that keep secrets isolate their children, and a baby who learned that no one comes may still believe it. This is why you need five kinds of people, not one: the one who knows everything, the one further ahead, the one behind you, the one who is just a friend, and the one allowed to correct you. A meeting, a sponsor, a counselor, and a church small group can fill the first of these.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

Date:

___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which of the five roles is empty for me?

2. Where could I find one this month?

3. What keeps me from reaching out?

SOFT ACTION

Write the five roles with one name beside each, or a blank. Choose one blank to work on.

SUPPLICATION

God, You settle the solitary in a home. Put people around me, and give me courage to let them in. Amen.

I will not do this alone. Alone was the plan, not the answer.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: ECCLESIASTES 4:9-10

God, settle the solitary in a home.

She is not alone, and neither am I.

- Reach out to one person you have lost touch with.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Isolation: Your Family Taught You to Be Alone

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Two are better than one, because they have a good reward for their toil. For if they fall, one will lift up his fellow. But woe to him who is alone when he falls and has no one to lift him up!”

Ecclesiastes 4:9-10 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You are not a burden. You are a person who is allowed to need.

“Let us then with confidence draw near to the throne of grace, that we may receive mercy and find grace to help in time of need.”

Heb 4:16 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You are allowed to need help. That is what other people are for.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to reach before I fall.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you have a person you reach for without thinking. If it is still hard, keep reaching.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Who Can Tell You You're Wrong

TODAY'S GOAL

Let someone who loves you tell you the truth.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · PROVERBS 27:17 (ESV)

Proverbs 27:17 says, "Iron sharpens iron, and one man sharpens another." Verse 6 in the same chapter adds, "Faithful are the wounds of a friend; profuse are the kisses of an enemy." Proverbs treats honest friends as a gift. It also assumes you pick them with care.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Mutual-help and peer-support groups have been shown in reviews to support recovery, partly through accountability and shared experience. Being known by people who care is protective.

Source: Kelly et al., 2020. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the name of one person who has told you the truth in love (or one you would trust to).
- 2 ☐ Write one question to ask them: "What do you see that I am missing?"
- 3 ☐ Ask it this week and listen without defending.
- 4 ☐ Write one thing you heard and one thing you will do about it.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

CYCLE-BREAKING · WARFARE

Hold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.*

PROVERBS 27:17 · ESV

A person who cannot be corrected is dangerous, and that includes a survivor who has been wrong-footed so many times she can only defend. If nobody is allowed to tell you you are wrong, that is this month's assignment. Correction from someone who loves you is a gift, and it is uncomfortable. Learn to hear it without collapsing into shame or attacking in defense. Teachable people break cycles; defended people repeat them.

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SACRED REFLECTION

1. Who is allowed to tell me I am wrong?

2. How did I take it the last time?

3. What would help me receive correction without falling apart?

SOFT ACTION

Ask one trusted person, "What is one thing I could hear that would help me?" Listen without answering.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, make me teachable. Give me friends who will tell me the truth with love. Amen.

I would rather be corrected than be impressive.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PROVERBS 27:17

Lord, make me teachable.

*I would rather be helped than
impressive.*

- Ask for help with one small thing.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Who Can Tell You You're Wrong

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Iron sharpens iron, and one man sharpens another.”

Proverbs 27:17 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Let someone tell you the truth in love. It might be the kindest thing you do for yourself.

“Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and do not lean on your own understanding. In all your ways acknowledge him, and he will make straight your paths.”

Prov 3:5–6 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

The right friend will say what you need to hear, not just what you want.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose honest company.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you chose your people well and kept them. Sharp friends keep you from going dull.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Running Out the Clock

TODAY'S GOAL

Stop waiting for permission to start.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · EPHESIANS 5:15-16 (ESV)

Ephesians 5:15–16 says, “Look carefully then how you walk, not as unwise but as wise, making the best use of the time, because the days are evil.” Paul urges careful, intentional living. “Making the best use of the time” points to seizing opportunities, not to panic.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Habit research shows that new behaviors become easier with daily repetition, and that missing a day here and there does not ruin the process. Starting small and starting now matters more than starting perfectly.

Source: Lally et al., 2010. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write one thing you have been waiting to start (treatment, a call, a job application, a meeting, a hobby).
- 2 ☐ Make the first step ridiculously small (find a phone number, write one sentence).
- 3 ☐ Do that step in the next 10 minutes.
- 4 ☐ Write when you will do the next step.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

ADDICTION · CYCLE-BREAKING

Name three things you can see and one thing you can hear. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.*

EPHESIANS 5:15-16 · ESV

One of the most common traps is not destruction. It is delay. Someday I will get sober. Someday I will tell the truth. When I am ready. A woman who is going to change soon for thirty years has changed nothing. This is not a call to panic or perfection. It is an invitation to pick one small, real step with a date on it. Every day you wait is a day the pattern keeps running.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What have I been about to do for years?

2. What is the smallest version I could do this week?

3. Who will hold me to it?

SOFT ACTION

Put one date on the calendar for one small step. Tell one person.

SUPPLICATION

Father, redeem the time I have lost, and help me not to waste today. Amen.

Not someday. Today has a date on it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: EPHESIANS 5:15-16

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Running Out the Clock

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Look carefully then how you walk, not as unwise but as wise, making the best use of the time, because the days are evil.”

Ephesians 5:15-16 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Today is a fine day to start. So is tomorrow. But today has the advantage of being here.

“but they who wait for the LORD shall renew their strength; they shall mount up with wings like eagles; they shall run and not be weary; they shall walk and not faint.”

Isa 40:31 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Waiting for the perfect time is how the years pass.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose the first step.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you are not waiting on anything anymore. Look what the first small step started.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

The Trigger Chain: When Abandonment Is the Link

TODAY'S GOAL

Map one trigger chain from start to finish.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · 1 PETER 5:8-9 (ESV)

First Peter 5:8–9 says, “Be sober-minded; be watchful. Your adversary the devil prowls around like a roaring lion, seeking someone to devour. Resist him, firm in your faith, knowing that the same kinds of suffering are being experienced by your brotherhood throughout the world.” Peter writes to believers facing persecution. “Sober-minded” and “watchful” describe alert, steady attention. “Resist him, firm in your faith” puts the weight on staying planted, not on running around.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Research on urge surfing and mindfulness-based relapse prevention suggests that cravings rise, peak, and pass, and that noticing the process without acting can reduce relapse risk. Cravings tend to be shorter than they feel.

Source: Bowen & Marlatt, 2009. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Pick the last time you felt a strong urge or fell into an old pattern.
- 2 ☐ Write the chain: What happened first? Then what did you feel? Then what did you think? Then what did you do?
- 3 ☐ Circle the earliest link where you could have done something different.
- 4 ☐ Write what you would do at that link next time.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

Date:

___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What does my chain look like, step by step?

2. Which link is earliest and detectable?

3. What will I do the moment I see it?

SOFT ACTION

Write your chain and circle the earliest link. Write one action for it, such as a phone call or a walk.

SUPPLICATION

God, help me see the early links, and give me a plan for the moment I feel left alone. Amen.

I fight at link three. Link seven is not a fight, it is a formality.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: 1 PETER 5:8-9

God, show us the early link.

I can catch it early.

- Set a daily alarm labeled with your early-link action.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Trigger Chain: When Abandonment Is the Link

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Be sober-minded; be watchful. Your adversary the devil prowls around like a roaring lion, seeking someone to devour. Resist him, firm in your faith, knowing that the same kinds of suffering are being experienced by your brotherhood throughout the world.”

1 Peter 5:8-9 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You can name a chain without being chained. Look at it, then break the weakest link.

“He drew me up from the pit of destruction, out of the miry bog, and set my feet upon a rock, making my steps secure.”

Ps 40:2 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Triggers are chains. Break the chain at the weakest link.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to interrupt the chain early.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you catch it at the first link now. The earlier you act, the easier it is.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

HALT: Hungry, Angry, Lonely, Tired

TODAY'S GOAL

Run the HALT check on yourself: hungry, angry, lonely, tired.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · PSALM 127:2 (ESV)

Psalm 127:2 says, "It is in vain that you rise up early and go late to rest, eating the bread of anxious toil; for he gives to his beloved sleep." Psalm 127 is a song of ascents attributed to Solomon, and it opens with "Unless the LORD builds the house, those who build it labor in vain." Rest is presented as a gift, not a weakness.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

HALT is a recovery slogan, not a study. But the states it names (hunger, anger, loneliness, tiredness) match the kinds of situations relapse-prevention researchers describe as raising the risk of a lapse. Checking in on your basic needs is a simple, practical defense.

Source: Marlatt & Gordon, 1985. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Ask yourself four questions out loud: Am I hungry? Angry? Lonely? Tired? Say yes or no to each.
- 2 ☐ Fix the first yes. Eat something with protein. Drink water. Text someone. Lie down for 20 minutes.
- 3 ☐ Write what you will keep in your bag or kitchen so the first one is easy (nuts, a granola bar, water).
- 4 ☐ Set one reminder on your phone at your usual low point of the day: "HALT."
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

ADDICTION · CYCLE-BREAKING

Look around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

PSALM 127:2 · ESV

Many relapses are several of these stacked, and they are rarely only about the substance. Lonely is the one that hits hardest for a child who was left. Some of what feels like a craving is blood sugar. Some of what feels like despair is sleep. Run the check three times a day: what is loudest, and what can I do about it in the next hour? Feed yourself, rest, call someone, calm your body. That is how you give yourself what no one gave you.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which of the four is loudest right now?

2. What can I do about it in the next hour?

3. Who could I call when it is lonely?

SOFT ACTION

Eat something real and drink water. Set a bedtime and put the phone out of reach.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, You give Your beloved sleep. Help me care for myself like someone worth caring for. Amen.

I will feed, rest, call, and calm before I decide anything.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 127:2

Lord, You give Your beloved sleep.

I will feed, rest, call, and calm first.

□ Go to bed on time tonight with the phone out of the room.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

HALT: Hungry, Angry, Lonely, Tired

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"It is in vain that you rise up early and go late to rest, eating the bread of anxious toil; for he gives to his beloved sleep."

Psalm 127:2 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Rest is not something you earn after you fix everything.
You are allowed it before.

"Come to me, all who labor and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest."

Matt 11:28 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

A tired mind makes bad decisions. Rest is a spiritual practice.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to meet my basic needs before I fight anything else.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you take care of the basics first without thinking about it. Nobody can pray their way out of an empty stomach.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

The Craving Wave

TODAY'S GOAL

Ride one craving wave from start to finish without acting on it.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · 1 CORINTHIANS 10:13 (ESV)

First Corinthians 10:13 says, “No temptation has overtaken you that is not common to man. God is faithful, and he will not let you be tempted beyond your ability, but with the temptation he will also provide the way of escape, that you may be able to endure it.” Paul is writing to a church in Corinth about Israel’s failures in the wilderness. The promise is that there is a way out, and it comes with the temptation, not after.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Studies of “urge surfing,” in which people notice a craving rise and fall instead of fighting or obeying it, suggest that cravings tend to peak and pass within a limited time. A mindfulness-based relapse prevention program reduced substance use over time in one large trial. These tools support treatment. They do not replace it.

Source: Bowen & Marlatt, 2009. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ When the craving hits, say, “This is a wave.” Set a timer for 10 minutes.
- 2 ☐ Notice where you feel it in your body. Rate it from 0 to 10 every two minutes and write the number.
- 3 ☐ Breathe in for 4, out for 6, and drink a full glass of water.
- 4 ☐ When the timer ends, notice whether the number moved. Write it down.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration. If the craving is dangerous, call someone, go to a meeting, or call 988 or SAMHSA at 1-800-662-4357.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Who are the three numbers I will call, memorized?

2. What changes my body fastest?

3. What is my short prayer?

SOFT ACTION

Write your three numbers on a card and tape one copy where you will see it.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, I do not have to win this hour, only this wave. Give me a way out and the sense to take it. Amen.

I only have to outlast a wave. It always breaks.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: 1 CORINTHIANS 10:13

Jesus, I only have to outlast this wave.

I can outlast a wave. It always breaks.

- Practice your wave plan once when you are calm.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Craving Wave

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“No temptation has overtaken you that is not common to man. God is faithful, and he will not let you be tempted beyond your ability, but with the temptation he will also provide the way of escape, that you may be able to endure it.”

1 Corinthians 10:13 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

A wave is not the ocean. Ride it. It breaks.

“God is our refuge and strength, a very present help in trouble.”

Ps 46:1 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

A craving is loud, but it is not permanent.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to outlast the wave.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you have a whole page of numbers going down. They are proof the wave passes.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Play the Tape Forward: Who Else Pays

TODAY'S GOAL

Play the tape forward and see who else would pay.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · PROVERBS 14:12 (ESV)

Proverbs 14:12 says, "There is a way that seems right to a man, but its end is the way to death." The verse is repeated word for word in Proverbs 16:25. Proverbs urges people to look at where a path ends, not just how it feels at the start.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

In studies, people who were shown realistic images of their future selves made choices that favored their future more than people who were not. Seeing the end of the story makes it feel more real.

Source: Hershfield et al., 2011. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the choice you are tempted by.
- 2 ☐ Write what happens in the first hour, the next day, and the next month if you do it. Be honest and specific.
- 3 ☐ Write who else is affected (people, animals, your future).
- 4 ☐ Write the other tape: what happens in each of those windows if you do not.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration. Read the second tape out loud.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

ADDICTION · CYCLE-BREAKING

Sit with your back against something solid. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

PROVERBS 14:12 · ESV

Not the first hour. The forty-eighth. The call you would have to make. The face you would have to look at. Write it now, while you are clear, because you will not be able to write it in the moment. Add the people who would pay: your sponsor, your friends, whoever looks up to you, whoever you hope to be a different example for. Include where the naloxone is if opioids are in your history. This is not a scare tactic. It is a gift to your future self.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. If I use today, what happens within forty-eight hours?

2. Whose face do I see?

3. What do I most want to protect?

SOFT ACTION

Write your tape on a card. Keep it where you keep your keys.

SUPPLICATION

God, I want to keep what You have given me. Let me remember it when I cannot think. Amen.

I decide this now, while I can still think.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PROVERBS 14:12

God, let me remember what matters when I cannot think.

I decide this now, while I can still think.

Put your note somewhere you will find it in a hard moment.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Play the Tape Forward: Who Else Pays

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"There is a way that seems right to a man, but its end is the way to death."

Proverbs 14:12 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Play the whole tape. Then call someone. Both help.

"When I am afraid, I put my trust in you."

Ps 56:3 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

The first minute is persuasive. The tenth minute is honest.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to watch the whole tape.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you can see tomorrow clearly enough that tonight is not so loud.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Replace the Function: What Your Mother Couldn't Give

TODAY'S GOAL

Find three better comforts for the same need.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · ISAIAH 55:2 (ESV)

Isaiah 55:2 says, "Why do you spend your money for that which is not bread, and your labor for that which does not satisfy? Listen diligently to me, and eat what is good, and delight yourselves in rich food." It is part of God's open invitation to the thirsty to "come, buy and eat" without money. The question is about what satisfies, and it invites real nourishment.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Behavioral activation research suggests that adding even small, rewarding activities can lift mood over time, and that people often do not feel like doing them until after they begin. Replace a coping tool with another coping tool, not with a blank.

Source: Dimidjian et al., 2006. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ List the three moments you most reach for the old comfort (after work, at night, after conflict).
- 2 ☐ Next to each write a replacement that uses a different sense: warm shower, loud song, a walk, cold water, a call, a snack, a candle.
- 3 ☐ Put the replacement within reach (in your bag, on your nightstand).
- 4 ☐ Use one tonight. Write how you felt after.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

ADDICTION · MOTHER WOUND

Take a slow sip of water. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.*

ISAIAH 55:2 · ESV

You cannot leave a vacancy. For every job the substance did, find a legitimate replacement. It numbed pain, so find a place to put pain: therapy, a journal, a friend. It gave energy, so find food, movement, sleep. It gave belonging, so find a meeting or a church group. It quieted your head, so find music, a walk, or silence. It held you, so find real human touch, safe and chosen, and the comfort practices you are learning. God invites us to what satisfies.

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Date:

___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What jobs did it do for me?

2. What legitimate replacement could do each job?

3. When will I do it?

SOFT ACTION

Complete the job and replacement list from Day 39. Choose one to start today.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, I do not want to leave an empty room. Fill it with what is good. Amen.

I am not removing something. I am replacing it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: ISAIAH 55:2

Lord, fill the place the old comfort filled.

I can comfort her in ways that do not cost us.

- Use one item from the comfort box today, even if you are okay.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Replace the Function: What Your Mother Couldn't Give

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Why do you spend your money for that which is not bread, and your labor for that which does not satisfy? Listen diligently to me, and eat what is good, and delight yourselves in rich food.”

Isaiah 55:2 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

A better comfort exists. It may take a few tries to find it. Keep trying.

“The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want. He makes me lie down in green pastures. He leads me beside still waters. He restores my soul.”

Ps 23:1-3 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

A comfort is not the enemy. A comfort that costs your life is.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose comfort that does not charge interest.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope your comfort kit is worn and well loved.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Fill the House

TODAY'S GOAL

Fill one space in your home or day with something good.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · ROMANS 12:21 (ESV)

Romans 12:21 says, "Do not be overcome by evil, but overcome evil with good." Paul has just told believers not to repay evil for evil and to live peaceably as far as it depends on them. The verse is practical: overcome by doing good, not just by avoiding the bad.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Research on behavioral activation and on environment design suggests that filling empty time and space with planned, meaningful activity makes old habits less automatic. Empty time is risky time.

Source: Dimidjian et al., 2006. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Pick one empty block of time (for example, Friday at 8 p.m.).
- 2 ☐ Pick one good thing to put in it: a meeting, a class, a call, a walk, a craft, church, volunteering.
- 3 ☐ Pick one thing in your home to change (remove something, add something: a candle, a verse, a photo of Big Boy, plants).
- 4 ☐ Do the home change today.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · CYCLE-BREAKING

Feel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.*

ROMANS 12:21 · ESV

Jesus tells a story of a swept house left empty (Luke 11:24-26), and the last state was worse than the first. Whatever your view of the spiritual side, the practical truth stands: when something leaves your life, something must take its place. Where fear lived, put love. Where shame lived, put belonging. Where craving lived, put satisfaction. For a home, this can mean worship music, a routine, a regular meal, a table prayer. Overcome with good, in small and visible ways.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What am I emptying that needs filling?

2. What small good thing could fill it?

3. What would my "filled" home feel like?

SOFT ACTION

Choose one new, simple good habit for your home this week. Start tonight.

SUPPLICATION

Holy Spirit, fill every room that has been emptied. Leave nothing vacant. Amen.

Holy Spirit, occupy every room. Leave nothing empty.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: ROMANS 12:21

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Fill the House

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Do not be overcome by evil, but overcome evil with good.”

Romans 12:21 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

An empty hour is a lot easier to fill on purpose than by accident.

“And let us not grow weary of doing good, for in due season we will reap, if we do not give up.”

Gal 6:9 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Good does not get in only by pushing the bad out. Fill the room.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to fill my time on purpose.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope there are no empty hours that scare you anymore.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Architecture, Not Willpower

TODAY'S GOAL

Build a small daily structure that you can keep when you are tired.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · 1 CORINTHIANS 14:40 (ESV)

First Corinthians 14:40 says, "But all things should be done decently and in order." Paul is giving instructions for worship in Corinth, where meetings had become chaotic. Applied to daily life, it supports building routines. That is an application of the principle, not what the verse is directly about.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Habit research suggests that routines tied to a consistent place and time become more automatic, so they depend less on motivation. This is why the same wake-up, meal, and wind-down times can steady a hard season.

Source: Wood & Neal, 2007. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write a simple morning routine with only three steps (for example: water, pray two minutes, make bed).
- 2 ☐ Write an evening routine with three steps (for example: dishes, shower, lights low).
- 3 ☐ Put both on a card on your fridge or mirror.
- 4 ☐ Do the morning routine tomorrow, even if you do not feel like it.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

ADDICTION · CYCLE-BREAKING

Hold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.*

1 CORINTHIANS 14:40 · ESV

Freedom is architecture. Same wake hour. Sunlight in the first hour. Prayer out loud. Protein and water before caffeine. Movement. A HALT check. A meeting or a call. Same bedtime, phone out of the room. Pick the three that matter most and let the others wait. If you did not grow up with structure, you are building it from scratch, and that is hard and holy. Sleep affects almost everything else.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which piece of daily structure am I missing most?

2. What is the smallest version I could try?

3. What would I need to ask someone for?

SOFT ACTION

Choose three anchors for your day and write them where you can see them.

SUPPLICATION

God, You are a God of order. Help me build a day I can stand on. Amen.

Freedom is architecture. I am building the walls.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: 1 CORINTHIANS 14:40

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Architecture, Not Willpower

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“But all things should be done decently and in order.”

1 Corinthians 14:40 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

The routine you can keep when you are tired is the right routine.

“The steadfast love of the LORD never ceases; his mercies never come to an end; they are new every morning; great is your faithfulness.”

Lam 3:22–23 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Structure is a kindness to the tired version of you.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose a routine I can keep on a bad day.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope the routine is so ordinary now that you only notice it on the days it is missing.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Boundaries With Family, With Her, With Him

TODAY'S GOAL

Draw one boundary with family, with her, or with him.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · PROVERBS 4:23 (ESV)

Proverbs 4:23 says, "Keep your heart with all vigilance, for from it flow the springs of life." It is part of a father's advice to his son about wisdom. Guarding the heart is described as an act of care for the source of your life, not as coldness.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Self-efficacy research suggests that taking small, successful actions builds confidence for larger ones. Setting and keeping a small boundary makes the next one easier.

Source: Bandura, 1977. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write one boundary you need: "I will not _____. "I will _____ instead."
- 2 ☐ Write the exact words you will say: "I can't talk about that. I'm going to go now."
- 3 ☐ Practice saying it aloud twice.
- 4 ☐ Write what you will do if the person pushes back.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What boundary do I need to set?

2. How will I enforce it this week?

3. What will I do when they push back?

SOFT ACTION

Set one real-world boundary today. Write the exact sentence you will use.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, give me a firm yes and a firm no, and keep my heart open to those who are safe. Amen.

I am not explaining it forty times. It is a property line.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PROVERBS 4:23

Lord, give me a firm yes and a firm no.

A boundary is a property line, not a punishment.

□ Say your boundary sentence aloud three times.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Boundaries With Family, With Her, With Him

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Keep your heart with all vigilance, for from it flow the springs of life.”

Proverbs 4:23 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

A fence is not a wall. It has a gate, and you are the one who holds the key.

“for God gave us a spirit not of fear but of power and love and self-control.”

2 Tim 1:7 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

A boundary is not a punishment. It is a way to love people from where you are safe.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose a fence.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope boundaries feel like fences around a garden and not walls around a prison.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

When You Fall

TODAY'S GOAL

Plan what you will do if you stumble, before you stumble.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · MICAH 7:8 (ESV)

Micah 7:8 says, "Rejoice not over me, O my enemy; when I fall, I shall rise; when I sit in darkness, the LORD will be a light to me." Micah is speaking for a people who have fallen and are waiting for God to act. The verse does not say "if I never fall." It says "when I fall, I shall rise."

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Relapse-prevention researchers describe the "abstinence violation effect," where a lapse leads to shame and the thought "I have blown it," which can lead to continued use. Planning ahead to treat a lapse as a signal instead of a verdict helps.

Source: Marlatt & Gordon, 1985. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the plan: "If I slip, I will call _____ within one hour."
- 2 ☐ Write the first three things you will do (call, leave, eat, tell, go to a meeting).
- 3 ☐ Write a sentence to say to yourself instead of "I blew it": "This is a lapse, not a life sentence."
- 4 ☐ Tell the person on your plan that they are on it.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

ADDICTION · CYCLE-BREAKING

Put a hand on your chest and let one long breath out. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

MICAHA 7:8 · ESV

Having a plan is not permission. Not having one gives the fall a runway. Stop at the first one. The fall is the first act, the ruin is the decision afterward. Tell someone within the hour. Have naloxone in the house if opioids are in your history, and tell a person who can help. Do not throw away ninety days over one day. Then find the link you missed and write it down. Shame says hide; recovery says tell. The identity is in the rising.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What is my written plan for the day I fall?

2. Who will I tell within the hour?

3. What will I not do afterward?

SOFT ACTION

Write the plan and share it with one person. Keep a copy somewhere you can find it.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, when I fall, You are my light. Give me someone to call. Amen.

The identity is in the rising, not in never falling.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: MICAH 7:8

Lord, when I fall, You are my light.

The identity is in the rising, not in never falling.

- Share your plan with one person.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

When You Fall

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Rejoice not over me, O my enemy; when I fall, I shall rise; when I sit in darkness, the LORD will be a light to me.”

Micah 7:8 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

If you slip, you are still mine to love, and still God's.
Come back the same day.

“And he arose and came to his father. But while he was still a long way off, his father saw him and felt compassion, and ran and embraced him and kissed him.”

Luke 15:20 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

*A slip is not the same as a collapse.
What you do next is what counts.*

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose a way back before I need it.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, if you have ever used that plan, I am proud of you for using it. If you have not needed it, I am glad.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

ARC 6 REVIEW

Looking Back: The Playbook and the Structure

A few honest lines before you turn the page. This sheet also keeps each arc starting on a fresh sheet of paper for your binder.

WHAT DID I TELL THE TRUTH ABOUT IN THIS ARC?

WHAT WAS HARDEST, AND WHAT HELPED?

WHAT DO I WANT TO CARRY INTO THE NEXT ARC?



ARC 7 · DAYS 69-76

God



*Standing: Where He was, honest anger, silence. Coming Home:
Where Was Jesus?.*

THE HOLY R3UP FOR ALL

8 DAYS · 48 PAGES

Where Was He When You Were Six Months Old?

TODAY'S GOAL

Ask the question out loud: where were you?

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • GENESIS 16:13 (ESV)

In Genesis 16 Hagar, a mistreated servant, runs into the wilderness, and the angel of the LORD finds her. She names God, "You are a God of seeing," and says, "Truly here I have seen him who looks after me." She is the only person in Scripture to give God a name in this way. The story does not explain her suffering. It shows that God sees her.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Writing honestly about painful questions, including spiritual ones, is associated in studies with modest benefits for many people. You do not need an answer to benefit from asking.

Source: Pennebaker & Beall, 1986. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the question as plainly as you can: "God, where were you when _____?"
- 2 ☐ Write what you feel when you ask it (anger, fear, numbness, hope).
- 3 ☐ Read Genesis 16:7–14. Notice who sought whom.
- 4 ☐ Write one sentence of what you want from God now, even if it is "I don't know."
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration. It is okay to leave the question open.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

Where Was He When You Were Six Months Old?

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"So she called the name of the LORD who spoke to her, "You are a God of seeing," for she said, "Truly here I have seen him who looks after me.""

GENESIS 16:13 · ESV

Hagar, a mistreated servant who had run away, is the first person in Scripture to give God a name, and it is the God who sees. He was near the brokenhearted, in the room, not outside it, not arriving later. That is harder than absence, because it means He saw. It is also better than absence, because it means you were never alone, even when you felt completely alone. I do not know why He did not stop it. I know He saw, and I know He kept the record of every tear.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

THE HOLY R3UP · STANDING · UNDERSTAND AND STAND

Date:

___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Where do I most need to know He was?

2. What do I feel when I imagine Him in that room?

3. What do I want to say to Him?

SOFT ACTION

Say aloud, "You saw me." Sit with whatever comes.

SUPPLICATION

God of seeing, I did not know You were there. Show me, gently, how You were. Amen.

He was in the room. I was never in there by myself.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: GENESIS 16:13

God of seeing, show me, gently, how You were there.

He was in the room. She was never alone
in there.

□ Light a candle and sit quietly with the question for five minutes.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Where Was He When You Were Six Months Old?

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"So she called the name of the LORD who spoke to her, "You are a God of seeing," for she said, "Truly here I have seen him who looks after me.""

Genesis 16:13 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

It is okay to ask where He was. He has heard the question before and He is still listening.

"The LORD is near to all who call on him, to all who call on him in truth."

Ps 145:18 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

God can handle the question. He has heard it before.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose honesty with God.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope the question has become a conversation. If it is still open, God can hold it.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Why Didn't He Stop It?

TODAY'S GOAL

Let the "why didn't he stop it" question be asked without a tidy answer.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • ISAIAH 49:15 (ESV)

Isaiah 49:15 says, "Can a woman forget her nursing child, that she should have no compassion on the son of her womb? Even these may forget, yet I will not forget you." Isaiah is speaking to Zion, who had said, "The LORD has forsaken me." God does not argue with the feeling. He says even the most unlikely forgetting will not happen to him.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Studies of expressive writing show that people often benefit from wrestling with painful questions on paper over several days, even without resolving them. Lament has always been a way to bring pain to God.

Source: Pennebaker & Beall, 1986. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the question: "Why didn't you stop it?" Write it three times if you need to.
- 2 ☐ Write what you would say if he answered. Then write what you fear he would say.
- 3 ☐ Read Isaiah 49:15 aloud once.
- 4 ☐ Write one thing you know about God's character from Scripture that you are not sure you believe right now.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

MOTHER WOUND · CHILDHOOD

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

*"Can a woman forget her nursing child, that she should have no compassion on the son of her womb?
Even these may forget, yet I will not forget you."*

ISAIAH 49:15 · ESV

God made a world with real agency, because love that cannot be refused is not love. That means people can choose evil, and He does not routinely override the will He gave. He did not cause it, want it, or approve it. He hated it. That is an explanation, not a comfort, and I will not pretend it is the same. But hear how He answers in Isaiah: Can a woman forget her nursing child? Even these may forget, yet I will not forget you. He knows that mothers fail. And He says: I will not.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

440

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What do I most need to ask Him?

2. What do I do with the part that has no answer?

3. How does it feel to hear Him say, "I will not forget you"?

SOFT ACTION

Write the question you have never asked, and leave it open.

SUPPLICATION

Father, I do not understand. I trust Your character where I cannot trace Your hand. Stay with me. Amen.

I trust His character where I cannot trace His hand.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: ISAIAH 49:15

Father, I do not understand. Stay with us.

I can hold a question without a verdict.

□ Write one question for God on a card and put it in your Bible.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Why Didn't He Stop It?

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Can a woman forget her nursing child, that she should have no compassion on the son of her womb? Even these may forget, yet I will not forget you.”

Isaiah 49:15 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You can ask why without getting an answer. Some of us just get a presence. That is not nothing.

“And behold, I am with you always, to the end of the age.”

Matt 28:20 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

*A good question is not a lack of faith.
It is faith wrestling.*

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to ask without pretending.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you found some peace with not knowing. Some questions are lived into, not answered.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Not Punishment

TODAY'S GOAL

Separate what happened from the idea that you were being punished.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • JOHN 9:3 (ESV)

In John 9:1–3 the disciples ask about a man born blind, “Rabbi, who sinned, this man or his parents, that he was born blind?” Jesus answers, “It was not that this man sinned, or his parents, but that the works of God might be displayed in him.” Jesus rejects the assumption that suffering is a direct punishment for a particular sin.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Research on shame suggests that blaming yourself for harm done to you increases hiding and distress. Reframing responsibility accurately can reduce the weight.

Source: Tangney & Dearing, 2002. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write: “I was afraid that what happened was punishment for _____.”
- 2 ☐ Write the facts: who did what, and who was responsible.
- 3 ☐ Write the sentence “It was not my fault” and the sentence “It was not God’s punishment.”
- 4 ☐ Read John 9:1–3 aloud.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

CHILDHOOD · WARFARE

SANCTUARY • OPTIONAL

"Jesus answered, 'It was not that this man sinned, or his parents, but that the works of God might be displayed in him.'"

JOHN 9:3 · ESV

The disciples asked whose sin caused a man's blindness, and Jesus rejected the whole premise. What was done to you as a baby was not the sentence for anything you did or were. Your suffering was not invoiced to you. Jesus paid the bill and God does not double-bill. Grief is not proof of a curse, and hardship is not a verdict. If you have been secretly wondering what was wrong with you that this happened, nothing was.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What have I secretly believed I was being punished for?

2. Where did I learn that suffering means I did something wrong?

3. What would it mean to let that go?

SOFT ACTION

Write the sentence you believe, then cross it out and write, "This was not punishment."

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You refused the lie that suffering is always a sentence. Take mine out of that frame. Amen.

He is not punishing me. There is no condemnation.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: JOHN 9:3

Jesus, refuse the lie that suffering is always a sentence.

I am not being punished. There is no condemnation.

- Do one kind thing for someone who is suffering.

Swap the step for something small and kind: water, a snack, a stretch. That is practice too.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Not Punishment

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"Jesus answered, "It was not that this man sinned, or his parents, but that the works of God might be displayed in him.""

John 9:3 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You were not being punished. Hold on to that sentence with both hands.

"For I am sure that neither death nor life, nor angels nor rulers, nor things present nor things to come, nor powers, nor height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God in Christ Jesus our Lord."

Rom 8:38–39 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

God is not punishing you. People were not safe, and that was theirs to answer for.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to stop looking for a reason in myself.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you no longer look for the reason in yourself.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Angry at God

TODAY'S GOAL

Be angry at God out loud, with the psalms to lead.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • PSALM 13:1-2 (ESV)

Psalm 13:1-2 says, “How long, O LORD? Will you forget me forever? How long will you hide your face from me? How long must I take counsel in my soul and have sorrow in my heart all the day?” It is a short psalm of David. It begins in complaint and ends in trust (“I will sing to the LORD”). About a third of the psalms are laments, which means God’s own book gives you permission to be honest.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Writing about strong negative feelings, including anger, is linked in studies to improved well-being for many people when it moves toward meaning-making over time. Expression alone helps most when it leads somewhere.

Source: Pennebaker & Beall, 1986. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write your own psalm: “How long, Lord? _____.” Do not clean it up.
- 2 ☐ Write what you are angry about. Use hard words.
- 3 ☐ Write one line of what you still believe, even a small one.
- 4 ☐ Read all three aloud, as prayer.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · MOTHER WOUND

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"How long, O LORD? Will you forget me forever? How long will you hide your face from me? How long must I take counsel in my soul and have sorrow in my heart all the day? How long shall my enemy be exalted over me?"

PSALM 13:1-2 · ESV

Scripture preserves complaints. Jesus quoted a psalm of abandonment from the cross. Job accused God and God said Job had spoken rightly of Him. Lamentations is grief laid out before God, and God kept it in the canon. He can handle your rage. What He cannot work with is your distance. Say it to Him directly, even the part that says, where were You when I was a baby and no one protected me?

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What have I never said to God directly?

2. What am I afraid will happen if I do?

3. What would it look like to say it today?

SOFT ACTION

Write or say it to God, unedited, for two minutes.

SUPPLICATION

God, here it is, all of it. I am bringing it to You instead of holding it against You. Amen.

I bring it to Him instead of holding it against Him.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 13:1-2

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Angry at God

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“How long, O LORD? Will you forget me forever? How long will you hide your face from me? How long must I take counsel in my soul and have sorrow in my heart all the day? How long shall my enemy be exalted over me?”

Psalm 13:1-2 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Anger at God means you still think He is worth being angry at. He knows. Keep talking.

“Trust in him at all times, O people; pour out your heart before him; God is a refuge for us.”

Ps 62:8 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Anger at God is still a conversation with God.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose honesty over politeness.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope your relationship with God has room for your anger now. It is a deeper kind of trust.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Taking Your Case Out of Court

TODAY'S GOAL

Hand one case over to the only fair judge.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • ROMANS 12:19 (ESV)

Romans 12:19 says, “Beloved, never avenge yourselves, but leave it to the wrath of God, for it is written, ‘Vengeance is mine, I will repay, says the Lord.’” Paul is quoting Deuteronomy 32:35. The command is not “do nothing” in cases of abuse. Elsewhere Scripture calls on authorities to punish wrongdoing (Romans 13:4). It says personal revenge is not yours to carry out.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Studies of forgiveness programs find that people who release the desire for revenge, with support, generally report less distress. Releasing revenge does not mean the harm did not matter or that it was not a crime.

Source: Wade et al., 2014. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the name of the person and what they did, in one factual line.
- 2 ☐ Write what justice would look like to you (an apology, a consequence, an acknowledgment).
- 3 ☐ Decide whether any of it is something you can pursue legally or safely (a report, a restraining order, therapy). Write the next step.
- 4 ☐ Pray: “God, I put this case in your hands. I will do what is mine to do.”
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

Taking Your Case Out of Court

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"Beloved, never avenge yourselves, but leave it to the wrath of God, for it is written, "Vengeance is mine, I will repay, says the Lord.'"

ROMANS 12:19 · ESV

As long as you hold a verdict against God, you cannot receive from Him. You do not have to stop having questions. You have to stop having a verdict. And handing over your case against your father and your mother is not letting them off. It is God taking a weight that was killing you. He is the judge, and He sees everything, including what never reached a human court. Some people never face anything on earth. That is not the end of the story.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What verdict am I carrying against God?

2. What case am I carrying against my father and mother?

3. What would it feel like to hand each to Him?

SOFT ACTION

Write "I withdraw the verdict" beside the one you are ready to put down.

SUPPLICATION

God, I keep my questions open and I withdraw my verdict. The case is Yours. Amen.

I keep the questions open. I withdraw the verdict.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: ROMANS 12:19

Lord, I withdraw the verdict. The case is Yours.

I keep the questions open and withdraw the verdict.

□ Take one deep breath and let your shoulders drop three times.

Too much today? Open your eyes, name five things you see, and stop. Stopping is part of the practice.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Taking Your Case Out of Court

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"Beloved, never avenge yourselves, but leave it to the wrath of God, for it is written, 'Vengeance is mine, I will repay, says the Lord.'"

Romans 12:19 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You can lay down a case you are tired of carrying. The Judge is fair and He is not asleep.

"The LORD is my strength and my shield; in him my heart trusts, and I am helped; my heart exults, and with my song I give thanks to him."

Ps 28:7 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Releasing revenge is not the same as dropping the charges.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to hand over the gavel.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you feel lighter. Carrying a case is heavy work.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

The Quiet Stretch of Faith

TODAY'S GOAL

Sit with a quiet stretch of faith without forcing a feeling.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · LAMENTATIONS 3:26 (ESV)

Lamentations 3:26 says, "It is good that one should wait quietly for the salvation of the LORD." It sits in the middle of a poem written after the fall of Jerusalem. The author has just said, "The steadfast love of the LORD never ceases," in the midst of grief. Quiet waiting is described as good, not as failure.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

In one study, people who walked for 90 minutes in a natural setting showed less rumination than people who walked in an urban setting. Time in quiet, green places can help a busy mind settle.

Source: Bratman et al., 2015. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Go outside, or sit by a window. Set a timer for 10 minutes.
- 2 ☐ No phone. Look at one thing, like a tree or the sky.
- 3 ☐ Whenever your mind runs, say "Waiting," and look again.
- 4 ☐ At the end, write one sentence about what you noticed.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

The Quiet Stretch of Faith

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Hold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

"It is good that one should wait quietly for the salvation of the LORD."

LAMENTATIONS 3:26 · ESV

Elijah was suicidal and looked for God in wind, earthquake, and fire, and God came in a thin silence, after He fed him and let him sleep twice. Food, sleep, then the whisper. Sometimes the silence is not rejection. Sometimes you are exhausted and He is feeding you first. In early recovery you may have no energy for a long quiet time, and that is okay. A few honest sentences are prayer.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

THE HOLY R3UP · STANDING · UNDERSTAND AND STAND

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Have I been asking for a whisper when I need food and sleep?

2. What would feed me today?

3. What is one small way to wait?

SOFT ACTION

Eat something and rest ten minutes before praying. Then pray one sentence.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, I am tired. Feed me, and then speak. Amen.

Silence is documented. It is not rejection.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: LAMENTATIONS 3:26

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ### WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Quiet Stretch of Faith

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"It is good that one should wait quietly for the salvation of the LORD."

Lamentations 3:26 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Waiting in the quiet is not the same as being forgotten.

"but they who wait for the LORD shall renew their strength; they shall mount up with wings like eagles; they shall run and not be weary; they shall walk and not faint."

Isa 40:31 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Quiet is not empty. It is where things settle.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to wait without a plan.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope quiet has become something you look forward to, not something you run from.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Rocked Like a Weaned Child

TODAY'S GOAL

Let yourself be quieted, like a weaned child with its mother.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • PSALM 131:2 (ESV)

Psalm 131:2 says, "But I have calmed and quieted my soul, like a weaned child with its mother; like a weaned child is my soul within me." It is a three-verse psalm of ascent attributed to David. A weaned child is not crying for milk. It simply rests. The psalmist says he has chosen not to occupy himself with things too great for him.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Slow breathing and gentle contact, like petting a calm animal, have both been associated with calmer physiology in studies. Neither is a cure, and both are easy to try.

Sources: Zaccaro et al., 2018; Beetz et al., 2012. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Sit or lie down with something soft, or your dog beside you.
- 2 ☐ Breathe in for 4 and out for 6, ten times.
- 3 ☐ Place a hand on your chest and say, "My soul is quiet. I am not in charge of everything."
- 4 ☐ Rest for three minutes without doing anything.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

CHILDHOOD · MOTHER WOUND

Name three things you can see and one thing you can hear. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

PSALM 131:2 · ESV

Noise was safety. If it was quiet, you could hear them coming, and you had to feel it. So silence may feel like danger before it feels like peace. Start with two minutes. Eyes open if closed feels unsafe. When your mind runs, say later and come back. The coming back is the prayer. The psalmist describes a soul quieted like a weaned child with its mother. You may not have had that mother. You can ask for it from the One who comforts like one.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. How long did I sit, and what came up?

2. What does silence feel like in my body?

3. What would it be like to be quieted like a child with her mother?

SOFT ACTION

Sit two minutes today. Feet on the floor. Say once, "Jesus, I am here." Then nothing.

SUPPLICATION

Father, I do not have to say anything. I am not leaving. Quiet my soul like a child with her mother. Amen.

I am here. He does not have to say anything. I am not leaving.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 131:2

Lord, quiet her soul like a child with its mother.

I can comfort her the way she needed to be comforted.

- Hum a lullaby or a hymn.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Rocked Like a Weaned Child

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“But I have calmed and quieted my soul, like a weaned child with its mother; like a weaned child is my soul within me.”

Psalm 131:2 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You are allowed to be quieted like a child on a lap. I wish someone had done that for you. Let Him.

“But I have calmed and quieted my soul, like a weaned child with its mother; like a weaned child is my soul within me.”

Ps 131:2 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You are allowed to rest like a child who is not afraid.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to be quiet and held.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope your soul can quiet itself quickly now. I hope you remember how it felt today.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

All Things, Honestly

TODAY'S GOAL

Look at "all things work together" honestly, without calling the harm good.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • ROMANS 8:28 (ESV)

Romans 8:28 says, "And we know that for those who love God all things work together for good, for those who are called according to his purpose." Paul does not say all things are good. He says God works in all things, for the good of those who love him, inside a chapter that also names suffering, groaning, and waiting. Verse 29 shows the "good" as becoming like Jesus.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Studies of post-traumatic growth suggest that some people report meaning and growth after trauma, and that this tends to come with, not instead of, distress. It is not required, and it is not guaranteed. In life-goal writing studies, making meaning was linked to better well-being.

Source: King, 2001. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write: "What happened to me was not good. It was _____. " Use real words.
- 2 ☐ Write one thing God has brought you that you would not trade (a person, a lesson, a strength).
- 3 ☐ Write: "I do not need to call the pain good to believe God is good."
- 4 ☐ Read Romans 8:26–28 aloud.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

All Things, Honestly

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"And we know that for those who love God all things work together for good, for those who are called according to his purpose."

ROMANS 8:28 · ESV

It does not say all things are good. It says God works in all things toward good, and the next verse defines that good as being made like Christ. It is not a promise that your story will have a satisfying plot, and it is not meant to be said to someone in fresh grief. It is a promise that nothing in your story, including what happened when you were a baby and the years in your addiction, is unusable in His hands. It was not good. It will not be wasted. Those are different things.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What do I need Him to use rather than explain?

2. What have I been tempted to call good that was not?

3. What do I hope He will redeem?

SOFT ACTION

Write one thing that was not good, and one thing you are asking Him not to waste.

SUPPLICATION

God, I will not call it good, but I ask You not to waste it. Use it. Amen.

It was not good. It will not be wasted. Those are different.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: ROMANS 8:28

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID • WHAT I NOTICED

All Things, Honestly

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“And we know that for those who love God all things work together for good, for those who are called according to his purpose.”

Romans 8:28 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You do not have to call it good to believe He can use it.

“He will wipe away every tear from their eyes, and death shall be no more, neither shall there be mourning, nor crying, nor pain anymore, for the former things have passed away.”

Rev 21:4 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

God using something is not the same as God causing it.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to be honest about the harm and the help.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope that you can hold both: it was terrible, and God was at work. Neither cancels the other.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

ARC 7 REVIEW

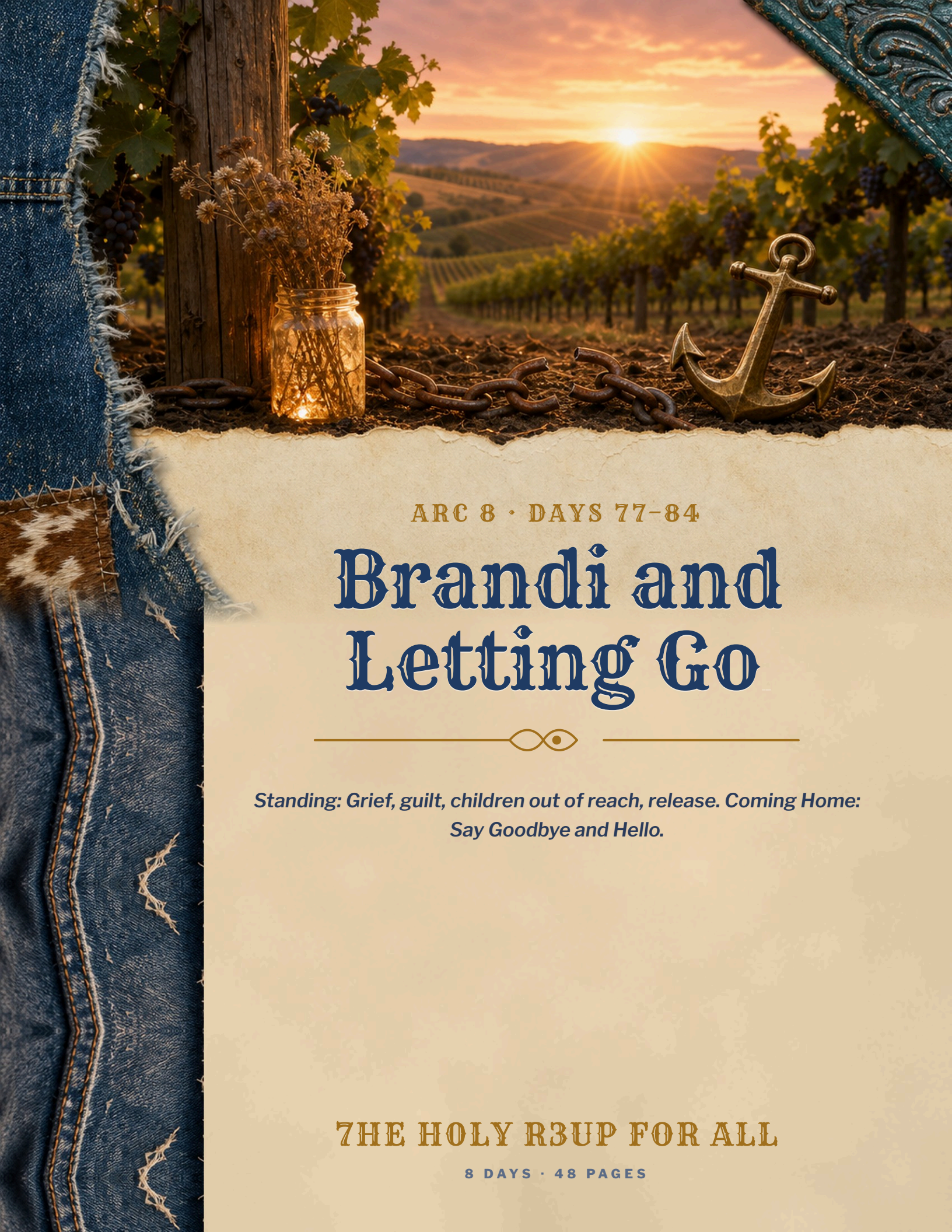
Looking Back: God

A few honest lines before you turn the page. This sheet also keeps each arc starting on a fresh sheet of paper for your binder.

WHAT DID I TELL THE TRUTH ABOUT IN THIS ARC?

WHAT WAS HARDEST, AND WHAT HELPED?

WHAT DO I WANT TO CARRY INTO THE NEXT ARC?



ARC 8 • DAYS 77-84

Brandi and Letting Go



*Standing: Grief, guilt, children out of reach, release. Coming Home:
Say Goodbye and Hello.*

THE HOLY R3UP FOR ALL

8 DAYS • 48 PAGES

You Were Not Their Savior

TODAY'S GOAL

Put down the job of being everyone's savior.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · PSALM 147:3 (ESV)

Psalm 147:3 says, "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds." The psalm is a song of praise that celebrates God for rebuilding Jerusalem, gathering the outcasts, and healing. Healing is described as his work, not yours. The verse is a relief, not a charge.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Al-Anon (al-anon.org) and similar family groups exist for people affected by someone else's drinking or drug use. They teach that you did not cause it, cannot control it, and cannot cure it, and many people find that freeing. Support groups are free.

Source: 988 Lifeline (988lifeline.org).

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the name of someone you tried to save. Write what you did to try.
- 2 ☐ Write what actually happened. Be honest.
- 3 ☐ Say aloud: "I did not cause it. I could not control it. I could not cure it."
- 4 ☐ Look up one family support meeting (Al-Anon, Nar-Anon, or another group) and note the time.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

MOTHER WOUND · ADDICTION

Look around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.*

PSALM 147:3 · ESV

If you lost someone to addiction, you may carry the idea that you should have saved them. You may also carry it about your mother. You were not their savior. You were a child, then a sister, then a daughter, then a friend. You lost them because addiction is lethal, because they were sick, and because the world they were in was built to fail people like them. None of those were yours to control. This page is for Brandi, and for the mother you could not save. Grief is allowed here.

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SACRED REFLECTION

1. What did I do for them?

2. What do I keep telling myself I should have done?

3. Was it truly in my power at that age and in that condition?

SOFT ACTION

Write one thing you did that was love. Let that be enough for today.

SUPPLICATION

God, I loved them and I was never their God. Hold them, and hold me. Amen.

I loved them. I was never their God. That was never my job.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 147:3

God, I loved them, and I was never their God.

I loved them. I was never their God.

Look at a photo of someone you lost and say one thing you love about them.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

You Were Not Their Savior

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds.”

Psalms 147:3 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

I love that you loved them. Now let someone love you back.

“See what kind of love the Father has given to us, that we should be called children of God; and so we are.”

1 John 3:1 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You can love someone fully and still not be able to save them.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to love without carrying.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you have learned to love without rescuing.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Who Was Responsible

TODAY'S GOAL

Sort what was your job and what never was.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · PSALM 9:9 (ESV)

Psalm 9:9 says, "The LORD is a stronghold for the oppressed, a stronghold in times of trouble." David praises God as the one who judges rightly and remembers the afflicted. The verse puts responsibility for justice in God's hands, not in the hands of the victim.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Research on adverse childhood experiences makes the point that children are not responsible for the adversity they experience. Accurately assigning responsibility is part of healing.

Source: Felitti et al., 1998. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Make two columns: "Not my job" and "My job."
- 2 ☐ Under "Not my job" list what you were made responsible for as a child (adults' feelings, safety, secrets, fixing).
- 3 ☐ Under "My job" list what is yours now (my choices, my recovery, my relationships, my peace).
- 4 ☐ Cross out one thing from your "Not my job" list that you still try to carry. Say, "I am putting this down."
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

Who Was Responsible

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"The LORD is a stronghold for the oppressed, a stronghold in times of trouble."

PSALM 9:9 · ESV

List what actually contributed: their choices, the people who hurt them, the ones who sold to them, the systems that turned them away, the disease itself, the patterns they were born into, and your own choices. Then count how many lines have your name on them, and how many do not. The point is not to avoid responsibility. It is to put it where it belongs, so grief can be grief and not an endless trial.

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SACRED REFLECTION

1. Who or what was responsible for each part?

2. Which lines have my name, truthfully?

3. What age and condition was I in then?

SOFT ACTION

Fill in a list of responsible parties. Stop when it is done.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, You are a stronghold for the oppressed. Help me put the weight where it belongs. Amen.

I judge my past self with resources she did not have. I stop.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 9:9

*I judge my past self with the resources
she had.*

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Who Was Responsible

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"The LORD is a stronghold for the oppressed, a stronghold in times of trouble."

Psalms 9:9 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You were a child. It was not your job. Take that sentence with you today.

"He brought me out into a broad place; he rescued me, because he delighted in me."

Psalms 18:19 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

A child cannot do an adult's job. You were a child.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to carry only what is mine.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you know whose job is whose.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Hope Without Certainty

TODAY'S GOAL

Practice hope without needing certainty.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · PSALM 139:8 (ESV)

Psalm 139:8 says, "If I ascend to heaven, you are there! If I make my bed in Sheol, you are there!" Sheol is the place of the dead in Hebrew thought. The psalm says there is no place so far that God is not present. It is a statement of presence, not a prediction about outcomes.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Writing about a hopeful but realistic future has been linked to better well-being in studies, and works best when paired with concrete steps. Hope is not a guarantee, and it is not a denial of how things are.

Source: King, 2001. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write one thing you do not know and cannot know about your future.
- 2 ☐ Write one thing you do know about God's presence from Psalm 139.
- 3 ☐ Write one hope you have for next year, in plain words, and one step toward it.
- 4 ☐ Say, "I do not need to know how it ends to take the next step."
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · MOTHER WOUND

Sit with your back against something solid. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

PSALM 139:8 · ESV

I am not God, and I will not pretend to know where she is. But addiction is not the unforgivable sin, God judges the heart and not the manner of death (1 Samuel 16:7), and Romans 8:38-39 lists death first among the things that cannot separate us from His love. A cry does not have to be eloquent: the thief on the cross got one sentence (Luke 23:42-43). You can hope, legitimately, without lying to yourself. Hope is not certainty, and you do not need certainty to stop tormenting yourself.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Can I hope without needing to know?

2. What does it feel like to place them in God's hands?

3. What would help me leave them there?

SOFT ACTION

Say aloud, "I do not know, and I hope." Sit with it.

SUPPLICATION

God, You are there, even in Sheol. I put them in Your hands. I do not know everything, and I hope. Amen.

I am putting them in the hands of someone kinder than the people who scared me.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 139:8

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Hope Without Certainty

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"If I ascend to heaven, you are there! If I make my bed in Sheol, you are there!"

Psalms 139:8 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You do not have to know how it ends to take the next small step.

"Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and do not lean on your own understanding. In all your ways acknowledge him, and he will make straight your paths."

Prov 3:5-6 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Hope is not certainty. It is choosing to walk toward light.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to hope without proof.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope some of those hopes came true. I hope the ones that did not did not break you.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Not a Debt

TODAY'S GOAL

Receive a place in the family that is not earned.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · ROMANS 8:15 (ESV)

Romans 8:15 says, "For you did not receive the spirit of slavery to fall back into fear, but you have received the Spirit of adoption as sons, by whom we cry, 'Abba! Father!'" Paul uses adoption language. In Roman culture an adopted son had the same legal rights as a natural child. The verse is about belonging, not debt.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Attachment research suggests that people who did not feel secure as children can come to feel more secure through steady relationships later, including with God, mentors, and community, although the evidence on religious attachment is still developing.

Source: Roisman et al., 2002. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write: "I used to think I had to earn a place by _____."
- 2 ☐ Write: "In God's family I am a child, not a servant."
- 3 ☐ Name one place or person where you already feel you belong.
- 4 ☐ Do one small thing to belong more: go to a service, a group, or a meeting.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

ADDICTION · CYCLE-BREAKING

Take a slow sip of water. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

ROMANS 8:15 · ESV

Their death, or their harm, did not buy your life, and there was no exchange. If you build your recovery or your work as restitution for being the one who lived, you will never be able to stop, and it will never be enough, because guilt does not close accounts. Build it because it is right, and because you love them. Their name goes on it as a dedication, not a debt. A survivor does not owe her life as payment.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Am I building out of love or out of guilt?

2. How can I tell the difference?

3. What would change if it were a dedication, not a debt?

SOFT ACTION

Write the sentence, "My life is not a payment." Say it aloud once.

SUPPLICATION

Father, I did not receive a spirit of slavery. Free me from owing. Let me carry their name in love. Amen.

Their name goes on the work as a dedication, not a debt.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: ROMANS 8:15

My life is not a payment.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Not a Debt

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"For you did not receive the spirit of slavery to fall back into fear, but you have received the Spirit of adoption as sons, by whom we cry, 'Abba! Father!'"

Romans 8:15 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You were chosen. Not for your résumé. For you.

"See what kind of love the Father has given to us, that we should be called children of God; and so we are."

1 John 3:1 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

*Adoption is a legal and a loving thing.
You were chosen.*

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to be a daughter, not a debtor.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you are finding seats at tables without fear.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

The Letter: To Her, To Him, To Brandi

TODAY'S GOAL

Write the letter, to her, to him, and to Brandi, and do not mail it.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · JOHN 11:35 (ESV)

John 11:35 is the shortest verse in the Bible: "Jesus wept." It comes at the tomb of his friend Lazarus, though Jesus was about to raise him. Even knowing how the story would turn, he cried. Grief is not a lack of faith.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Letters you never send, a form of expressive writing, have been used in grief and trauma work and are linked in studies to emotional processing. They are most helpful when you can stop and care for yourself afterward.

Source: Pennebaker & Beall, 1986. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Pick one: a letter to the child you were, to the person who hurt you, or to Brandi Renee. Write the date at the top.
- 2 ☐ Write for 15 minutes without stopping. Begin with "I need you to know."
- 3 ☐ End with one sentence of what you want to say goodbye to, or thank, or forgive.
- 4 ☐ Read it aloud only if you feel steady. Then put it away. Do not mail it.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration. Do something kind for yourself afterward.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

MOTHER WOUND · CHILDHOOD

Feel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

JOHN 11:35 · ESV

Jesus wept at a grave He was about to open. Grief is not weak faith. Write a letter to the one you need to write to: your mother, your father, or Brandi. Everything: the love, the rage, the why did you not protect me, the I am sorry, what you never said. You will not send it. Then write the indictment you have been running against yourself, and, if you can do it safely, burn it outside and watch it go.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What I have never said to her:

2. What I have never said to him:

3. What case have I been prosecuting against myself?

SOFT ACTION

Write the letter. Then, if you wish and it is safe, burn the second page.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You wept. Weep with me. Let me say it all, and let it go. Amen.

I am not letting them go. I am putting them down in better hands.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: JOHN 11:35

*I am not letting them go. I am putting
them down in better hands.*

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Letter: To Her, To Him, To Brandi

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY*“Jesus wept.”***John 11:35 · ESV****A NOTE OF LOVE**

Write the letter. You do not have to mail it. It only has to be said.

“He will wipe away every tear from their eyes, and death shall be no more, neither shall there be mourning, nor crying, nor pain anymore, for the former things have passed away.”

Rev 21:4 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Some things need to be said even if nobody ever hears them.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to say what has been waiting.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you kept that letter or burned it, and that it did what you needed.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Grief Is Not a Relapse

TODAY'S GOAL

Remember that grief is not a relapse.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · MATTHEW 5:4 (ESV)

Matthew 5:4 says, "Blessed are those who mourn, for they shall be comforted." It is the second Beatitude, in the Sermon on the Mount. Jesus names mourning as a blessed state, because those who mourn will be met with comfort. Grief is not treated as something to hide.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Research on bereavement suggests people grieve in many different ways and that the most common outcome is resilience, though grief can be intense and can come in waves. Grief waves are normal, and prolonged or overwhelming grief deserves professional help.

Source: Bonanno, 2004. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write her name and dates: Brandi Renee, January 27, 1986 to December 17, 2021. Or write the name and dates of someone you have lost.
- 2 ☐ Write one thing you miss and one thing you are glad you had.
- 3 ☐ Light a candle or hold something of theirs for two minutes. Cry if you need to.
- 4 ☐ Write: "Grief is love with nowhere to go." Then write one place to send it today (a walk, a prayer, a kind act).
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration. If grief tips toward using or self-harm, call someone or 988.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

ADDICTION · MOTHER WOUND

Hold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.*

MATTHEW 5:4 · ESV

Grief that is not given a place will take one, usually as rage, shutdown, or a craving. Know your dates: birthdays, anniversaries, the day you got the call. Plan for them instead of being ambushed. Have one person to call on those days. And stop calling it a setback when it is love with nowhere to put itself. You may grieve more than a death: the childhood you did not get and the mother you needed.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What are my hard dates?

2. Who will I call?

3. What gentle ritual could I make for what I am grieving?

SOFT ACTION

Put the next hard date on your calendar with a name and a plan.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, comfort me as You promised. Let me grieve without breaking. Amen.

I am allowed to grieve, and I am allowed to have a good day.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: MATTHEW 5:4

Lord, comfort me as You promised.

*I am allowed to grieve, and I am allowed
to have a good day.*

- Have one good, light moment today and do not feel guilty for it.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Grief Is Not a Relapse

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"Blessed are those who mourn, for they shall be comforted."

Matthew 5:4 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Grief is love with nowhere to go. Let it sit in the room with you today.

"The LORD is near to the brokenhearted and saves the crushed in spirit."

Ps 34:18 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Grief does not mean you are failing. It means you loved.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to let grief be grief.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope the grief has softened into a place you can visit.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Letting the Living Go: If Your Mother Is Still Here

TODAY'S GOAL

Practice gentle distance if the person is still living.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · LUKE 5:16 (ESV)

Luke 5:16 says, "But he would withdraw to desolate places and pray." Jesus, surrounded by crowds who needed healing, regularly stepped away. It is permission to have limits and to prioritize time with the Father.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Self-compassion research suggests that treating your own needs as valid lowers burnout and shame. Taking space is not selfish, and it can make your care more sustainable.

Source: Neff, 2003. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write the person you need distance from or from whom you want more space.
- 2 ☐ Write what you will do with the space (pray, rest, recover).
- 3 ☐ Write one gentle sentence you can say: "I love you, and I need space right now."
- 4 ☐ Decide the first small step (a shorter call, a later reply, a limit on visits).
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

MOTHER WOUND · WARFARE

Name three things you can see and one thing you can hear. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.*

LUKE 5:16 · ESV

There are four kinds of letting go: release to God with them still in your life, boundary, distance, and no contact. You are not obligated to give unlimited access to someone who is actively harming you, and no Scripture requires it. If your mother is living, decide which kind fits now and what would change it. If she is gone, you may still be letting go of the mother you needed and the apology you may never hear. You can love someone and not be their savior.

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Date:

___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which of the four fits my relationship with my mother now?

2. What would have to change for that to change?

3. What am I grieving that has no funeral?

SOFT ACTION

Write which kind you are choosing, the cost, and the next step.

SUPPLICATION

Father, You see her. Go where I cannot go. Help me love without losing myself. Amen.

Loving someone does not require me to die with them.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: JEREMIAH 31:16-17

Father, You see them. Go where I cannot go.

Loving someone does not require me to die with them.

- Write one boundary or release sentence and say it aloud.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Letting the Living Go: If Your Mother Is Still Here

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“But he would withdraw to desolate places and pray.”

Luke 5:16 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

Loving someone from a distance is still loving them. It is also still protecting you.

“He who dwells in the shelter of the Most High will abide in the shadow of the Almighty.”

Ps 91:1 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Even Jesus withdrew.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to love with limits.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you give love from a healthy distance. It is okay to love and keep your boundaries.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

The Release

TODAY'S GOAL

Release what you cannot carry.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · PSALM 55:22 (ESV)

Psalm 55:22 says, "Cast your burden on the LORD, and he will sustain you; he will never permit the righteous to be moved." David wrote this in distress over betrayal by a close friend. "Cast" is a physical word, like throwing something off your back. The promise is that God sustains, not that the burden vanishes instantly.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Naming heavy feelings in words has been linked to reduced intensity of emotional reactions in lab studies. Naming each burden before you hand it over can make the handing-over more real.

Source: Lieberman et al., 2007. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write three burdens you are still carrying, in a line each.
- 2 ☐ Next to each write: "I cannot fix this."
- 3 ☐ Hold a heavy object (a book, a bag of rice). Say, "I cast this on you, Lord." Put it down.
- 4 ☐ Notice the lightness in your hands. Take three breaths.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · MOTHER WOUND

Put a hand on your chest and let one long breath out. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.*

"Cast your burden on the LORD, and he will sustain you; he will never permit the righteous to be moved."

WHAT THIS MEANS

Say it: I release ___ into the hands of God. I am not their savior, judge, jailer, or payment. What was good, I keep. What was mine, I take back. What was theirs, I return. I forgive them, and I am not available for more harm. Then replace the space on purpose, because holes get filled by whatever is nearest. Put something good in it: a person, a practice, a purpose.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Who am I releasing?

2. What am I keeping, and what am I returning?

3. What will I put in the space?

SOFT ACTION

Write the release by name, and read it aloud. Then do one small good thing in the space.

SUPPLICATION

God, I release them into Your hands. Sustain me. Amen.

Out of my hands, into His. His are better than mine ever were.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 55:22

God, I release them. Sustain me.

Out of my hands, into His.

□ Replace what you released with something good in the space it left.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Release

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Cast your burden on the LORD, and he will sustain you; he will never permit the righteous to be moved.”

Psalms 55:22 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You are allowed to put the weight down. Your hands were made for more than carrying.

“casting all your anxieties on him, because he cares for you.”

1 Pet 5:7 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You were not made to carry everything.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to put the weight down.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope your hands are free.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

ARC 8 REVIEW

Looking Back: Brandi and Letting Go

A few honest lines before you turn the page. This sheet also keeps each arc starting on a fresh sheet of paper for your binder.

WHAT DID I TELL THE TRUTH ABOUT IN THIS ARC?

WHAT WAS HARDEST, AND WHAT HELPED?

WHAT DO I WANT TO CARRY INTO THE NEXT ARC?



ARC 9 · DAYS 85-90

Becoming Her



Standing: Stewarding what you have learned. Coming Home: Meet the New You.

THE HOLY R3UP FOR ALL

6 DAYS · 36 PAGES

Known Before You Were Formed

TODAY'S GOAL

Believe that you were known and wanted before you were hurt.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • PSALM 139:13-14 (ESV)

Psalm 139:13-14 says, "For you formed my inward parts; you knitted me together in my mother's womb. I praise you, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Wonderful are your works; my soul knows it very well." David wrote this as a song of praise. The verse says that God was involved in your making, no matter what the circumstances of your birth or your parents' choices were.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Studies on self-compassion suggest that seeing yourself as worthy of care, not because of achievement, is linked to better emotional health. Worth is not something you have to prove.

Source: Neff, 2003. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write: "Before anything happened, God made me. He saw me as _____."
- 2 ☐ Write three things about yourself that you like or that make you you (your laugh, your grit, your love for animals).
- 3 ☐ Look in the mirror and say, "I am fearfully and wonderfully made," once.
- 4 ☐ Write one thing you would like to say to the child who was hurt: "You were wanted by God."
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

CHILDHOOD · MOTHER WOUND

Look around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

PSALM 139:13-14 · ESV

God knew you before you were formed, and what was done to you never canceled what He had in mind for you. Scripture says He knitted you together in your mother's womb. Your mother's womb was not the whole story, and she was not the one who made you; He was. I cannot tell you the harm was aimed at your calling. I do not know that. But the place that hurt most is often the place you understand best, and that can become a place you help from.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What was hurt earliest, and what did it try to take?

2. What do I see when I picture myself as known and wanted by God?

3. What does it change?

SOFT ACTION

Look at a photo of yourself as a child. Say, "Known and wanted by God."

SUPPLICATION

Father, You knitted me together. Let that be the final word over me. Amen.

God's knowing came first. The harm does not get the final word.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: PSALM 139:13-14

Father, You knitted her together. Let that be the final word.

God's knowing came first. The harm does not get the final word.

- Look at yourself in the mirror for ten seconds with kindness.

Too much today? Open your eyes, name five things you see, and stop. Stopping is part of the practice.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Known Before You Were Formed

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“For you formed my inward parts; you knitted me together in my mother's womb. I praise you, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Wonderful are your works; my soul knows it very well.”

Psalms 139:13-14 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You were wanted before anyone hurt you. Say it where you can hear it.

“I have loved you with an everlasting love; therefore I have continued my faithfulness to you.”

Jer 31:3 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

What was done to you does not undo how you were made.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to see what God sees.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope you believe it, and I hope others see it.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

The Wound as a Door

TODAY'S GOAL

Notice that your wound can become a door for someone else.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • 2 CORINTHIANS 1:3-4 (ESV)

Second Corinthians 1:3–4 says, “Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of mercies and God of all comfort, who comforts us in all our affliction, so that we may be able to comfort those who are in any affliction, with the comfort with which we ourselves are comforted by God.” Paul wrote it after severe hardship in Asia. Comfort is received so it can be passed on. It does not say your pain was good, only that it can be used.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

In a study of people in alcohol recovery, those who helped other people in Alcoholics Anonymous were more likely to stay sober over the following year than those who did not. Helping from a place of stability seems to benefit the helper as well.

Source: Pagano et al., 2004. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write one lesson from your journey that someone else could use.
- 2 ☐ Write who might need it (a newcomer in a meeting, a friend, a younger woman).
- 3 ☐ Write one safe way to share it (a text, a meeting share, a card).
- 4 ☐ Only share what is stable and healed enough for you. You are not required to reopen anything.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

The Wound as a Door

WARFARE · CYCLE-BREAKING

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Press your palms together, then let go. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

"Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of mercies and God of all comfort, who comforts us in all our affliction, so that we may be able to comfort those who are in any affliction, with the comfort with which we ourselves are comforted by God."

2 CORINTHIANS 1:3-4 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Joseph was starved of family and put in charge of feeding families. Moses was drawn out of the water and sent to draw a nation out. Often, the fruit comes in the shape of the wound. Not always, not automatically, and never as a reason to call the wound good. Look at yours as a map, not a verdict. The so that is the whole point: you were not comforted to feel better only. You were comforted so you would know the road for someone else.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

THE HOLY R3UP · STANDING · UNDERSTAND AND STAND

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Where do my wound and my compassion overlap?

2. Who might need exactly what I know?

3. What is one small way I could offer it?

SOFT ACTION

Complete the sentence: "I am the one who ___ for the people who ___."

SUPPLICATION

God of all comfort, comfort me, and let me comfort someone else with what You gave me. Amen.

My wound does not have to stay a wound. It can become a door.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: 2 CORINTHIANS 1:3-4

God of all comfort, comfort me, and let me comfort someone else.

My wound does not have to stay a wound.

- Offer one kind word to someone who is hurting.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Wound as a Door

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of mercies and God of all comfort, who comforts us in all our affliction, so that we may be able to comfort those who are in any affliction, with the comfort with which we ourselves are comforted by God.”

2 Corinthians 1:3-4 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

What you have been through can become somebody else's way out. Only the part you are ready to share.

“Fear not, for I am with you; be not dismayed, for I am your God; I will strengthen you, I will help you, I will uphold you with my righteous right hand.”

Isa 41:10 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You do not have to be healed to help.

You just need to be honest and safe.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to offer comfort from where I am.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope someone told you your story helped them. You are not a project. You are a person who can offer comfort.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Sent, Not Special

TODAY'S GOAL

Meet the woman you are becoming and say hello.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT · JOHN 15:16 (ESV)

John 15:16 says, “You did not choose me, but I chose you and appointed you that you should go and bear fruit and that your fruit should abide, so that whatever you ask the Father in my name, he may give it to you.” Jesus says this to the disciples at the Last Supper, in the passage about the vine and the branches. “Appointed” and “bear fruit” mean you are chosen for something, but the fruit comes from staying connected to him.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Self-efficacy research suggests that imagining and practicing the person you want to be, then taking small steps that match, builds confidence over time. Identity is built by actions.

Source: Bandura, 1977. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes · check each box

- 1 ☐ Write a description of the woman you are becoming in five lines (how she wakes up, speaks, rests, loves).
- 2 ☐ Write one thing she does that you already do.
- 3 ☐ Write one thing she does that you will do this week.
- 4 ☐ Say, “Hello, _____. I see you.” (Use her name or a nickname.)
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · CYCLE-BREAKING

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"You did not choose me, but I chose you and appointed you that you should go and bear fruit and that your fruit should abide, so that whatever you ask the Father in my name, he may give it to you."

JOHN 15:16 · ESV

Chosen is not a rank. It is an assignment with a destination. Scripture uses the language of being chosen of every believer, not only the dramatic ones. Many people in Scripture were marked early, isolated, delayed, misunderstood, and broken in a specific place before they were used. The cost is real: lost people, delay that looks like denial, being misunderstood by good people. It does not mean God likes you more. Your assignment may start with simply being the one who stays in recovery.

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SACRED REFLECTION

1. What has this already cost me?

2. What am I still unwilling to pay?

3. What is the assignment right in front of me?

SOFT ACTION

Name the assignment closest to you today. Do one small thing for it.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You chose me and sent me. Keep me humble and faithful. Amen.

Chosen does not mean liked more. It means sent.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: JOHN 15:16

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Sent, Not Special

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

“You did not choose me, but I chose you and appointed you that you should go and bear fruit and that your fruit should abide, so that whatever you ask the Father in my name, he may give it to you.”

John 15:16 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

She has been waiting for you. The woman you are becoming says thank you for not quitting.

“And I am sure of this, that he who began a good work in you will bring it to completion at the day of Jesus Christ.”

Phil 1:6 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

You are not becoming someone else. You are becoming who you were made to be.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to act like her.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope we are good friends by now.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Two Roads: Carrying It On, or Ending It Here

TODAY'S GOAL

Choose between carrying it on and ending it here, and write the choice.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • DEUTERONOMY 30:19 (ESV)

Deuteronomy 30:19 says, "I call heaven and earth to witness against you today, that I have set before you life and death, blessing and curse. Therefore choose life, that you and your offspring may live." Moses is speaking to Israel at the end of his life. The choice is repeated, and it is presented as real, with help from God (v. 20).

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Specific, written plans are linked to higher follow-through. A choice you have written and told someone about is more likely to hold.

Source: Gollwitzer, 1999. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write: "Carrying it on looks like _____."
- 2 ☐ Write: "Ending it here looks like _____." Be specific.
- 3 ☐ Write three actions you will take in the next thirty days that fit the second.
- 4 ☐ Tell one safe person your three actions.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

CYCLE-BREAKING · ADDICTION

Take a slow sip of water. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.*

DEUTERONOMY 30:19 · ESV

One possible future is the woman who knew what she was for, told people about it, and never started, while the pattern ran on. Another is the same woman, with the agreements she made in pain released, the pattern interrupted, five people who truly know her, and someone helped because of what she lived. Neither is guaranteed. Choices are what you have, and you get to make a small one today. If this page pulls you down, close it and call someone.

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SACRED REFLECTION

1. If this week repeats 260 times, where am I in five years?

2. Who else is affected by my choices?

3. What is the one small step I can take today?

SOFT ACTION

Take the small step you wrote. Then tell one person.

SUPPLICATION

God, I choose life, for me and for those who come after me. Start small with me today. Amen.

I am going to do it, scared and imperfect and on a date.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: DEUTERONOMY 30:19

Father, let them know each other.

I am choosing life, for both of us.

□ Read your letter aloud to a mirror, or to a friend you trust.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Two Roads: Carrying It On, or Ending It Here

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"I call heaven and earth to witness against you today, that I have set before you life and death, blessing and curse. Therefore choose life, that you and your offspring may live,"

Deuteronomy 30:19 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You can choose, and you can choose again tomorrow.
That is how the line gets bent.

"May the God of hope fill you with all joy and peace in believing, so that by the power of the Holy Spirit you may abound in hope."

Rom 15:13 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Choosing is not one big moment. It is many small ones.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose life, and I will show it in my calendar.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope your thirty days turned into ninety, then more.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

Steward, Not Survivor: What You Pass On Without Children

TODAY'S GOAL

Plan what you will pass on without having children.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • 2 TIMOTHY 1:5 (ESV)

Second Timothy 1:5 says, "I am reminded of your sincere faith, a faith that dwelt first in your grandmother Lois and your mother Eunice and now, I am sure, dwells in you as well." Paul writes to Timothy, his spiritual son. Faith was passed through relationship. Paul himself had no biological children and passed faith on through discipleship.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Studies on "future self continuity" suggest that feeling connected to your future self helps with long-term choices. Legacy is a way of caring for the people who will come after you, including your future self.

Source: Hershfield et al., 2011. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Write who you could pass something on to (a niece, a mentee, a younger friend, a neighbor, a newcomer in recovery).
- 2 ☐ Write what you want to pass on (a recipe, a skill, a verse, a boundary, a way to ask for help).
- 3 ☐ Write one small act this month (a coffee, a card, a call).
- 4 ☐ Do it or schedule it.
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

CYCLE-BREAKING · WARFARE

Feel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.*

"I am reminded of your sincere faith, a faith that dwelt first in your grandmother Lois and your mother Eunice and now, I am sure, dwells in you as well."

2 TIMOTHY 1:5 · ESV

Victim: this happened to me. Survivor: and I am still here. Steward: and now it belongs to God and it is for somebody else. You do not need children to pass something on. You pass it on to the people who watch how you live: friends, nieces, nephews, coworkers, people in a meeting, people you mentor. Paul remembered a line of faith that passed through women, a grandmother and a mother. You can start a line of faith and honesty, whether or not you ever raise a child. What you pass on is how you live.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

THE HOLY R3UP · STANDING · UNDERSTAND AND STAND

Date:

___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What have I learned that is worth passing on?

2. Who is watching how I live?

3. What does passing it on look like in an ordinary week?

SOFT ACTION

Share one honest, hopeful truth with someone who is watching you this week.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, make me a steward of what You have taught me. Let what I pass on be good. Amen.

I know the road because I was on it. That is the qualification.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: DEUTERONOMY 6:6-7

Lord, bring her home, and keep us together.

She is home, and I am home.

□ Set a place at your table or put a chair near yours for her.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Steward, Not Survivor: What You Pass On Without Children

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

0 = calm · 10 = most distressed

WHEN I FINISHED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Circle one number each time. This is how you can see what works for you.

WHAT CAME UP FOR ME TODAY

WHAT I DID (CIRCLE THE STEPS I FINISHED)

1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

WHAT I NOTICED IN MY BODY

WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME



A VERSE TO CARRY

"I am reminded of your sincere faith, a faith that dwelt first in your grandmother Lois and your mother Eunice and now, I am sure, dwells in you as well."

2 Timothy 1:5 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

There are people who will inherit something good from you, and you do not have to have children for that to be true.

"Those who sow in tears shall reap with shouts of joy!"

Ps 126:5 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Legacy is not only blood. It is who you invest in.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to pass on something good.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, I hope somebody carries something good because of you.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

The Commission

TODAY'S GOAL

Close the ninety days by commissioning yourself, honestly and with a next step.

THE BIBLE IN CONTEXT • NEHEMIAH 4:14 (ESV)

Nehemiah 4:14 says, "And I looked and arose and said to the nobles and to the officials and to the rest of the people, 'Do not be afraid of them. Remember the Lord, who is great and awesome, and fight for your brothers, your sons, your daughters, your wives, and your homes.'" Nehemiah is rebuilding the wall of Jerusalem under threat. The people worked with a tool in one hand and a weapon in the other, and they finished.

WHAT RESEARCH SUGGESTS

Habit research suggests new behaviors can take around two months or more to become automatic, and that missing days does not undo progress. Writing about your future in a realistic way is associated with better well-being.

Sources: Lally et al., 2010; King, 2001. Full citations are in the back of the book.

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP about 15 minutes • check each box

- 1 ☐ Look back through your ninety days. Write three things that changed.
- 2 ☐ Write one practice you will keep (morning armor, craving surfing, HALT, a daily call, a meeting).
- 3 ☐ Write one thing you will do in the next thirty days to build on this.
- 4 ☐ Write a short commission to yourself: "I am _____. I am here to _____."
- 5 ☐ Say the declaration. Tell one person what you finished.

MY NOTES WHILE I DO THESE STEPS

Too much today? Stop at any step. Press your feet into the floor, name five things you can see, and reach for someone safe. Numbers are at the back.

WARFARE · CYCLE-BREAKING · ADDICTION

Hold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.*

NEHEMIAH 4:14 · ESV

Nehemiah rebuilt a wall with one hand on the work and the other on the weapon. That is the picture: build and stand at the same time. Revelation 12:11 says they conquered by the blood of the Lamb and the word of their testimony, and your testimony is whatever is true, told at your own pace to safe people. Read the whole page aloud, standing. Then set the next date and run it again, because you can only see the next layer from ground you already took. You are not finished. You are on your way, and you are not carrying it on.

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SACRED REFLECTION

1. What is different about me than on Day 1?

2. What is the next layer I can see now?

3. Who will walk with me into it?

SOFT ACTION

Sign it, date it, and tell one person. Then pick your next date.

SUPPLICATION

Father, thank You for ninety days of honesty. Keep me standing, keep me building, and keep me Yours. In Jesus' name. Amen.

I am the woman God chose to stand and to build. Not someday. Today. The line stops here.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: NEHEMIAH 4:14

AFFIRMATION

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- ## WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Commission

BEFORE I STARTED

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

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1 2 3 4 5 and one thing I did not do, and why:

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A VERSE TO CARRY

“...Do not be afraid of them. Remember the Lord, who is great and awesome, and fight for your brothers, your sons, your daughters, your wives, and your homes.”

Nehemiah 4:14 · ESV

A NOTE OF LOVE

You did it. You survived. Now we rebuild, and you already started.

“but they who wait for the LORD shall renew their strength; they shall mount up with wings like eagles; they shall run and not be weary; they shall walk and not faint.”

Isa 40:31 · ESV

The note is mine. The verse is what Scripture actually says.

A NUGGET

Ninety days is not the end. It is a foundation.

TODAY I CHOOSE

Today I choose to keep building.

A NOTE FROM FUTURE ME

Future Me, you finished. Whatever comes next, remember that you did this. You survived. Now we rebuild.

Write Future Me one line of your own:

ARC 9 REVIEW

Looking Back: Becoming Her

A few honest lines before you turn the page. This sheet also keeps each arc starting on a fresh sheet of paper for your binder.

WHAT DID I TELL THE TRUTH ABOUT IN THIS ARC?

WHAT WAS HARDEST, AND WHAT HELPED?

WHAT DO I WANT TO CARRY INTO THE NEXT ARC?

Sources

These are the studies and books behind the “What research suggests” boxes. Each box summarizes a finding in plain words and does not claim more than that. **These citations were written from memory and have not been verified against the originals, so please look them up before relying on them.** A librarian, a counselor, or a search engine can help.

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The Challenge Jar

Cut along the dashed lines, fold each card, and keep them in a jar or envelope. Draw one at random any time — when a day feels flat, when it feels too heavy, or when you finish early. Use as many or as few as you like.

CHALLENGE

Text someone a photo of something beautiful you see today.

CHALLENGE

Drink a full glass of water before anything else.

CHALLENGE

Walk around the block and count how many different trees or flowers you see.

CHALLENGE

Listen to a song you loved as a kid, all the way through.

CHALLENGE

Write three things you can smell, taste, or feel right now.

CHALLENGE

Tidy one drawer for five minutes.

CHALLENGE

Sincerely compliment someone.

CHALLENGE

Take a slow bath or shower and thank your body.

CHALLENGE

Call someone you have not talked to in a month.

CHALLENGE

Stand in sunlight for five minutes.

CHALLENGE

Make your bed with care.

CHALLENGE

Give away one thing you no longer need.

CHALLENGE

Eat something colorful.

CHALLENGE

Write a thank-you note to someone who helped you.

CHALLENGE

Turn off screens an hour before bed.

CHALLENGE

Pray the Lord's Prayer slowly, one line at a time.

CHALLENGE

Do ten slow stretches.

CHALLENGE

Doodle for ten minutes with no goal.

CHALLENGE

Sing one worship song out loud, even badly.

CHALLENGE

Read one psalm aloud.

CHALLENGE

Smile at yourself in the mirror and say your new name.

CHALLENGE

Write one thing you did well today.

CHALLENGE

Water or care for something living.

CHALLENGE

Make something with your hands.

CHALLENGE

Sit outside for ten minutes and just notice.

CHALLENGE

Wear your favorite color today.

CHALLENGE

Ask someone how they are, and really listen.

CHALLENGE

Say no to one thing you do not have to do.

CHALLENGE

List ten things you are grateful for.

CHALLENGE

Dance silly for one song.

PRAYER

Lord, I am here. Be here too.

PRAYER

Jesus, hold her hand and mine.

PRAYER

Father, thank You for getting me through today.

PRAYER

God, I do not have words. You know them.

PRAYER

Holy Spirit, quiet what is loud in me.

PRAYER

Lord, show me one thing I can do next.

PRAYER

Jesus, stay near while I do the hard part.

PRAYER

Father, give me rest tonight.

PRAYER

God, protect the ones I love.

PRAYER

Lord, teach me to be gentle with myself.

PRAYER

Jesus, be the shelter I run to.

PRAYER

Father, give me courage for one small step.

PRAYER

God, I give You what I cannot fix.

PRAYER

Lord, turn my eyes to what is true.

PRAYER

Jesus, thank You for not giving up on me.

PRAYER

Father, put safe people around me.

PRAYER

God, help me forgive in my time.

PRAYER

Lord, meet me in the quiet.

PRAYER

Jesus, heal what I cannot reach.

PRAYER

Father, I belong to You. Amen.

AFFIRMATION

I am not too much and I am not too late.

AFFIRMATION

She was a child, and it was not her fault.

AFFIRMATION

I am allowed to rest.

AFFIRMATION

I can learn slowly and still be growing.

AFFIRMATION

God has not given up on me.

AFFIRMATION

I can be kind to myself today.

AFFIRMATION

I do not have to earn love.

AFFIRMATION

My story is not finished.

AFFIRMATION

I am safer than I used to be.

AFFIRMATION

I can ask for help.

AFFIRMATION

My feelings are information, not a verdict.

AFFIRMATION

I am allowed to have boundaries.

AFFIRMATION

I am more than my worst day.

AFFIRMATION

What I survived does not define my worth.

AFFIRMATION

I can start again as many times as I need.

AFFIRMATION

I am known and loved by God.

AFFIRMATION

I can tell the truth and still be held.

AFFIRMATION

My body kept me alive, and I can thank it.

AFFIRMATION

I can be gentle and strong.

AFFIRMATION

I am coming home.

TASK

Put 988 and your safe person's number in your phone favorites.

TASK

Write your safe-place details on a card and keep it with you.

TASK

Schedule one appointment or call you have been avoiding.

TASK

Clear one surface in your home for five minutes.

TASK

Restock your landing kit.

TASK

Reread one day of your journal.

TASK

Pack a small bag: water, a snack, and a note to yourself.

TASK

List your three safest people.

TASK

Write your date and plan on a sticky note.

TASK

Delete one app or contact that keeps you stuck.

TASK

Lay out tomorrow's clothes tonight.

TASK

Save your boundary sentence in your phone notes.

TASK

Make a simple three-day meal plan.

TASK

Move your bedtime fifteen minutes earlier.

TASK

Write one question for your counselor.

TASK

Wash dishes or fold laundry as a prayer.

TASK

Clean out one stress spot (a bag, a car, a purse).

TASK

Write down your three early-warning signs.

TASK

Look up one local support group or class.

TASK

Take a photo of one thing that makes you feel safe.

A Letter From Her

Write as the girl at the doorway. Let her say what she has wanted to say. She can be angry, tender, funny, or quiet. You do not have to edit her.

A Letter From the New Me

Our Promise

Read both letters aloud, then write one promise you can keep, small enough to do on a bad day.

Signed: _____ Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Witnessed by: _____

*Welcome home. We are a team. We are not finished, and we are
not alone.*

LOOKING BACK

Final Reflection

Take your time. Answer in pencil if that feels safer. You are not grading yourself — you are noticing.

WHAT IS ONE THING I TOLD THE TRUTH ABOUT THAT I HAD BEEN AVOIDING?

WHERE DID I FEEL THE MOST RESISTANCE, AND WHAT MIGHT THAT BE PROTECTING?

WHAT IS ONE THING THAT IS DIFFERENT — EVEN SLIGHTLY — FROM WHEN I STARTED?

WHAT DO I STILL NEED HELP WITH, AND WHO COULD I ASK?

PROGRESS REVIEW

Where I Am Now

Fill this in honestly. “Still hard” is an allowed answer. Finishing is not the same as being finished.

Arc	What I finished or practiced	What shifted	What still needs care
Arc 1 • Telling the Truth			
Arc 2 • The Lies and the Names			
Arc 3 • The Realm and Your Authority			
Arc 4 • The Contracts			
Arc 5 • The Bloodline			
Arc 6 • The Playbook and the Structure			
Arc 7 • God			
Arc 8 • Brandi and Letting Go			
Arc 9 • Becoming Her			

YOUR NEXT STEP

Next-Step Challenge

SAY IT OUT LOUD

Go back to Day 1 and read what you wrote — not to grade yourself, to see it. Then choose one practice (the armor, the craving protocol, the silence, the release) and keep it for the next thirty days. Tell one person which one.

MY ONE NEXT STEP

WHO WILL KNOW ABOUT IT, AND BY WHEN?

WHAT WILL I DO IF I MISS A DAY?

Pick the page back up. Missing a day is not failure — the identity is in the rising.

Closing Prayer

PRAYER

Father, thank You for walking with me through these pages. I did not do this perfectly, and You never asked me to. Where I told the truth, thank You for staying. Where I skipped, meet me there with patience. Where I found grief, hold me in it. Where I found anger, let me bring it to You instead of away from You. Give me safe people, good help, and a next step small enough to take. Keep me honest without letting me shame myself. Teach me to tend what You have given me — slowly, the way a vineyard is tended. I belong to You, and I am still building. In Jesus' name. Amen.

THE HOLY R3UP FOR ALL

Certificate of Completion



This certifies that

PARTICIPANT'S NAME

has completed

The 90-Day Rebuild

with honesty, courage, and grace for the days that were hard. Brokenness is not the destination. Keep going, one next step at a time.

SIGNATURE

DATE

You survived. Now we rebuild.

THE HOLY R3UP FOR ALL & CO.

KEEP THIS PAGE

Help, Right Now

If you are in danger right now, or the thought of dying has teeth in it today, stop reading and call. That is not failure. That is the correct use of this page.

Need	Contact
988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline	Call or text 988 · free, 24/7, confidential
Crisis Text Line	Text HOME to 741741
SAMHSA National Helpline (substance use, treatment referrals)	1-800-662-4357 · free, 24/7, confidential
National Domestic Violence Hotline	1-800-799-7233, or text START to 88788
RAINN (sexual assault)	1-800-656-4673
National Human Trafficking Hotline	1-888-373-7888, or text 233733
Veterans Crisis Line	Dial 988, then press 1

GOOD TO KNOW

- **Narcan (naloxone)** is available without an individual prescription at most pharmacies, and free through many health departments and harm-reduction programs. Keep it in the house even if you do not use. It can reverse an opioid overdose and will not hurt someone who did not take opioids.
- **Withdrawal from alcohol, benzodiazepines, and barbiturates can kill you.** Do not detox from those alone. That is a medical detox, not a willpower problem. Call SAMHSA or go to an emergency room.
- Numbers and services change. Confirm them before you rely on them.

MY PEOPLE

Role	Name	Number
Knows everything		
Further ahead		
Behind me		
Just a friend		
Can correct me		

Reaching back. Freeing the bound.

THE HOLY R3UP & CO.